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10. LANDSCAPE AND VISUAL IMPACT

10.1 Introduction

10.1.1.1 The assessment of potential landscape and visual impacts due to construction and operation of the Project is presented in this chapter.

10.1.1.2 Landscape and visual impacts were assessed in accordance with the criteria and guidelines as stated in Section 1 of Annexes 10 and 18 of the Technical Memorandum on Environmental Impact Assessment Process (EIAO-TM) and the latest version of Environmental Impact Assessment ordinance (EIAO) Guidance Note No. 8/2023 on "Preparation of Landscape and Visual Impact Assessment under the Environmental Impact Assessment Ordinance".

10.2 Scope and Content of the Study

Assessment Area

10.2.1.1 The assessment area for landscape impact assessment includes all areas within 100m from the boundary of the Project and its associated works in accordance with EIA Study Brief (No. ESB-373/2025). The assessment area for the visual impact assessment is defined by the visual envelope of the Project. The landscape and visual impact study boundary are shown in **Figure 10.1.0**.

Landscape Impact Assessment

10.2.1.2 The existing and planned landscape resources and character within the assessment area were described, appraised, analyzed and evaluated. A system is derived for judging landscape and visual impact significance as required under the Technical Memorandum. The sensitivity of the landscape framework and its ability to accommodate change are particularly focused on. The degree of compatibility of the Project with the existing and planned landscape setting was identified. The landscape impact assessment evaluated the potential landscape impact so as to illustrate the significance of such impacts arising from the proposed Project. Clear mapping of the baseline landscape resources, landscape character areas and the landscape impact were provided.

Visual Impact Assessment

10.2.1.3 The visual impact due to the Project during operation phase was assessed. For aboveground roads and structures of the Project, clear illustrations including mapping of visual impact are provided. The assessment adopts a systematic methodology and includes the following.

(a) Identification and plotting of visual envelope of the Project;

(b) Appraisal of existing visual resources and character as well as the future outlook of the visual system of the assessment area;

(c) Identification and justification of the key public viewing points within the visual envelope and their views at sea level, ground level and elevated vantage points, and clearly indicate the public viewing points on a plan of appropriate scale;

(d) Evaluation of the magnitude of change in terms of visual composition, visual obstruction and visual change of the Project with the existing and planned visual context, and sensitivity of viewers in terms of types of viewers and value of existing views;

(e) The visual impact of the Project with and without mitigation measures during operation phase shall be included and illustrated so as to demonstrate the effectiveness of the proposed mitigation measures across time; and

(f) Evaluation and explanation with supportive arguments of factors considered in arriving the significant thresholds of visual impacts. The visual impacts included the presentation of an evaluation matrix derived for judging impact significance.

Landscape and Visual Mitigation Measures

10.2.1.4 The merit of preservation in total or in parts of existing landscape and the establishment of a new landscape character are evaluated. Alternative construction methods and / or Project-related works or structure(s) that would avoid or reduce the identified landscape and visual impacts are considered and evaluated for comparison before adopting other mitigation or compensatory measures to alleviate the impacts. The mitigation measures proposed are not only concerned with damage reduction but also included consideration of potential enhancement of the existing landscape and visual quality. Mitigation measures to minimise the adverse effects identified, including provision of a landscape design, are recommended.

10.2.1.5 The mitigation measures such as the preservation and tree transplanting as far as practical, control of night-time lighting glare, erection of decorative screen hoarding that compatible with the surrounding setting, reinstatement of the affected hard and soft landscape area in like-for-like basis, aesthetic design of aboveground structure, provision of finishes to structure, colour scheme and texture of material used, tree compensation, provision of screen planting, roadside amenity planting, roof greening and reprovision of open spaces.

Significance of Landscape and Visual Impact

10.2.1.6 Annotated illustration such as coloured perspective drawings, plans and section/elevation diagrams, oblique aerial photographs, photographs taken at key public viewing vantage points and computer-generated photomontage are adopted where appropriate to illustrate the significance of the landscape and visual impacts of the aboveground roads and structures of the Project.

10.3 Environmental Legislation, Standards and Guidelines

10.3.1.1 The following legislation, standards and guidelines are applicable to landscape and visual impact assessment associated with the construction and operation of the Project:

- EIAO (Cap.499) and the EIAO-TM, particularly Annexes 10 and 18;
- EIAO Guidance Note No. 8/2023;
- Town Planning Ordinance (Cap. 131);
- Forests and Countryside Ordinance (Cap. 96) and its subsidiary legislations;
- Plant Varieties Protection Ordinance (Cap. 490);
- Protection of Endangered Species of Animals and Plants Ordinance (Cap. 586);
- Hong Kong Planning Standards and Guidelines (HKPSG) Chapters 4, 10 and 11;
- Chapter on External Lighting;
- Guideline on Industry Best Practices for External Lighting Installations;

- AFCD Nature Conservation Practice Note No. 2 - Measurement of Diameter at Breast Height (DBH);
- AFCD Nature Conservation Practice Note No. 3 - The Use of Plant Names;
- DEVB TC(W) No. 4/2020 - Tree Preservation;
- DEVB TC(W) No. 5/2020 - Registration and Preservation of Old and Valuable Trees;
- DEVB TC(W) No. 3/2024 - Allocation of Space for Quality Greening on Roads;
- DEVB TC(W) No. 6/2015 - Maintenance of Vegetation and Hard Landscape Features;
- DEVB TC(W) No. 9/2020 - Blue-Green Drainage Infrastructure;
- LAO PN 6/2023 – Processing of Tree preservation and Removal Proposals for Building Development in Private Projects – Compliance with Tree Preservation Clause under Lease;
- GEO Publication 1/2011 - Technical Guidelines on Landscape Treatment for Slopes;
- GEO Publication (1999) - Use of Vegetation as Surface Protection on Slopes;
- Guidelines on Tree Transplanting (September 2014) issued by Greening, Landscape and Tree Management (GLTM) Section of DevB;
- Guidelines on Tree Preservation during Development (April 2015) issued by GLTM Section of DevB;
- Guidelines for Tree Risk Assessment and Management Arrangement issued by DEVB; and
- Study on Landscape Value Mapping of Hong Kong.

10.4 Assessment Methodology

Landscape Impact Assessment Methodology

10.4.1.1 The landscape impact was assessed according to the following procedures:

- ***Carry out Broad Brush Tree/Vegetation Survey including distinctive landscape resources within the Assessment Area.*** The survey would be carried out within 100m from boundary of the Project and its associated works, which is in accordance with the EIA Study Brief (No. 373/2025), to identify the dominant tree species, maturity, rarity, and any plant species of conservation importance, and the trees of particular interest (TPIs) as listed under Para.3 , Appendix I of the EIA Study Brief, etc. for the baseline study on the Landscape Resources (LRs) and Landscape Character Areas (LCAs)." In case the tree species listed in the Forestry Regulations (Cap 96A) under the Forests and Countryside Ordinance (Cap. 96) are commercially cultivated, readily available from nurseries and widely planted in Hong Kong's urban landscape, these trees will not be identified as trees of particular interest (TPI) in the Tree Schedule. The broad brush tree (between 100m assessment area) and individual tree (in accessible locations within the site boundary) survey findings including tree survey plans, tree schedule and tree photographs are illustrated in **Appendix i**.
- All aboveground and underground construction activities including temporary and permanent structures, are assessed in this report if they impose any landscape impact within the assessment area. Only underground activities and facilities unlikely to impose landscape impacts such as tunnelling, are not assessed.

- ***Identification and description of the baseline LR and LCA found within the Assessment area.*** The assessment area includes all areas within 100m from boundary of the Project and its associated works. This is achieved by site visits and desktop study of topographical maps, information databases and photographs."
- ***Assessment of the degree of sensitivity of the LR and LCA.*** This is influenced by a number of factors including whether the resource/character is common or rare, whether it is considered to be of local, regional, national or global importance, whether there are any statutory or regulatory limitations/requirements relating to the resource, the quality of the resource/character, the maturity of the resource and the ability of the resource/character to accommodate change.

  The sensitivity of each LR and LCA is classified as follows:

  High: Important landscape resources and landscape character of particularly distinctive in character or high importance, sensitive to relatively small change.

  Medium: Landscape resources and landscape character of moderately valued landscape characteristics reasonably tolerant to change.

  Low: Landscape resources and landscape character, the nature of which is largely tolerant to change.

- ***Identification of potential sources of landscape impacts.*** These are the various elements of the construction works and operation procedures that would generate landscape impact.

- Assessment of the potential magnitude of landscape changes. Factors considered include:
  - the compatibility with the surrounding landscape;
  - the duration of the impact under construction and operational phases;
  - scale of development; and
  - impact on the Trees of Particular Interest;
  - reversibility of change

- The magnitude of landscape changes is classified as follows:

  Substantial: The landscape resources and landscape character would incur a major change.

  Moderate: The landscape resources and landscape character would incur a moderate change.

  Slight: The landscape resources and landscape character would incur slight or barely perceptible change.

  Negligible: The landscape resources and landscape character would incur no discernible change.

- ***Identification of potential landscape mitigation measures.*** These may take the form of adopting basic engineering design to prevent and/or minimise adverse landscape impact before adopting other mitigation or compensatory measures to alleviate the impacts. Potential mitigation measures should also include the preservation of vegetation and natural landscape resources, transplanting trees with good condition and high amenity value, enhancement of existing landscape quality by providing planting with screening, shading and ornamental value, re-vegetation of disturbed lands, compensatory planting, aesthetic design of aboveground structures including provision of finishes, colour scheme, texture of materials used and any measures to mitigate the impact on the existing and planned land use and visually sensitive receivers. A programme for the mitigation measures will be provided. The agencies responsible for the funding, implementation, management and maintenance of the mitigation measures will be identified.
- ***Prediction of the significance thresholds of impacts before and after the implementation of the mitigation measures.*** Potential mitigation measures suggested would alleviate the landscape impact and enhance the landscape quality by reinstating the disturbed lands and improve the compatibility with the surrounding. By synthesising the magnitude of the change and the sensitivity of the various LRs and LCAs, it is possible to categorise impacts in a logical, well-reasoned and consistent fashion. **Table 10.1** shows the rationale for dividing the degree of significance into four thresholds, namely negligible, slight, moderate, and substantial, depending on the combination of a negligible-slight-moderate- substantial magnitude of change and a low-medium-high degree of sensitivity of landscape resource and character. **Table 10.1** shows the rationale for dividing the degree of significance into four thresholds, namely negligible, slight, moderate, and substantial, depending on the combination of a negligible-slight-moderate- substantial magnitude of change and a low-medium-high degree of sensitivity of landscape resource and character.

Table 10.1 Relationship between Sensitivity and Magnitude of Change in Defining Impact Significance

Magnitude of Change	Low	Medium	High
Substantial	Moderate	Moderate / Substantial	Substantial
Moderate	Slight / Moderate	Moderate	Moderate / Substantial
Slight	Negligible / Slight	Slight / Moderate	Moderate
Negligible	Negligible	Negligible	Negligible

Sensitivity of Landscape Resource and Landscape Character Area

Note: All impacts are Adverse unless otherwise noted with Beneficial.

- The significance thresholds of landscape impact are categorised as follows:

  Substantial: Adverse impact where the proposal would cause significant deterioration or improvement in existing landscape quality.

  Moderate: Adverse impact where the proposal would cause a noticeable deterioration or improvement in existing landscape quality.

  Slight: Adverse impact where the proposal would cause a barely perceptible deterioration or improvement in existing landscape quality.

  Negligible: No discernible change in the existing landscape quality.

  Beneficial: Beneficial impact where the proposal would complement the landscape character of its setting, and/or would improve overall landscape quality.

Visual Impact Assessment Methodology

10.4.1.2 Reference is drawn from EIAO GN No. 8/2023 – Preparation of Landscape and Visual Impact Assessment Under Environmental Impact Assessment Ordinance.

10.4.1.3 These various elements of the visual impact assessment are detailed below:

- ***Identification of the Visual Envelope (VE) of the Project.*** This is achieved by site visit and desktop study of topographic maps and photographs. Size, distance and other factors will be considered, to determine the VE of the Project. The VE is expected to cover the fields of views from sensitive viewers in direct sight of the proposed NM Highway; usually defined by natural ridgeline, man-made features, or road infrastructures, etc.
- ***Identification of the Key Public Viewing Points (VPs) within the VE.*** These VPs are where members of the public or tourists can access or view the site easily.

- **Assessment of the degree of sensitivity to change of the viewers of the VPs.** Factors considered include:
  - Visual impact on sensitive public viewers from the most affected viewing points, include key pedestrian nodes, popular areas used by the public or tourists for outdoor activities, recreation, rest, sitting-out, leisure, walking, sight-seeing, and prominent travel routes where travellers' visual attention may be caught by the Project;
  - People engaged in working activities are regarded as less sensitive to the visual changes;
  - Viewing point should be at human eye level for a realistic presentation of the views;
  - Key public viewing points may refer to Chapter 11 on Urban design Guidelines in the Hong Kong Planning Standards and Guidelines (HKPSG), the Explanatory Statement of the relevant statutory plans, adopted outline development plans and layout plans, and completed planning studies available for public reference; and
  - Local viewpoints should be determined with reference to the setting of the project and views of local significance.

  The sensitivity of viewers of the VPs is classified as follows:

  High: The viewers of the VP are highly sensitive to any change in their viewing experience.

  Medium: The viewers of the VP are moderately sensitive to any change in their viewing experience.

  Low: The viewers of the VP are only slightly sensitive to any change in their viewing experience.

- ***Identification of existing visual elements.*** This includes major physical structures, visual resources or attractors, and/ or visual eyesores or detractors that currently exist or area known to be planned within the assessment area. Different visual elements may enhance, degrade or neutralize the overall visual impact of the development being assessed.
- ***Appraisal of visual changes.*** *Visual changes may be positive or negative and they are not necessarily mutually exclusive*:
  - **Visual Composition:** the total visual effects of all the visual elements due to their variation in locations, massing, heights, dispositions, scales, forms, proportions and characters viz-a-viz the overall visual backdrop. It may result in visual balance, compatibility, harmony, unity or contrast. This appraisal should have due regard to the overall visual context and character within the wider and local contexts;
  - **Visual Obstruction:** this appraisal should assess the degree of visual obstruction and loss of views or visual openness due to the Project from all key public viewing points within the assessment area. Blockage or partial blockage of views which substantially reduce visual permeability, existing panorama, vistas, visual resources or visual amenities should be avoided or minimised, in particular with regard to impact on prominent ridgelines, the harbour, natural coastlines, open sea horizon, skyline, scenic areas, valued landscape, special landmark, heritage features to be

preserved, etc; and

- **Visual Changes:** this appraisal should assess the impacts on changes with direct sightlines (considering degree of visibility and viewing distance) to the existing and future public views by comparing before and after the proposed NM Highway.

The magnitude of visual changes is classified as follows:

Substantial: The viewers of the VP would suffer a major change in their viewing experience.

Moderate: The viewers of the VP would suffer a moderate change in their viewing experience.

Slight: The viewers of the VP would suffer a small change in their viewing experience.

Negligible: The viewers of the VP would suffer no discernible change in their viewing experience.

- ***Identification of potential visual mitigation measures.*** These may take the form of adopting basic engineering design to prevent and/or minimise adverse visual impact before adopting other mitigation or compensatory measures to alleviate the impacts. Potential mitigation measures should also include the preservation of vegetation and natural landscape resources, provision of screen planting, re-vegetation of disturbed lands, compensatory planting, aesthetic design of aboveground structures including provision of finishes, colour scheme, texture of materials used and any measures to mitigate the impact on the existing and planned land use and visually sensitive receivers. A programme for the mitigation measures is provided. The agencies responsible for the funding, implementation, management and maintenance of the mitigation measures are identified.
- ***Prediction of the significance thresholds of visual impacts after the implementation of the mitigation measures.*** By synthesising the magnitude of the various visual impact and the sensitivity of the viewers, it is possible to categorise the degree of significance of the impacts in a logical, well-reasoned and consistent fashion. **Table 10.2** shows the rationale for dividing the degree of significance into four thresholds, namely, negligible, slight, moderate or substantial, depending on the combination of the magnitude of change and the degree of sensitivity of viewers. **Table 10.2** shows the rationale for dividing the degree of significance into four thresholds, namely, negligible, slight, moderate or substantial, depending on the combination of the magnitude of change and the degree of sensitivity of viewers. The assessment of visual impacts will be presented in a matrix format considering the factors including the location of the VPs, type and approximate number of viewers of the VPs, description of existing view and degree of visibility of the proposed NM Highway, the sensitivity of the viewers of the VPs, sources of visual impacts, minimum viewing distance of the viewers, magnitude of change, mitigation measures and significance thresholds of residual impacts (upon mitigation) during operational phase on Day 1 and in Year 10.

Table 10.2 Relationship between VPs/ Viewers' Sensitivity and Magnitude of Change in Defining Impact Significance

Magnitude of Change	Low	Medium	High
Substantial	Moderate	Moderate / Substantial	Substantial
Moderate	Slight / Moderate	Moderate	Moderate / Substantial
Slight	Negligible / Slight	Slight / Moderate	Moderate
Negligible	Negligible	Negligible	Negligible

Sensitivity of VPs / Viewers

Note: All impacts are Adverse unless otherwise noted with Beneficial.

- The significance thresholds of visual impact are categorised as follows:

  Substantial: Adverse impact where the proposal would cause significant deterioration or improvement in existing visual quality.

  Moderate: Adverse impact where the proposal would cause a noticeable deterioration or improvement in existing visual quality.

  Slight: Adverse impact where the proposal would cause a barely perceptible deterioration or improvement in existing visual quality.

  Negligible: No discernible change in the existing visual quality.

  Beneficial: Beneficial impact where the proposal would complement the visual character of its setting, and/or would improve overall visual quality.

10.5 Baseline Study

10.5.1 Physical Landscape Resources

Landform

10.5.1.1 The assessment area for on-site works areas generally comprises various types of landforms, from hillside upland of Kai Kung Leng, Lung Tam Shan, Ngau Tam Shan to Ki Lun Shan, to valley landscape at Tam Mei and Poon Loon Tei and flat land along Castle Peak Road (Chau Tau) and the San Tin Highway.

Waterbodies

10.5.1.2 The assessment area for on-site works areas generally comprises various types of waterbodies within the assessment area, including Kam Tin River, natural stream/ river course, wetland/ marsh/ reed area at Ngau Tam Mei Area and San Tin and Kwu Tung Area, Kwu Tung Reservoir.

Open Space

10.5.1.3 The assessment area is a semi developed rural area comprised with squatter huts, low-rise residential developments, and number of villages. Public open spaces identified within the assessment boundary are usually small in scale and scattered within the developed rural area or abutting the villages. Those are the sitting-out area and ballcourts such as On Yat Ting Sitting-out Area, Ki Lun Tsuen Playground, and Yau Tam Mei Basketball Court etc for recreational purpose to the neighbourhood. No district open spaces are identified within the assessment boundary. In general, all public open spaces within the assessment boundary are considered to be of low to medium value and sensitivity due to their importance and maturity of the landscape resources to the neighbourhood.

Existing Tree

10.5.1.4 Based on the desktop study[1], nil Registered Old and Valuable Trees (OVTs) are identified within the 100m landscape impact assessment area

10.5.1.5 Broad brush tree survey and field survey have been conducted on site to identify the existing trees located within the 100m assessment area which would be potentially affected by this Project. In this connection, the information of broad-brush tree survey and the identified TPIs is provided in **Appendix i** to **Appendix iii**.

10.5.2 Landscape Resources

10.5.2.1 Baseline landscape resources (LR) which will be potentially affected by the Project are described and appraised, together with their sensitivity are analysed and evaluated in **Table 10.3**. The locations of LR are mapped in **Figures 10.2.0 – 10.2.10**. Photographs of the LR are provided in **Figures 10.2.11-10.2.13**.

[1] Source: https://treeregister.greening.gov.hk/map/treeIndex.aspx

Table 10.3 Landscape Resources and Their Sensitivity

ID No.	Landscape Resources	Descriptions	Sensitivity (High/Medium/ Low)	Approx. Area (ha)
Landscape Resources in Kam Tin Area				
LR-1.01	Woodland	This Woodland comprises an area of woodland located to the east side of the San Tin Highway, situated on a low, longitudinal shaped hill and scattered in Kai Kung Leng. Some woodland patches also fall within the fringe area of Lam Tsuen Country Park and Conservation area. Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are identified within this LR. The ability to accommodate change is relatively low. Generally, this LR is considered to form an important part of the overall landscape context and so its sensitivity is considered to be **High**.	**High**	12.4 ha.

ID No.	Landscape Resources	Descriptions	Sensitivity (High/Medium/ Low)	Approx. Area (ha)
LR-1.02	Hillside Vegetation	This LR refers to the hillside plantation located in Kai Kung Leng. This LR forms an important component in views of Kam Tin and the mountain backdrop in views along the San Tin Highway to the Kai Kung Leng. This LR is within the Conservation Area in the foothill area of Kai Kung Leng. The main species in this LR include a combination of exotic plantation species such as Taiwan Acacia (*Acacia confusa*), Brisbane Box (*Lophostemon confertus*), Chinese Red Pine (*Pinus massoniana*), Slash Pine (*Pinus elliottii*) and Swamp Mahogany (*Eucalyptus robusta*). These areas also include some common native species such as Castanopsis (*Castanopsis fissa*), Oak (*Quercus spp*.) and Machilus (*Machilus spp.).* The ability to accommodate change is relatively low. Given its relative maturity, its importance to the overall landscape character and amenity and its importance in terms of the green network, the sensitivity of this LR is considered to be **High**.	**High**	7.3 ha.

ID No.	Landscape Resources	Descriptions	Sensitivity (High/Medium/ Low)	Approx. Area (ha)
LR-1.03	Shrub / Grassland	This LR refers to the shrubland and Grassland mainly located on the south facing hill slopes of Kai Kung Leng. This LR falls within the fringe area of Lam Tsuen Country Park in the foothill area of Kai Kung Leng and falls within the fringe area of conservation area in the vicinity of Nam Sang Wai Road. This LR is mainly located on the hillside within the headland. Dominant species comprising the Oriental Blechnum (*Baeckea frutescens*) and Blood-red Melastoma (*Melastoma sanguineum*). The ability to accommodate change is relatively medium. This LR contributes to the overall landscape character and green amenity in the vicinity, results in the sensitivity of this LR being considered as **Medium**.	**Medium**	6.0 ha.

ID No.	Landscape Resources	Descriptions	Sensitivity (High/Medium/ Low)	Approx. Area (ha)
LR-1.04	Vegetation in Village / Rural Area	This LR refers to the vegetation among the village / rural area located in Po Wai, Fung Kat Heung. These rural areas are largely characterised by low-rise village developments interspersed with vegetation and small agricultural uses. In village areas at Pok Wai and Fung Kat Heung, fruit trees like *Litchi chinensis*, *Dimocarpus longan, Mangifera indica, Clausena lansium* and common village trees like *Ficus microcarpa*, *Celtis sinensis, Macaranga tanarius var. tomentosa* are common. These trees are generally of moderate maturity. Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are identified within this LR. The ability to accommodate change is relatively medium. Given the nature of the development, the sensitivity of this LR is generally considered to be **medium**.	**Medium**	27.3 ha.

ID No.	Landscape Resources	Descriptions	Sensitivity (High/Medium/ Low)	Approx. Area (ha)
LR-1.05	Roadside vegetation	This LR refers to the roadside vegetation on roadside engineered slopes and road verge along San Tin Highway, Castle Peak Road – Tam Mi, San Tam Road in Kam Tin. Tree species found are common roadside pioneer species in Hong Kong. Common trees found such as *Acacia confusa*, *Celtis sinensis*, *Eucalyptus tereticornis*, *Lophostemon confertus* and *Sterculia lanceolata*, generally in semi-mature to mature size, average form and health condition. The ability to accommodate change is relatively medium. Despite the non-native species composition, this LR's relative maturity, its importance to the overall landscape character and amenity and its importance in screening unsightly activities, results in the sensitivity of this LR being considered as **Medium**.	**Medium**	43 ha

ID No.	Landscape Resources	Descriptions	Sensitivity (High/Medium/ Low)	Approx. Area (ha)
LR-1.06	Vegetation in Wasteland / Open Storage	This LR refers to the vegetation scattered in the open storage area in Fung Kat Heung and along both side of San Tin Highway, in which only supports a limited floral species due to intensive human disturbance. A very small part of this LR fall within the Conservation Area in the vicinity of Ho Hok Shan. Dominant species include Paper-bark Tree (*Melaleuca cajuputi subsp. cumingiana*), Chinese Red Pine (*Pinus massoniana*) and the Many-flowered Silvergrass (*Miscanthus floridulus*), with some weedy and shrub species. The ability to accommodate change is high. Given the nature of the development, the sensitivity of this LR is generally considered to be **Low**.	**Low**	14.2 ha
LR-1.07	Landscape Area in Developed Area	The developed areas in Kam Tin comprises the Construction Sector Imported Labour Quarters in Kam Tin. Dominated plant species are mainly for landscape amenity purposes, with some weedy and shrub species. The ability to accommodate change is high. Given the nature of the development, the sensitivity of this LR is generally considered to be **Low**.	**Low**	14 ha

ID No.	Landscape Resources	Descriptions	Sensitivity (High/Medium/ Low)	Approx. Area (ha)
LR-1.10	Vegetation Along Watercourse	This LR refers to the watercourses and its riparian vegetation. Several watercourses and channel were identified in Kam Tin, namely, the Kam Tin Main Drainage Channel, water channel next to Nam Sang Wai Road. This Kam Tin River channel, is a channelized river located to the east to Yuen Long, near Kam Tin, Hong Kong. Vegetation are identified among the river embankment, in which this watercourses support a relatively low vegetation diversity, with *the Giant Alocasia* (*Alocasia macrorrhizos*) and *Bidens alba* being the most common. The ability to accommodate change is Medium. Given the existing condition of the watercourses which make up this LR, its sensitivity is considered to be **Medium**.	**Medium**	10.4 ha
LR-1.11	Vegetation in Wetland Area	This LR refer to the wetland area located on the northern side of Sha Po Tsuen Road and in the vicinity of Nam Sang Wai Road. Part of this wetland is under the private residential development to restore the existing wetlands into a semi-natural, brackish marsh. The dominant species along this LR include common wetland species such as Umbrella Plant (*Cyperus involucratus*), Uni-spike Kyllinga (*Kyllinga nemoralis*) and Whorled Pennywort (*Hydrocotyle verticillate*). The ability to accommodate change is Medium. Given the engineered nature of this wetland, its sensitivity is generally considered to be **Medium**.	**Medium**	3.8 ha

ID No.	Landscape Resources	Descriptions	Sensitivity (High/Medium/ Low)	Approx. Area (ha)
LR-1.12	Pond	This LR refers to the water pond located in the vicinity of Nam Sang Wai Road and in Au Tau (AFCD Au Tau Fisheries Offices). There are some plantation around the edge of the fishery pond, mainly are amenity and self-colonised plants including the Chinese Banyan (*Ficus microcarpa*), Lantana (*Lantana camara*) and Orange-jessamine (*Murraya paniculata*). Tree species found are common pioneer species or native growth in Hong Kong. The quality of this resource is Medium, and the ability of this resources to accommodate change is Medium. The sensitivity of this landscape resource is considered as **Medium**.	**Medium**	2.4 ha
Landscape Resources in Ngau Tam Mei Area				

ID No.	Landscape Resources	Descriptions	Sensitivity (High/Medium/ Low)	Approx. Area (ha)
LR-2.01	Woodland	This LR is the vegetated slopes located to the north of Kai Kung Leng, partially fall within the area of Lam Tsuen Country Park. It was fragmented by infrastructure developments such as Nau Tam Mei Water Treatment Works. The condition of the existing trees within this area are fair, the trees are relatively mature and contribute to the local rural landscape. Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are identified within this LR. Conservation area (4.8 ha) and Lam Tsuen Country Park (0.6 ha) are identified in this LR Given the contribution of this LR to the landscape setting and backdrop to Ngau Tam Mei, this LR has high amenity value and its importance to the local context and local importance. Considering the limited size of this LR fall within the assessment area, the quality and significance of this landscape resources are medium to high with relatively low tolerance to change. The ability to accommodate change is relatively low. Hence, the sensitivity of this LR is considered as **High**.	**High**	13.2 ha

ID No.	Landscape Resources	Descriptions	Sensitivity (High/Medium/ Low)	Approx. Area (ha)
LR-2.02	Hillside vegetation	This LR refers to the hillside vegetation located within the Study Area at Kai Kung Leng Upland and Ngau Tam Shan Upland adjacent to the Lam Tsuen country park. Due to the limited human disturbance, these trees are mature and of medium to large sizes. The vegetation mixed with the grassland, shrubland and trees form a green backdrop in the vicinity and serve as an important green vista and visual amenity for the regions. Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are identified within this LR. Conservation area (1.1 ha) is identified in this LR in this LR. The quality and significance of this landscape resources are medium to high with relatively medium tolerance to change. The ability to accommodate change is relatively medium. Hence, the sensitivity of this LR is considered as **High**.	**High**	29.8 ha

ID No.	Landscape Resources	Descriptions	Sensitivity (High/Medium/ Low)	Approx. Area (ha)
LR-2.03	Shrubland/ Grassland	This LR includes the grassland and shrubland located on the hill slopes in north-west of Ngau Tam Shan, and hill slopes near the Ngau Tam Mei Water Treatment Works, near the proposed I/C03. The shrubland forms the transitional landscape between the wooded lower hill slopes and extends to the grassland at the summit of the hills, forming part of the green backdrop to many of the views available in locations. The area composed of common grass species, as well as some self-seeded and fruit trees, which are spreading from adjacent woodlands or cultivated by villagers in settlement at Yau Tam Mei. This LR is in combination with the other hillside LRs and forming part of the backdrop to views of the landscape from lower levels. The quality and significance of this LR is medium and have medium tolerance to change, hence the sensitivity is considered as **Medium**.	**Medium**	15.4 ha

ID No.	Landscape Resources	Descriptions	Sensitivity (High/Medium/ Low)	Approx. Area (ha)
LR-2.04	Vegetation in village/ rural area	This LR refers to recognised village or low-rise residential areas of lower density dominated by domestic structures (mainly of 2-3 storeys) interwoven with roads and paths and limited other large overground structures. These areas include ancestral halls, shrines and temples and often small orchard or agricultural areas associated with private gardens, as well as amenity planting among the built structures. They are identified to be mostly concentrated at Ngau Tam Mei area, north-wester abutting Kai Kung Leng. The floral composition in these village/ rural areas at Ngau Tam Mei was similar and comprised of predominately fruit trees and ornamental plants. Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are identified within this LR. Considering most vegetation are common in HK and exposed to constant human disturbance, the quality, rarity, significance in local and regional context, are regarded as low to medium with a high ability to accommodate the changes. Hence, the overall sensitivity is considered as **Medium**.	**Medium**	51.7 ha

ID No.	Landscape Resources	Descriptions	Sensitivity (High/Medium/ Low)	Approx. Area (ha)
LR-2.05	Roadside Vegetation	This LR refers to the vegetation planted on the engineered slope along Ching Yau Road abutting hillside of Kai Kung Leng, and road connection to Ngau Tam Mei Water Treatment Works. The majority of the vegetation are slope planting, complies with cluster of exotic trees species and shrub and ruderal herbs and weedy. It is extensively covered throughout the roadside engineering slopes to provide a series of green screening and a green buffer between the roads and the adjacent hillside vegetation. Dominant tree species are commonly planted as amenity and mitigation for infrastructure works. Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are identified within this LR. Conservation area (1.5 ha) is identified in this LR. Its quality and significance of this man-made landscaping are relatively low while the ability to accommodate change is high. Hence, the sensitivity is considered as **Low**.	**Low**	3.5 ha

ID No.	Landscape Resources	Descriptions	Sensitivity (High/Medium/ Low)	Approx. Area (ha)
LR-2.06	Vegetation in wasteland/ open storage	This LR refers to low-lying areas that are heavily adapted for human industrial use such as open areas for storage, parking, or other associated activities such as industrial/ open-air storage, logistic and parking uses, primarily located on both the western and eastern valleys of Ki Lun Shan Au. They are characterised by small internal roads with very little existing vegetation. In which most are self-seeded trees and shrubs scattered around the areas. Considering most vegetation are common in HK and exposed to constant human disturbance, the quality, rarity, significance in local and regional context, are regarded as low with a high ability to accommodate the changes. Hence, the overall sensitivity is considered as **Low**.	**Low**	6.4 ha
LR-2.07	Landscape area in Developed Area	This LR refers to low-lying urbanised areas that are spatially defined by the patterns of surrounding human developments such as roads, utilities facilities and parking use etc, mostly located north of Kai Kung Shan. This LR comes with very limited and low amenity greening at their site peripheral. This LR is man-made in nature and subject to human disturbance. Considering most vegetation are common in HK and exposed to constant human disturbance, the quality, rarity, significance in local and regional context, are regarded as low with a high ability to accommodate the changes. Hence, the overall sensitivity is considered as **Low**.	**Low**	1.3 ha
LR-2.08	**Not in use**	N/A	N/A	N/A

ID No.	Landscape Resources	Descriptions	Sensitivity (High/Medium/ Low)	Approx. Area (ha)
LR-2.09	Landscape area in Ngau Tam Mei Water Treatment Works	This LR refers to the vegetation planted on the engineered slope surrounding Ngau Tam Mei Water Treatment Works between hillside vegetation of west Ngau Tam Shan and vegetation in Yau Tam Mei area This LR comes with very limited and low amenity greening at their site peripheral. This LR is man-made in nature and subject to human disturbance. Considering most vegetation are common in HK and exposed to minimum human disturbance, the quality, rarity, significance in local and regional context, are regarded as low with a high ability to accommodate the changes. Hence, the overall sensitivity is considered as **Low**.	**Low**	3.9 ha
LR-2.10	Watercourse	This LR refers to watercourses and its riparian vegetation. They are mostly observed in areas from hillside of Kai Kung Leng towards north-west Ngau Tam Mei. The majority associated vegetation includes a combination of wetland herbs, common and weedy grass vegetation and some isolated shrub. Considering the small size, scattered nature, exposure to some degree of human disturbance and consists of common vegetation species, the quality, rarity, significance in local and regional context, are regarded as medium with a medium ability to accommodate the changes. Hence, the overall sensitivity is considered as **Medium**.	**Medium**	1.6 ha

ID No.	Landscape Resources	Descriptions	Sensitivity (High/Medium/ Low)	Approx. Area (ha)
LR-2.11	Wetland/ Marsh/ Reed	This LR refers to the marshland/ wetland/ reed areas located in Ngau Tam Mei and Yau Tam Mei. These areas form a successional stage in the return of disused fishponds to dry land and represent a loss in the distinctive landscape texture of the organically shaped fishponds. Some self-seeded trees spreading from adjacent woodland. These marsh areas are considered to be a locally important LR and owing to factors such as its size, the nature of the vegetation and its appearance, the quality and significance of these marshlands are high with relatively low tolerant to change. Hence, the sensitivity of this LR is considered as **High**.	**High**	1.2 ha

ID No.	Landscape Resources	Descriptions	Sensitivity (High/Medium/ Low)	Approx. Area (ha)
LR-2.12	Pond	This LR refers to the freshwater ponds often associated with adjacent village, marsh/ reed and grassland areas. They are mostly small in scale and fragmented in Yau Tam Mei Tsuen and Ngau Tau Mei East. These fishponds include rectangular concrete fish tanks and traditional fishponds with managed pond bunds. Herbaceous vegetation and common reed grass with a few small fruit trees at the pond bunds that are commonly found. It is also observed that the ponds were mostly interspersed with village areas and inaccessible. Considering the small size, fragmented nature, exposure to human disturbance and consists of common vegetation species, the quality, rarity, significance in local and regional context, are regarded as medium with a medium ability to accommodate the changes. Hence, the overall sensitivity is considered as **Medium**.	**Medium**	5.0 ha

ID No.	Landscape Resources	Descriptions	Sensitivity (High/Medium/ Low)	Approx. Area (ha)
Landscape Resources in San Tin and Kwu Tung Area				
LR-3.01	Woodland	This LR is the vegetated slopes of Ki Lun Shan, and south of Tit Hang near the proposed I/C04. The shrubland forms the transitional landscape between the wooded lower hill slopes and extends to the grassland at the summit of the hills, forming part of the green backdrop to many of the views available in locations. The condition of the existing trees within this area are fair, the trees are relatively mature and contribute to the local rural landscape. Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are identified within this LR. Conservation area (0.45 ha) is identified in th is LR Given the contribution of this LR to the landscape setting and backdrop to lower levels, namely Hang Tau Tsuen, Luk Mei Tsuen, Pang Loon Tei, and Pak Shek Au, this LR has high amenity value and its importance to the local context and local importance. Considering the limited size of this LR fall within the assessment area, the quality and significance of this landscape resources are medium to high with relatively low tolerance to change. The ability to accommodate change is relatively low. Hence, the sensitivity of this LR is considered as **High**.	**High**	10.0 ha

ID No.	Landscape Resources	Descriptions	Sensitivity (High/Medium/ Low)	Approx. Area (ha)
LR-3.02	Hillside vegetation	This LR refers to the hillside vegetation located north of Ki Lun Shan and south of Fanling Highway, abutting wasteland/ open space. Due to the minimal human disturbance, these trees are mature and of medium to large sizes. The vegetation mixed with the grassland, shrubland and trees form a green backdrop in the vicinity and serve as an important green buffer between Fanling Highway and Ki Lun Shan viewing from Pak Shek Au, Kwu Tung North area. Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are identified within this LR. Conservation area (1.1 ha) is identified in this LR. The quality and significance of this landscape resources are medium to high with relatively low tolerance to change. The ability to accommodate change is relatively medium. Hence, the sensitivity of this LR is considered as **High**.	**High**	12.7 ha

ID No.	Landscape Resources	Descriptions	Sensitivity (High/Medium/ Low)	Approx. Area (ha)
LR-3.03	Shrubland/ Grassland	This LR includes the grassland and shrubland located on the hill slopes of Ki Lun Shan, and hill slopes south of Tit Hang near the proposed I/C04. The shrubland forms the transitional landscape between the wooded lower hill slopes and extends to the grassland at the summit of the hills, forming part of the green backdrop to many of the views available in locations. The area composed of common grass species, as well as some self-seeded and fruit trees, which are spreading from adjacent woodlands. Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are identified within this LR. Conservation area (10.1 ha) is identified in this LR. This LR is in combination with the other hillside LRs and forming part of the backdrop to views of the landscape from lower levels, namely Hang Tau Tsuen, Luk Mei Tsuen, Pang Loon Tei, and Pak Shek Au. The quality and significance of this LR is medium and have medium tolerance to change, hence the sensitivity is considered as **Medium**.	**Medium**	78.3 ha

ID No.	Landscape Resources	Descriptions	Sensitivity (High/Medium/ Low)	Approx. Area (ha)
LR-3.04	Vegetation in village/ rural area	This LR refers to recognised village or low-rise residential areas of lower density dominated by domestic structures (mainly of 2-3 storeys) interwoven with roads and paths and limited other large overground structures. These areas include ancestral halls, shrines and temples and often small orchard or agricultural areas associated with private gardens, as well as amenity planting among the built structures. They are identified to be mostly concentrated at south of Ki Lun Shan - Pang Loon Tei, Ki Lun Tsuen and north of Ki Lun Shan at Pak Shek Au - Chau Tau Tsuen. The floral composition in these village/ rural areas similar and comprised of predominately fruit trees and ornamental plants. Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are identified within this LR. Conservation area (0.7 ha) is identified in this LR. Considering most vegetation are common in HK and exposed to constant human disturbance, the quality, rarity, significance in local and regional context, are regarded as low to medium with a high ability to accommodate the changes. Hence, the overall sensitivity is considered as **Medium**.	**Medium**	27.2 ha

ID No.	Landscape Resources	Descriptions	Sensitivity (High/Medium/ Low)	Approx. Area (ha)
LR-3.05	Roadside Vegetation	This LR refers to the vegetation planted on the engineered slope along Fanling Highway. The majority of the vegetation are slope planting, complies with cluster of exotic trees species and shrub and ruderal herbs and weedy. It is extensively covered throughout the roadside engineering slopes to provide a series of green screening and a green buffer between the roads and the adjacent hillside vegetation particularly form Kwu Tung North Development near Pak Shek Au from hill slopes of Ki Lun Shan. Dominant tree species are commonly planted as amenity and mitigation for infrastructure works. Its quality and significance of this man-made landscaping are relatively low while the ability to accommodate change is high. Hence, the sensitivity is considered as **Low**.	**Low**	4.2 ha

ID No.	Landscape Resources	Descriptions	Sensitivity (High/Medium/ Low)	Approx. Area (ha)
LR-3.06	Vegetation in wasteland/ open storage	This LR refers to low-lying areas that are heavily adapted for human industrial use such as open areas for storage, parking, or other associated activities such as industrial/ open-air storage, logistic and parking uses, primarily located on both the western and eastern valleys of Ki Lun Shan Au. They are characterised by small internal roads with very little existing vegetation. In which most are self-seeded trees and shrubs scattered around the areas. Considering most vegetation are common in HK and exposed to constant human disturbance, the quality, rarity, significance in local and regional context, are regarded as low with a high ability to accommodate the changes. Hence, the overall sensitivity is considered as **Low**.	**Low**	8.6 ha

ID No.	Landscape Resources	Descriptions	Sensitivity (High/Medium/ Low)	Approx. Area (ha)
LR-3.07	Landscape area in Developed Area	This LR refers to low-lying urbanised areas that are spatially defined by the patterns of surrounding human developments such as roads, utilities facilities and residential developments etc, mostly located north of Ki Lun Shan on both side of Fanling Highway. Conservation area (0.5 ha) is identified in this LR. This LR comes with very limited and low amenity greening at their site peripheral. This LR is man-made in nature and subject to human disturbance. Considering most vegetation are common in HK and exposed to constant human disturbance, the quality, rarity, significance in local and regional context, are regarded as low with a high ability to accommodate the changes. Hence, the overall sensitivity is considered as **Low**.	**Low**	16.9 ha
LR-3.08	Landscape area in LCSD Sitting-out area/ park	This LR refers to public facilities and leisure space surrounding urban developments under Leisure and Cultural Services Department (LCSD)'s jurisdiction, such as, Ki Lun Tsuen Playground and Basketball court, located at Ki Lun Tsuen. This LR comes with very limited and low amenity greening at their site peripheral. This LR is man-made in nature and subject to human disturbance. Considering most vegetation are common in HK and exposed to constant human disturbance, the quality, rarity, significance in local and regional context, are regarded as low with a high ability to accommodate the changes. Hence, the overall sensitivity is considered as **Low**.	**Low**	0.1 ha

ID No.	Landscape Resources	Descriptions	Sensitivity (High/Medium/ Low)	Approx. Area (ha)
LR-3.09	Landscape Area in Kwu Tung Reservoir	This LR refers to the waterbody of Kwu Tung Reservoir and vegetation planted surrounding the Reservoir. The Kwu Tung Reservoir is a small irrigation reservoir. It is popular spot for its heart shape of the reservoir landscape; the landscape quality and amenity value is good. This LR is man-made in nature and subject to human disturbance. Most vegetation are common in HK and exposed to minimum human disturbance, considering the landscape quality and amenity value of this LR, the quality, rarity, significance in local and regional context, are regarded as low with a medium ability to accommodate the changes. Hence, the overall sensitivity is considered as **Low**.	**Low**	1.0 ha
LR-3.10	Watercourse	This LR refers to watercourses and its riparian vegetation. They are observed in areas of hillside at Ki Lun Shan Au. The majority associated vegetation includes a combination of wetland herbs, common and weedy grass vegetation and some isolated shrub. Considering the small size, scattered nature, exposure to some degree of human disturbance and consists of common vegetation species, the quality, rarity, significance in local and regional context, are regarded as low with a medium ability to accommodate the changes. Hence, the overall sensitivity is considered as **Low**.	**Low**	0.3 ha
LR-3.11	**Not in use**	N/A	N/A	N/A

ID No.	Landscape Resources	Descriptions	Sensitivity (High/Medium/ Low)	Approx. Area (ha)
LR-3.12	Pond	This LR refers to the freshwater ponds often associated with adjacent village, marsh/ reed and grassland areas. Fishponds are identified in Ki Lun Tsuen, south of Ki Lun Shan Au. These fishponds include rectangular concrete fish tanks and traditional fishponds with managed pond bunds. Herbaceous vegetation and common reed grass with a few small fruit trees at the pond bunds that are commonly found. It is also observed that the ponds were mostly interspersed with village areas and inaccessible. Considering the small size, exposure to human disturbance and consists of common vegetation species, the quality, rarity, significance in local and regional context, are regarded as medium with a medium ability to accommodate the changes. Hence, the overall sensitivity is considered as **Medium**.	**Medium**	0.5 ha

10.5.3 Landscape Character Areas

10.5.3.1 Landscape character areas (LCAs) were identified within the assessment area in accordance with the "A Study on Landscape Value Mapping of Hong Kong". LCAs which will be potentially affected by the Project are described and appraised, together with their sensitivity analysed and evaluated in **Table 10.4**.

Table 10.4 Landscape Character Areas and Their Sensitivity

ID No.	Landscape Character Area	Descriptions	Sensitivity (High/Medium/Low)	Approx. Area (ha)
Landscape Character Areas in Kam Tin				
LCA-1.1	**Not in use**	N/A	N/A	

ID No.	Landscape Character Area	Descriptions	Sensitivity (High/Medium/Low)	Approx. Area (ha)
LCA-1.2	Upland and Hillside Landscape	This LCA refers to Kam Tin upland and hillside. The hillside woodland within the 100m landscape assessment area is located on the lower hillslopes along the edge at the base of Kai Kung Leng. The more natural parts of the hillsides are covered by lush woodland where native species like *Castanopsis fissa, Machilus spp., Macaranga tanarius* var. *tomentosa, Ficus hispida etc*. are common; trees in these secondary woodlands are generally mature. Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are identified within this LR. The Upland and Hillside Landscape area locates largely part of the Conservation Area and Lam Tsuen Country Park, with an elevation starting from +50.0 mPD. The naturalistic character of these landscape character features is considered to have a high quality, and their sensitivity to change is assessed as High, and the ability of this resources to accommodate change is Low. The sensitivity of this landscape resource is considered as **High**.	**High**	22.3 ha

ID No.	Landscape Character Area	Descriptions	Sensitivity (High/Medium/Low)	Approx. Area (ha)
LCA-1.3	Rural Inland Plain Landscape	This LCA refer to the rural inland plain landscape character area located in the vicinity of Wang Ping Shan South Road and around the Castle Peak Road – Tam Mi. This LCA is characterised by a series of undulating hills with ridgelines located in the foothill of Kai Kung Leng. Some patches also fall within the fringe area of Conservation area. Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are identified within this LR. This LCA includes a landscape of rural setting with remnants of the natural landform and naturalistic vegetation cover. The ability to accommodate change is relatively medium. With the rural type setting and bounded by a more naturalistic landscape, the quality of this LCA is considered to be medium, and its overall sensitivity to change is assessed as **Medium**.	**Medium**	19.4 ha
LCA-1.4	**Not in use**	**N/A**	N/A	

ID No.	Landscape Character Area	Descriptions	Sensitivity (High/Medium/Low)	Approx. Area (ha)
LCA-1.5	Miscellaneous Rural Fringe Landscape	This LCA refers to the flat, low lying landscape of low-rise village housing along both side of San Tin Highway and comprises single storey dwellings set within a landscape of traditional strip fields, small orchards and specimen trees. Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are identified within this LR. A very small part of this LR fall within the Conservation Area in the vicinity of Ho Hok Shan, in the Nam Sang Wai Road, and in the foothill of Kai Kung Leng. These rural village developments are interspersed with mature specimen trees and small clumps of trees. The area is both crossed and bounded by large scale road infrastructure such as San Tin Highway, Tsing Long Highway, Castle Peak Road – Yuen Long. The ability to accommodate change is relatively high. Given the disturbed nature of the existing landscape, the quality of this LCA is considered to be low and the sensitivity of this LCA to change is assessed as **Low**.	**Low**	62 ha
LCA-1.6	**Not in use**	N/A	N/A	

ID No.	Landscape Character Area	Descriptions	Sensitivity (High/Medium/Low)	Approx. Area (ha)
LCA-1.7	Comprehensive Residential Development Landscape	This LCA refers to the modern medium-rise residential development of Crescent Green, Riva, Skycity, and Yuk Yat Gardens along Ko Po Road as well as Park Yoho in Shui Mei Road. The ability to accommodate change is relatively high. Given the nature of the development, the sensitivity of this LR is generally considered to be **Low**.	**Low**	6.3 ha
LCA-1.8	Transportation Corridor Landscape	This LCA refers to the transportation corridor landscape character area of San Tin Highway, which dominated by the large carriageway surfaces, viaduct, and the interchange. The corridor landscape is largely visually enclosed, with the tree planting lining the highway road verge which as a visual green barrier. Tree species found are common roadside pioneer species in Hong Kong. Common trees found such as *Acacia confusa, Eucalyptus spp.,* generally in semi-mature to mature size, average form and health condition. Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are identified within this LCA. The ability to accommodate change is relatively medium. As a result of its developed nature, the quality of this LCA is considered to be medium, and its overall sensitivity to change is assessed as **Medium**.	**Medium**	60.6 ha
Landscape Character Areas in Ngau Tam Mei Area				
LCA-2.1	**Not in use**	N/A	N/A	N/A

ID No.	Landscape Character Area	Descriptions	Sensitivity (High/Medium/Low)	Approx. Area (ha)
LCA-2.2	Upland and Hillside Landscape	This LCA refers to the upland and hillside landscape areas, low ridges extending from Kai Kung Leng, Lung Tam Shan, to Ngau Tam Shan. It is mainly covered in scrub or woodland. It contains a rugged character with rocky outcrops and boulder. It forms the green backdrop to the viewers in the lowland areas of the Yau Tam Mei area. This LCA also contrasts with the urban development along Castle Peak Road – Tam Mei and form an important landscape feature. Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are identified within this LCA. This LCA is generally large in scale and considered as high landscape quality. Railway infrastructure is remote from this LCA. Hence, this type of LCA has a **high** sensitivity.	**High**	70.2 ha

ID No.	Landscape Character Area	Descriptions	Sensitivity (High/Medium/Low)	Approx. Area (ha)
LCA-2.3	Rural Inland Plain Landscape	This LCA refers to the expansive lowland with a low/ moderate density ratio of built development. Often there is significant ongoing change from traditional rural land uses to non-intensive development, which includes abandoned agricultural land and ponds. This LCA is predominantly spotted in south-west edge of Ngau Tam Shan at Tam Mei area. Vegetation is dominated by shrubby grassland and patches of plantation, with fishponds and agricultural fields. Matures vegetation may found along the foothills. Its quality is considered as fair while the ability to accommodate change is medium. Given the significance of its rural landscape character forming a buffer between Yau Tam Mei Tsuen & San Wai Tsuen and Ngau Tam Shan & Lung Tam Shan, the sensitivity is considered as **Medium**.	**Medium**	11.0 ha

ID No.	Landscape Character Area	Descriptions	Sensitivity (High/Medium/Low)	Approx. Area (ha)
LCA-2.4	Urban Peripheral Village Landscape	This LCA refers to the low/ moderate density ratio of rural/ urban residential areas on the periphery of the major urban areas. It includes isolated villages and denser villages scattered in the assessment area, and are often comprised with squatter huts, 3-storey low rise village houses, etc. Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are identified within this LCA. Its quality is considered as fair while the ability to accommodate change is medium. Given the significance of its rural landscape character forming a buffer between Yau Tam Mei Tsuen & San Wai Tsuen and Ngau Tam Shan & Lung Tam Shan, the sensitivity is considered as **Medium**.	**Medium**	22.5 ha
LCA-2.5	Miscellaneous Rural Fringe Landscape	This LCA refers to a wider spread of abandonment of agricultural fields, emerging into its subsequent uses including open storage areas, transport corridors, and parking connected by footpaths and lanes which are commonly found in New Territories. This LCA characterized by low-density structure and mixture of undeveloped area. This LCA is generally low to medium quality landscape in urban area with **low** sensitivity.	**Low**	16.7 ha

ID No.	Landscape Character Area	Descriptions	Sensitivity (High/Medium/Low)	Approx. Area (ha)
LCA-2.6	Miscellaneous Urban Fringe Landscape	This LCA refers to the developed area with comprehensive planning, high sense of self-containment and highly structured landscape character. This LCA is mostly located abutting the hill edge of Kai Kung Leng and Lung Tam Shan. Vegetation found mainly man-made either for amenity purpose or greenery provision. Its quality and significance are considered as low while the ability to accommodate change is high. Hence, the sensitivity is considered as **Low**.	**Low**	11.2 ha
LCA-2.7	**Not in use**	N/A	N/A	N/A
LCA-2.8	**Not in use**	N/A	N/A	N/A
Landscape Character Areas in San Tin and Kwu Tung Area				

ID No.	Landscape Character Area	Descriptions	Sensitivity (High/Medium/Low)	Approx. Area (ha)
LCA-3.1	Settled Valley Landscape	This LCA refers to landscapes characterized by low density and man-made features situated at a valley floor between the ridges of Ngau Tam Shan and Ki Lun Shan. This LCA consist of a mosaic of active and abandoned agricultural which some are converted into open storage/ logistics/ industrial/ parking areas with some remaining isolated villages; hence the incoherent features and their associated structures have little formal relationship to each other. Given the high human disturbance to the area with vegetation and watercourses of low to medium amenity value, and high ability to accommodate change, the sensitivity of this LCA considered as **Medium**.	**Medium**	12.9 ha

ID No.	Landscape Character Area	Descriptions	Sensitivity (High/Medium/Low)	Approx. Area (ha)
LCA-3.2	Upland and Hillside Landscape	This LCA refers to the upland and hillside landscape areas, low ridges extending from Ngau Tam Shan to Ki Lun Shan. It is mainly covered in scrub or woodland. It contains a rugged character with rocky outcrops and boulder. It forms the green backdrop to the viewers in the lowland areas of Pak Shek Au, and Chau Tau Tsuen area. This LCA also contrasts with the transportation corridor landscape along Castle Peak Road – Chau Tau and form an important landscape feature. Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are identified within this LCA. This LCA is generally large in scale and considered as high landscape quality. Hence, this type of LCA has a **high** sensitivity.	**High**	108.3 ha

ID No.	Landscape Character Area	Descriptions	Sensitivity (High/Medium/Low)	Approx. Area (ha)
LCA-3.3	Rural Inland Plain Landscape	This LCA refers to the expansive lowland with a low/ moderate density ratio of built development. Often there is significant ongoing change from traditional rural land uses to non-intensive development, which includes abandoned agricultural land and ponds. This LCA is located at Hang Tau and Pang Loon Tei area abutting south foothill of Ki Lun Shan. Vegetation is dominated by shrubby grassland and patches of plantation, with fishponds and agricultural fields. Matures vegetation may found along the foothills. Its quality is considered as fair while the ability to accommodate change is medium. Hence, this type of LCA has a **medium** sensitivity.	**Medium**	3.7 ha

ID No.	Landscape Character Area	Descriptions	Sensitivity (High/Medium/Low)	Approx. Area (ha)
LCA-3.4	Urban Peripheral Village Landscape	This LCA refers to the low/ moderate density ratio of rural/ urban residential areas on the periphery of the major urban areas. This LCA is mostly located south foothill of Tit Hang and north of Ki Lun Shan, at Pak Shek Au. It includes isolated villages and denser villages scattered in the assessment area, and are often comprised with squatter huts, 3-storey low rise village houses, etc. Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are identified within this LCA. Its quality is considered as fair while the ability to accommodate change is medium. Given the significance of its rural landscape character forming a buffer between the transportation corridor landscape along Castle Peak Road – Chau Tau and Fanling Highway. Hence, the sensitivity is considered as **Medium**.	**Medium**	14.3 ha

ID No.	Landscape Character Area	Descriptions	Sensitivity (High/Medium/Low)	Approx. Area (ha)
LCA-3.5	Miscellaneous Rural Fringe Landscape	This LCA refers to a wider spread of abandonment of agricultural fields, emerging into its subsequent uses including open storage areas, transport corridors, and parking connected by footpaths and lanes which are commonly found in New Territories. This LCA is found at Hang Tau and Pang Loon Tei area abutting south foothill of Ki Lun Shan, and along both side of Castle Peak Road – Chau Tau and Fanling Highway. This LCA characterized by low-density structure and mixture of undeveloped area. This LCA is generally low to medium quality landscape in urban area with **low** sensitivity.	**Low**	10.2 ha
LCA-3.6	Miscellaneous Urban Fringe Landscape	This LCA refers to the developed area with comprehensive planning, high sense of self-containment and highly structured landscape character. This LCA is mostly located along both side of Castle Peak Road – Chau Tau and Fanling Highway. Vegetation found mainly man-made either for amenity purpose or greenery provision. Its quality and significance are considered as low while the ability to accommodate change is high. Hence, the sensitivity is considered as **Low**.	**Low**	13.7 ha

ID No.	Landscape Character Area	Descriptions	Sensitivity (High/Medium/Low)	Approx. Area (ha)
LCA-3.7	Comprehensive Residential Development Landscape	This LCA refers to the low to medium density residential housing comprises mainly of detached houses of low-build elements and private front yard and surrounded with roadside greenery. It consists of a mostly homogeneous and ordered landscape. It is found in the northeast of the assessment area at Shui Tong Hang, namely Europa Garden, Eden Place House, Valais etc. Given the high human disturbance to the area with vegetation of low amenity value, and high ability to accommodate change, the sensitivity of this LCA considered as **low**.	**Low**	4.2 ha
LCA-3.8	Transportation Corridor Landscape	This LCA is characterised by the major highways and railways corridors, and depot, featured with flyovers, footbridges, railway line and associated uses. This LCA is located north of Ki Lun Shan foothill, along Castle Peak Road – Chau Tau and Fanling Highway. Between the roads and railways are landscaped embankments, generally with vegetation of trees and shrubs as buffer planting. This type of LCA is common to Hong Kong and is generally less sensitive to railway development. Hence, the sensitivity of this LCA considered as **low**.	**Low**	10.8 ha

10.5.4 Visual Envelope and Zones of Visual Influence

10.5.4.1 The VE of the Project has been identified by desktop study maps, photographs and site visit to determine visibility of the project site from various locations. The assessment area for the Visual Impact Review is the Primary Visual Envelope (“VE”)

within which the proposed project is clearly visible to key public viewpoints ("VPs") (**Figure 10.4.0**). VPs are areas accessible to the general public from which views of the project are available. Any part of the proposed project that is clearly visible to key public VPs falls within the Primary Visual Envelope.

10.5.4.2 For the southwestern boundary of the visual envelope, it is formed by the townscape in Yuen Long at the west, and the ridgeline of Kai Kung Leng (+570mPD) along the Lam Tsuen Lam Tsuen Country Park.

10.5.4.3 For the northern boundary of the visual envelope, it is formed from the ridgeline of Tit Hang close to the Kwu Tung North. The ridgeline along the Ngau Tam Shan, Kai Kung Leng defined the visual envelope at the east and extended to Ho Pui Tsuen Circular Road.

10.5.4.4 The visual envelope of the Project during the operational phases is illustrated in **Figure 10.4.0** and will further review subject to the latest design development.

10.5.5 Existing Visual Condition and Key Visual Elements

10.5.5.1 This existing visual baseline is established through site surveys, aerial photography, and photomontages capturing current views from key public VPs within the VE for assessment of the visual impact. The assessment also takes into account planned and committed developments, if any, within the Study Area to evaluate cumulative visual impacts. There is no vantage points identified in the Urban Design Guidelines under Hong Kong Planning Standards and Guidelines. Within VE of this project, key visual resources including greenery backdrop from Kai Kung Leng, Ngau Tam Shan and Ki Lun Shan, and river channels at Kam Tin River, Ngau Tam Mei and Sheung Yue River are identified. Concurrent planned developments identified in VE are listed below and illustrated in **Figure 10.4.0** –

1. Kwu Tung North New Development Area
2. Ngau Tam Mei Water Treatment Works Extension
3. Ngau Tam Mei New Development Area
4. Northern Metropolis Highway (NMH) – Kwu Tung Section
5. Northern Metropolis Highway (NMH) – Tin Shui Wai Section
6. Northern Link (NOL)
7. Planned Residential Development under Planning Application no. Y/YL-NSW/7
8. Planned Residential Development under Planning Application no. Y/YL-NSW/8
9. Planned Residential Development under Planning Application no. Y/YL-NSW/9
10. Planned Residential Development under Land Sharing Pilot Scheme Application No. LSPS/002
11. Planned Residential Development under Planning Application no. A/YL-NSW/274
12. Planned Residential Development under Planning Application no. A/YL-NSW/314
13. San Tin Technopole
14. Site Formation and Infrastructure Works for Public Housing Development at Sha Po, Shap Pat Heung and Tai Kei Leng Yuen Long
15. Proposed Hong Kong Wetland Park Expansion Area
16. Planned Residential Development under the Planning Application no. A/YL-NSW/293

17. Planned Residential Development under the Planning Application no. A/YL-KTN/964
18. Planned Residential Development under the Planning Application no. A/YL-KTN/604 and A/YL-KTN/663
19. Planned Social Welfare Facilities under the Planning Application no. A/YL-NSW/348 and A/Y-NSW/349
20. Planned School under the Planning Application no. Y/NE-KTS/18

10.5.6 Identified Public Viewing points (VPs)

10.5.6.1 Within the VE, the following representative key public VPs have been identified, and mapped in **Figure 10.4.0**.

North of Lung Tam Shan
1. VP-N.1 – View from Kwu Tung Fresh Water Service Reservoir (Hiker)
2. VP-N.2 – View from Kwu Tung Reservoir (Hiker)
3. VP-N.3 – View from Pak Shek Au Interchange
4. VP-N.4 – View from Ki Lun Tsuen Playground
5. VP-N.5 – View from Cheung Lek Minibus Station
6. VP-N.6 – View from Planned Public Transport Interchange of the Technopole
7. VP-N.7 – View along the revitalised Ngau Tam Mei Drainage Channel at the University Town
8. VP-N.8 – View from Kai Kung Shan (Hiker)
9. VP-N.9 – View from Planned Roadside Amenity Area of the Ngau Tam Mei NDA

South of Lung Tam Shan
1. VP-S.1 – View from Nam Sang Wai Road
2. VP-S.2 – Western side of Kam Tin River adjoining Ko Po Tsuen
3. VP-S.3 – View from Footbridge crossing San Tam Road
4. VP-S.4 – View from Ho Hok Shan (Hiker)

10.5.6.2 Based on the locations of the proposed aboveground structures, the viewpoints from key public viewers are mapped in **Figure 10.4.0**, with their description and sensitivities evaluated in **Table 10.5** as follow:

Table 10.5 Key Public Viewers and Their Sensitivity

VP-ID	Location of VPs and Description	Type of Viewers	Description and Value of Existing Views	Viewer Sensitivity (Low, Medium, High)
VP-N.1	View from Kwu Tung Fresh Water Service Reservoir (Hiker) • Elevated vantage level VP orientated towards NM Highway viaduct section, at-grade section and 5m noise barrier • Located at around 300m from the Project Approx. no. of viewers: Few	Traveller (hikers) / Recreational Users	• The general view of this VP consists of settled valley landscape and the planned San Tin Technopole and Kwu Tung North Development Area at front ground with continuous ridgeline at Pak Shek Au and open sky view at the background. • The duration of view is long viewing. • Subject to the long viewing distance, the visibility of the view may vary due to the weather condition. • Value of existing view: Fair to good	Medium
VP-N.2	View from Kwu Tung Reservoir (Hiker) • Ground level VP orientated towards NM Highway viaduct section between Portal C1 and B2 • Located at around 250m from the Project • Approx. no. of viewers: Medium	Traveller (hikers) / Recreational Users	• The general view of this VP consists of vast waterbody at left front ground and ridgeline of Ki Lun Shan and open sky view at the background. • The duration of view is medium to long viewing. • Value of existing view: Good	High
VP-N.3	View from Pak Shek Au Interchange • Ground level VP orientated towards NM Highway viaduct section • Located at around 350m from the Project	Vehicular traveller along Pak Shek Au Interchange	• The general view of this VP consists of Pak Shek Au Interchange abutting Fan Ling Highway, the planned Northern Link and San Tin Technopole at front ground with foothill of Ki Lun Shan and the planned Kwu Tung North New Development Area at the background. • The duration of view is short to long viewing. • Value of existing view: Fair	Low

VP-ID	Location of VPs and Description	Type of Viewers	Description and Value of Existing Views	Viewer Sensitivity (Low, Medium, High)
	• Approx. no. of viewers: Medium			
VP-N.4	View from Ki Lun Tsuen Playground • Ground level VP orientated towards NM Highway viaduct section connecting Portal A2 and E2 of I/C04. • Located at around 50m from the Project • Approx. no. of viewers: Few	Traveller / Recreational Users	• The general view of this VP consists of uphill landscape to Ki Luen Shan Au at front ground, with the planned residential development under the planning application No. Y/NE-TS/18 and open sky view at the background. • The duration of view is short to medium viewing. • Value of existing view: Fair	Low
VP-N.5	View from Cheung Lek Minibus Station • Ground level VP orientated towards NM Highway at-grade section and viaducts section between Portal A2 and B1 • Located at around 300m from the Project Approx. no. of viewers: Few	Traveller from/ to Cheung Lek Village	• The general view of this VP consists of grassland at front ground with continuous ridgeline of Ki Luen Shan Au, the planned San Tin Technopole and open sky view at the background. • The duration of view is long viewing. • Value of existing view: Fair	Low
VP-N.6	View from Planned Public Transport Interchange of the Technopole • Ground level VP orientated towards NM Highway at-grade section and viaducts connecting to Portal E1	Traveller of the planned Public Transport Interchange of the Technopole	• The general view of this VP consists of the planned San Tin Technopole with the planned Public Transport Interchange of the Technopole at front ground with continuous ridgeline at Ngau Tam Shan and partial sky view at the background. • The duration of view is medium viewing. • Value of existing view: Fair	Medium

VP-ID	Location of VPs and Description	Type of Viewers	Description and Value of Existing Views	Viewer Sensitivity (Low, Medium, High)
	• Located at around 100m from the Project Approx. no. of viewers: Medium			
VP-N.7	• View along the revitalised Ngau Tam Mei Drainage Channel at the University TownGround level VP orientated towards viaduct section connecting to NM Highway Portal A1 • Located at around 400m from the Project Approx. no. of viewers: Medium	Traveller from/ to the planned University Town and NTM development	• The general view of this VP consists of the view along the revitalised Ngau Tam Mei Drainage Channel at the University Town at front ground. • The duration of view is long viewing. • Value of existing view: Fair	Low
VP-N.8	View from Kai Kung Shan (Hiker) • Elevated vantage VP orientated towards NM Highway at-grade section, viaduct section, and administration building • Located at around 500m from the Project Approx. no. of viewers: Few	Traveller (hikers) / Recreational Users	• The general view of this VP consists of settled valley landscape of Ngau Tam Mei settled valley landscape with the planned Ngau Tam Mei New Development Area from elevated level of Kai Kung Leng hiking trail, peak of Kai Kung Shan at the middle ground, and the planned San Tin Technopole, Shenzhen skyline and open sky view at the background. • The duration of view is long viewing. • Subject to the long viewing distance, the visibility of the view may vary due to the weather condition. • Value of existing view: Good	High
VP-N.9	View from Planned Roadside Amenity Area of the Ngau Tam Mei NDA	Traveller	• The general view of this VP viewing from the planned roadside amenity with layby area consists of the planned G/IC landuse and the planned open space of NTM NDA at front ground, and the planned riverside open space of NTM NDA in the middle ground. • The duration of view is long viewing.	Low

VP-ID	Location of VPs and Description	Type of Viewers	Description and Value of Existing Views	Viewer Sensitivity (Low, Medium, High)
	• Ground level VP orientated towards NMH viaduct section • Located at around 900m from the Project Approx. no. of viewers: Few to medium		• Subject to the long viewing distance, the visibility of the view may vary due to the weather condition. • Value of existing view: Fair to good	

VP-ID	Location of VPs and Description	Type of Viewers	• Description and Value of Existing Views	Viewer Sensitivity (Low, Medium, High)
VP-S.1	View from Nam San Wai Road • Ground level VP viewing at Nam Sang Wai Road in the vicinity of Kam Tin River • Located at around 1000m – 1200m from the Project Approx. no. of viewers: Few	Traveller / Recreational Users	• Recreational Traveler along Nam Sang Wai Road. • This view is to illustrate the potential visual impact due to the proposed viaduct across the Kam Tin River, located in the Tsing Long Highway interchange, with a viewing distance of approximately 1000m - 1200m towards to the viaduct. • The duration of view is short to medium, depending on whether viewers will pause at the point of the trail to enjoy the scenic view of Kai Kung Leng and Tai Mo Shan. • Value of existing view: Good	High
VP-S.2	Western side of Kam Tin River adjoining Ko Po Tsuen • Ground level VP viewing at the path adjacent to the Ko Po Playground in Ko Po Road Approx. no. of viewers: Few	Traveller / Recreational Users	• Recreational user/ traveller located in the path adjacent to the Ko Po Playground. • This view is to illustrate the potential visual impact due to the proposed viaduct across the Kam Tin River, linking to the Tsing Long Highway, with a viewing distance of approximately 1400m - 1600m towards to the viaduct across the Kam Tin River. • The duration of view is short to medium. • Value of existing view: Fair to good.	Medium
VP-S.3	View from Footbridge Crossing San Tam Road • It is an elevated view towards the NM Highway • Located less than 50m from the Project Approx. no. of viewers: Few	Pedestrian Traveller	• Pedestrian Traveler cross the footbridge along Castle Peak Road – Tam Mi, San Tin Highway and San Tam Road, in the vicinity of Elite Garden. • This view is to illustrate the potential visual impact due to the proposed viaduct along the San Tam Road. • The duration of view is short, as most viewers across the footbridge are transient. • Value of existing view: Fair.	Low
VP-S.4	View from Ho Hok Shan (Hiker) • at a level of approximate +140mPD view towards NM Highway section	Traveller / Recreational hiker	• Recreation hiker in Ho Kok Shan (+140mPD) • This view is to illustrate the potential visual impact due to the proposal viaduct linking to the Tsing Long Highway. • The duration of view is short to medium, as most viewers along the walking trail in Ho Hok Shan are transient and may stop for	High

VP-ID	Location of VPs and Description	Type of Viewers	• Description and Value of Existing Views	Viewer Sensitivity (Low, Medium, High)
	• Located at around 400m – 500m from the Project Approx. no. of viewers: Few		short period of time to enjoy the views of vast landscape and scenic view. • Value of existing view: good.	

10.6 Landscape Impact Assessment

10.6.1 Sources of Landscape Impact

10.6.1.1 The sources of landscape impact arising from the Project would create various levels of landscape impact during construction and operational phases of the Project. Potential impacts would result from the temporary and permanent works during the construction phase and permanent aboveground roads and structure elements during operational phase.

10.6.1.2 The NM Highway San Tin Section will be predominantly as aboveground structures and minor underground structures, including the at-grade road / viaduct structures, tunnels, tunnel portals, associated administration building, ancillary building and portal plant building/ plant room, slope formation, and relevant road modification/ realignment of existing highway. The sources of temporary landscape impact were expected from the following key aboveground construction works:

- Construction of associated administration building, ancillary building and portal plant building/ plant room and tunnel portals for operation and maintenance;
- Construction works areas for site offices, stockpiling of construction;
- Modification of the existing landform to accommodate the development proposals including the introduction of new embankments, cuttings, tunnel portals and bridges;
- Demolition materials, storage of construction equipment and plant, etc; and
- Loss of existing trees and other vegetation due to the construction works.

10.6.1.3 The NM Highway San Tin Section constitutes the designated projects (DPs) in Part I, Schedule 2 of EIAO (including items A.1, A.7, I.1, K.10 and Q.1).

- DP Item A.1: A carriage way for motor vehicles that is an expressway, truck road, primary distributor or district distributor road
- DP Item A.7: A road tunnel or railway tunnel more than 800m in length between portals
- DP Item I.1: A drainage channel or river training and diversion works located less than 300m from the nearest boundary of an existing or planned conservation area
- DP Item K.10: A depot for the storage of, or a manufacturing plant for the manufacture of, explosives (as defined by section 2 of the Dangerous Goods Ordinance (Cap. 295))
- DP Item Q.1: All projects involving earthworks, dredging works and other building works partly or wholly in an existing or gazetted proposed country park or special area, a conservation area, an existing or gazetted proposed marine park or marine reserve, a site of cultural heritage, and a site of special scientific interest.

10.6.1.4 The sources of landscape impact in the operational phase would include:

- Operation of the NM Highway San Tin Section, including the at-grade road/viaduct, tunnel portal, associated administration building, ancillary building and portal plant building/ plant room; and
- Permanent removal of existing trees and other vegetation.

10.6.2 Magnitude of Landscape Change

10.6.3 The magnitude of unmitigated landscape changes associated with the construction and operational phases of the Project were assessed and are described in **Table 10.6**.

Table 10.6 Magnitude of Landscape Changes during Construction and Operation

ID No.	Landscape Resources	Description of Works	Description of Impacts	Magnitude of Change (Negligible / Slight / Moderate / Substantial)	
				Construction	Operation
Landscape Resources in Kam Tin Area					
LR-1.01	Woodland	• Temporary work sites for the construction works of NM Highway San Tin Section, including slope cutting, at-grade and viaduct carriageway and associated road works in the northern side of the hillside of Kai Kung Shan. • Permanent structure of 3-lane carriageway trunk road located in the northern side of the hillside of Kai Kung Shan.	• A small portion of the LR that close to the works site would be permanently affected. • Approximate 2.1 ha (17% of this LR) will be affected. • Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are affected within this LR. • Lam Tsuen Country Park is identified within this LR, but would not be affected. • A small portion (approx. 2 ha) of Conservation Area is affected within this LR.	Moderate	Moderate
LR-1.02	Hillside Vegetation	• Temporary work sites for the construction works of NM Highway San Tin Section, including slope cutting, at-grade and viaduct	• A small portion of the LR that close to the works site would be permanently affected. • Approximate 0.1 ha (2% of this LR) will be affected.	Moderate	Moderate

ID No.	Landscape Resources	Description of Works	Description of Impacts	Magnitude of Change (Negligible / Slight / Moderate / Substantial)	
				Construction	Operation
		carriageway and associated road works in the northern side of the hillside of Kai Kung Shan. • Permanent structure of 3-lane carriageway trunk road located in the northern side of the hillside of Kai Kung Shan.	• A small portion (approx. 0.1 ha) of Conservation area is affected within this LR.		
LR-1.03	Shrub / Grassland	• Temporary work sites for the construction works of NM Highway San Tin Section, including slope cutting, at-grade and viaduct carriageway and associated road works in the northern side of the hillside of Kai Kung Shan. • Permanent structure of 3-lane carriageway trunk road located in the northern side of the hillside of Kai Kung Shan.	• A small portion of the LR that close to the works site would be permanently affected. • Approximate 0.05 ha (1% of this LR) will be affected. • Lam Tsuen Country Park is identified within this LR, but would not be affected. • A small portion (approx. 0.04 ha) of Conservation Area is affected within this LR.	Slight	Slight
LR-1.04	Vegetation in Village / Rural Area	• Temporary work sites for the construction works of NM Highway San Tin Section, including slope cutting, at-grade and viaduct carriageway and associated road works along San Tin Highway and in the vicinity of Fung Kat	• A portion of the LR that close to the works site would be permanently affected. • Approximate 2 ha (7% of this LR) will be affected. • Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are	Moderate	Moderate

ID No.	Landscape Resources	Description of Works	Description of Impacts	Magnitude of Change (Negligible / Slight / Moderate / Substantial)	
				Construction	Operation
		Heung and along San Tam Road. • Permanent structure of 3-lane carriageway trunk road along San Tin Highway in the vicinity of Fung Kat Heung.	affected within this LR. • A very small part (approx. 0.02 ha) of Conservation Area in the vicinity of Pak Wai is affected within this LR.		
LR-1.05	Roadside vegetation	• Temporary work sites for the construction works of NM Highway San Tin Section, including slope cutting, at-grade and viaduct carriageway and associated road works along San Tin Highway. • Permanent structure of 3-lane carriageway trunk road along San Tin Highway	• A portion of the LR that close to the works site would be permanently affected. • Approximate 5 ha (12% of this LR) will be affected. • Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are affected within this LR.	Moderate	Moderate
LR-1.06	Vegetation in Wasteland / Open Storage	• temporary work for the construction of the viaduct pier. • permanent work of viaduct pier.	• Approximate 0.1 ha (1% of this LR) will be affected.	Negligible	Negligible
LR-1.07	Landscape Area in Developed Area	• No temporary work or permanent work proposed.	• Nil	Negligible	Negligible
LR-1.10	Vegetation Along Watercourse	• Temporary work sites for the construction works of the pier of NM Highway San Tin Section across the Kam Tin River channel, in the vicinity of the Interchange I/C-02.	• A small portion of the LR that close to the works site would be permanently affected. • Approximate 0.4 ha (4% of this LR) will be affected.	Slight	Slight

ID No.	Landscape Resources	Description of Works	Description of Impacts	Magnitude of Change (Negligible / Slight / Moderate / Substantial)	
				Construction	Operation
		• Permanent structure of the piers across the Kam Tin River, in the vicinity of the Interchange I/C-02			
LR-1.11	Vegetation in Wetland Area	• No temporary work or permanent work proposed.	• Nil	Negligible	Negligible
LR-1.12	Pond	• No temporary work or permanent work proposed.	• Nil	Negligible	Negligible
Landscape Resources in Ngau Tam Mei Area					
LR-2.01	Woodland	• Temporary work sites for the construction works of NM Highway San Tin Section, including slope cutting, site formation of tunnel section (DP Item Q.1), at-grade and viaduct carriageway and associated road works for Project area. • Permanent structure of at-grade section highway (DP Item A.1), tunnel section of Portal A1 (DP Item A.7) and Interchange I/C-03 connecting to Development at Ngau Tam Mei Area. • Permanent structure of ancillary works, namely Administration building and Portal plant building/ plant room (DP Item Q.1).	• A small portion of the LR that close to the works site would be permanently affected. • Approximate 0.4 ha (3% of this LR) will be affected. • Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are affected within this LR. • Conservation area (4.8 ha) is identified in this LR but would not be affected	Slight	Slight
LR-2.02	Hillside vegetation	• Temporary work sites for the construction works of NM Highway San Tin Section, including slope	• A small portion of the LR that close to the works site would be permanently affected.	Slight	Slight

ID No.	Landscape Resources	Description of Works	Description of Impacts	Magnitude of Change (Negligible / Slight / Moderate / Substantial)	
				Construction	Operation
		cutting, site formation of tunnel section (DP Item Q.1), at-grade and viaduct carriageway and associated road works for Project area. • Permanent structure of at-grade and viaduct section highway, tunnel connecting to Portal A1 (DP Item A.7) and Interchange I/C-03 connecting to Development at Ngau Tam Mei Area (DP Item A.1). • Permanent structure of ancillary works, namely Administration building and Portal plant building/ plant room .	• Approximate 2.2 ha (7% of this LR) will be affected. • Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are affected within this LR. • Conservation area (1.1 ha) is identified in this LR and approx. 0.2 ha (0.01% of LR) would be affected within this LR.		
LR-2.03	Shrubland/ Grassland	• Temporary work sites for the construction works of NM Highway San Tin Section, including slope cutting, site formation of tunnel section (DP Item Q.1), at-grade and viaduct carriageway and associated road works for Project area. • Permanent structure of at-grade (DP Item A.1) and tunnel section highway (DP Item A.7) at Ngau Tam Shan.	• A small portion of the LR close to the works site would be temporarily affected. • A small cluster of shrubs and weedy plant would be permanently removed. • Approx. 1.6 ha (10% of LR) would be affected. • Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are affected within this LR • Conservation area (2.7 ha) is identified in this LR but would not be affected	Slight	Slight

ID No.	Landscape Resources	Description of Works	Description of Impacts	Magnitude of Change (Negligible / Slight / Moderate / Substantial)	
				Construction	Operation
LR-2.04	Vegetation in village/ rural area	• Temporary work sites for the construction works of NM Highway San Tin Section, including at-grade and viaduct carriageway and associated road works for Project area. • Permanent structure of at-grade and viaduct section (DP Item A.1) highway and Interchange I/C-03 connecting to Development at Ngau Tam Mei Area. • Permanent structure of ancillary works, namely Administration building and Portal plant building/ plant room .	• A small portion of the LR that close to the works site would be permanently affected. • Some of the existing vegetation in village settlements would be removed permanently. • Approx. 3.7 ha (7% of LR) would be affected. • Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are identified within this LR.	Slight	Slight
LR-2.05	Roadside Vegetation	• Temporary work sites for the construction works of NM Highway San Tin Section, including at-grade and viaduct carriageway and associated road works for Project area. • Permanent structure of at-grade and viaduct section highway (DP Item A.1). • Permanent structure of ancillary works, namely Administration building and Portal	• A small portion of the LR that close to the works site would be permanently affected. • Approx. 0.5 ha (14% of LR) would be affected. • Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are identified within this LR. • Conservation area (1.5 ha) is identified in this LR but would not be affected	Moderate	Moderate

ID No.	Landscape Resources	Description of Works	Description of Impacts	Magnitude of Change (Negligible / Slight / Moderate / Substantial)	
				Construction	Operation
		plant building/ plant room .			
LR-2.06	Vegetation in wasteland/ open storage	• No temporary work or permanent work proposed.	• Nil	Negligible	Negligible
LR-2.07	Landscape area in Developed Area	• No temporary work or permanent work proposed.	• Nil	Negligible	Negligible
LR-2.08	**Not in use**	• Nil	• Nil	Negligible	Negligible
LR-2.09	Landscape area in Ngau Tam Mei Water Treatment Works	• No temporary work or permanent work proposed.	• Nil	Negligible	Negligible
LR-2.10	Watercourse	• Temporary work sites for the construction works of NM Highway San Tin Section, including slope cutting, site formation of tunnel section, at-grade and viaduct carriageway and associated road works for Project area. • Permanent structure of at-grade (DP Item A.1).	• A small portion of the LR that close to the works site would be permanently affected. • Approx. 0.1 ha (6% of LR) would be affected.	Slight	Slight
LR-2.11	Wetland/ Marsh/ Reed	• Temporary work sites for the construction works of NM Highway San Tin Section, including at-grade and viaduct carriageway and associated road works for Project area. • Permanent structure of at-grade and	• A small portion of the LR that close to the works site would be permanently affected. • Approx. 0.1 ha (8% of LR) would be affected.	Moderate	Moderate

ID No.	Landscape Resources	Description of Works	Description of Impacts	Magnitude of Change (Negligible / Slight / Moderate / Substantial)	
				Construction	Operation
		viaduct section highway (DP Item A.1).			
LR-2.12	Pond	• Temporary work sites for the construction works of NM Highway San Tin Section, including at-grade and viaduct carriageway and associated road works for Project area. • Permanent structure of at-grade and viaduct section highway (DP Item A.1).	• A small portion of the LR that close to the works site would be permanently affected. • Approx. 0.4 ha (8% of LR) would be affected.	Moderate	Moderate
Landscape Resources in San Tin and Kwu Tung Area					
LR-3.01	Woodland	• Temporary work sites for the construction works of NM Highway San Tin Section, including slope cutting, at-grade carriageway and associated road works for Project area. • Permanent structure of at-grade section highway (DP Item A.1) connecting to Interchange I/C-04	• A small portion of the LR that close to the works site would be permanently affected. • Approximate 1.9 ha (0.2% of this LR) will be affected. • Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are affected within this LR. • Conservation area (0.45 ha) is identified in this LR but would not be affected	Slight	Slight
LR-3.02	Hillside vegetation	• Temporary work sites for the construction works of NM Highway San Tin Section, including at-grade and viaduct carriageway and	• A small portion of the LR that close to the works site would be permanently affected.	Moderate	Moderate

ID No.	Landscape Resources	Description of Works	Description of Impacts	Magnitude of Change (Negligible / Slight / Moderate / Substantial)	
				Construction	Operation
		associated road works for Project area (DP Item Q.1). • Permanent structure of at-grade and viaduct section highway (DP Item A.1) and Interchange I/C-05 connecting to Fanling Highway near Pak Shek Au and I/C-06 connecting to Kwu Tung North New Development Area.	• Approx. 1.1 ha (8% of LR) would be affected. • Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are affected within this LR. • Conservation area (1.1 ha) is identified in this LR but would not be affected		
LR-3.03	Shrubland/ Grassland	• Temporary work sites for the construction works of NM Highway San Tin Section, including slope cutting, site formation of tunnel section (DP Item Q.1), at-grade and viaduct carriageway and associated road works for Project area. • Permanent structure of at-grade and viaduct section highway (DP Item A.1), tunnel connecting to Portal A2, Portal E1 & E2, Portal B1 & B2, Portal C1 & C2 (DP Item A.7), and Interchange I/C-04 connecting to San Tin Technopole, I/C-05 connecting to Fanling Highway near Pak Shek Au and I/C-06 connecting to Kwu Tung North New Development Area.	• A small portion of the LR close to the works site would be permanently affected. • Approx. 4 ha (5% of LR) would be affected. • Conservation area is affected within this LR. • Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are affected within this LR. • Conservation area (10.1 ha) is identified in this LR and approx. 0.8 ha (0.01% of LR) would be affected.	Slight	Slight

ID No.	Landscape Resources	Description of Works	Description of Impacts	Magnitude of Change (Negligible / Slight / Moderate / Substantial)	
				Construction	Operation
LR-3.04	Vegetation in village/ rural area	• Temporary work sites for the construction works of NM Highway San Tin Section, including at-grade and viaduct carriageway and associated road works for Project area. • Permanent structure of at-grade and viaduct section highway (DP Item A.1) and Interchange I/C-04 connecting to San Tin Technopole.	• Some of the existing vegetation in village settlements would be removed permanently. • Approx. 3.3 ha (12% of LR) would be affected. • Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are affected within this LR • Conservation area (0.7 ha) is identified in this LR but would not be affected	Moderate	Moderate
LR-3.05	Roadside Vegetation	• Temporary work sites for the construction works of NM Highway San Tin Section, including viaduct carriageway and associated road works for Project area. • Permanent structure of viaduct section highway (DP Item A.1) and Interchange I/C-05 connecting to Fanling Highway near Pak Shek Au.	• Approx. 0.8 ha (19% of LR) would be affected.	Moderate	Moderate
LR-3.06	Vegetation in wasteland/ open storage	• Temporary work sites for the construction works of NM Highway San Tin Section, including at-grade carriageway and associated road works for Project area. • Permanent structure of at-grade section highway (DP Item A.1) and Interchange I/C-04 connecting to	• A small portion of the LR close to the works site would be permanently affected. • Approx. 0.4 ha (6% of LR) would be affected.	Slight	Slight

ID No.	Landscape Resources	Description of Works	Description of Impacts	Magnitude of Change (Negligible / Slight / Moderate / Substantial)	
				Construction	Operation
		San Tin Technopole and I/C-06 connecting to Kwu Tung North New Development Area.			
LR-3.07	Landscape area in Developed Area	• Temporary work sites for the construction works of NM Highway San Tin Section, including at-grade carriageway and associated road works for Project area. • Permanent structure of at-grade and viaduct section highway (DP Item A.1) of Interchange I/C-05 and I/C-06 connecting to Kwu Tung North New Development Area.	• Approx. 0.1 ha (1% of LR) would be affected. • Conservation area (0.5 ha) is identified in this LR but would not be affected	Slight	Slight
LR-3.08	Landscape area in LCSD Sitting-out area/ park	• No temporary work or permanent work proposed.	• Nil	Negligible	Negligible
LR-3.09	Landscape Area in Kwu Tung Reservoir	• No temporary work or permanent work proposed.	• Nil	Negligible	Negligible
LR-3.10	Watercourse	• No temporary work or permanent work proposed.	• Nil	Negligible	Negligible
LR-3.11	**Not in use**	• Nil	• Nil	Negligible	Negligible
LR-3.12	Pond	• Temporary work sites for the construction works of NM Highway San Tin Section, including viaduct carriageway and associated road works for Project area.	• Approx. 0.2 ha (34% of LR) would be affected.	Moderate	Moderate

ID No.	Landscape Resources	Description of Works	Description of Impacts	Magnitude of Change (Negligible / Slight / Moderate / Substantial)	
				Construction	Operation
		• Permanent structure of viaduct section highway (DP Item A.1) and Interchange I/C-04 connecting to San Tin Technopole.			

ID No.	Landscape Character Areas	Description of Works	Description of Impacts	Magnitude of Change (Negligible / Slight / Moderate/ Substantial) *	
				Construction	Operation
Landscape Resources in Kam Tin Area					
LCA-1.1	**Not in use**	Nil	Nil	Negligible	Negligible
LCA-1.2	Upland and Hillside Landscape	• Temporary work sites for the construction works of NM Highway San Tin Section, including slope cutting, at-grade and viaduct carriageway and associated road works in the northern side of the hillside of Kai Kung Shan. • Permanent structure of 3-lane carriageway trunk road located in the northern side of the hillside of Kai Kung Shan.	• A portion of the LCA that close to the works site would be permanently affected. • Approximate 2.4 ha (11% of this LCA) will be affected. • Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are affected within this LCA. • Lam Tsuen Country Park is identified within this LR, but would not be affected. • Conservation Area is affected, approx.2.1 ha., within this LR, in the northern side of Kai Kung Shan.	Moderate	Moderate
LCA-1.3	Rural Inland Plain Landscape	• Temporary work sites for the construction works of NM Highway San Tin Section, including slope cutting, at-grade and viaduct carriageway and associated road works in the northern side of the hillside of Kai Kung Shan. • Permanent structure of 3-lane carriageway trunk road located in the northern side of the hillside of Kai Kung Shan.	• A portion of the LCA that close to the works site would be permanently affected. • Approximate 0.3 ha (2% of this LCA) will be affected. • Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are affected within this LCA. • Small patches (0.05ha) of Conservation Area located in the foothill of Kai Kung Leng would be affected.	Slight	slight
LCA-1.5	Miscellaneous Rural Fringe Landscape	• Temporary work sites for the construction works of NM Highway San Tin Section, including slope cutting, at-grade and viaduct carriageway and associated road works along San Tin Highway	• A portion of the LCA that close to the works site would be permanently affected.	Moderate	Moderate

ID No.	Landscape Character Areas	Description of Works	Description of Impacts	Magnitude of Change (Negligible / Slight / Moderate/ Substantial) *	
				Construction	Operation
		and in the vicinity of Fung Kat Heung and along San Tam Road. • Permanent structure of 3-lane carriageway trunk road along San Tin Highway in the vicinity of Fung Kat Heung.	• Approximate 3.3ha (5% of this LCA) will be affected. • Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are affected within this LCA. • Conservation Area is identified in this LCA, and a very small part (0.02ha) in the vicinity of Pak Wai would be affected.		
LCA-1.7	Comprehensive Residential Development Landscape	Nil	Nil	Negligible	Negligible
LCA-1.8	Transportation Corridor Landscape	• Temporary work sites for the construction works of NM Highway San Tin Section, including slope cutting, at-grade and viaduct carriageway and associated road works along San Tin Highway. • Permanent structure of 3-lane carriageway trunk road along San Tin Highway linking to the Tsing Long Highway.	• A portion of the LCA that close to the works site would be permanently affected. • Approximate 4.3 ha (14% of this LCA) will be affected. • Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are affected within this LR.	Moderate	Moderate
Landscape Character Areas in Ngau Tam Mei Area					
LCA-2.1	**Not in use**	• Nil	• Nil	Negligible	Negligible
LCA-2.2	Upland and Hillside Landscape	• Temporary work sites for the construction works of NM Highway San Tin Section, including slope cutting, site formation of tunnel section, at-grade and viaduct carriageway and associated road works for Project area (DP Item Q.1). • Permanent structure of at-grade and viaduct section highway (DP Item A.1), tunnel connecting Portal A1 (DP Item A.7) and Interchange I/C-03 connecting to Development at Ngau Tam Mei Area. • Permanent structure of ancillary works, namely Administration building	• Approx. 5.0 ha (7% of LCA) would be affected. • Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are affected within this LCA • Conservation area (10.1 ha) is identified in this LCA within the 100m assessment boundary and approx. 0.2 ha (0.002% of LCA) would be affected. • Lam Tsuen Country Park (0.6 ha) is identified in this LCA but would not be affected.	Slight	Slight

ID No.	Landscape Character Areas	Description of Works	Description of Impacts	Magnitude of Change (Negligible / Slight / Moderate/ Substantial) *	
				Construction	Operation
		and Portal plant building/ plant room .			
LCA-2.3	Rural Inland Plain Landscape	• Temporary work sites for the construction works of NM Highway San Tin Section, including at-grade and viaduct carriageway and associated road works for Project area. • Permanent structure of viaduct section highway (DP Item A.1).	• Approx. 1.0 ha (10% of LCA) would be affected.	Moderate	Moderate
LCA-2.4	Urban Peripheral Village Landscape	• Temporary work sites for the construction works of NM Highway San Tin Section, including at-grade and viaduct carriageway and associated road works for Project area. • Permanent structure of at-grade and viaduct section highway. • Permanent structure of at-grade and viaduct section highway and Interchange I/C-03 connecting to Development at Ngau Tam Mei Area. • Permanent structure of ancillary works, namely Administration building.	• Approx. 2.4 ha (11% of LCA) would be affected. • Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are affected within this LCA • Conservation area (0.01 ha) is identified in this LCA but would not be affected.	Slight	Slight
LCA-2.5	Miscellaneous Rural Fringe Landscape	• Temporary work sites for the construction works of NM Highway San Tin Section, including viaduct carriageway and associated road works for Project area. • Permanent structure of viaduct section highway.	• Approx. 0.9 ha (5% of LCA) would be affected.	Slight	Slight
LCA-2.6	Miscellaneous Urban Fringe Landscape	• Temporary work sites for the construction works of NM Highway San Tin Section, including at-grade and viaduct carriageway and associated road works for Project area. • Permanent structure of at-grade and viaduct section highway.	• A small portion of the LCA close to the works site would be temporarily affected. • Approx. 0.4 ha (4% of LCA) would be affected.	Slight	Slight
LCA-2.7	**Not in use**	• Nil	• Nil	Negligible	Negligible
LCA-2.8	**Not in use**	• Nil	• Nil	Negligible	Negligible
Landscape Character Areas in San Tin and Kwu Tung Area					

ID No.	Landscape Character Areas	Description of Works	Description of Impacts	Magnitude of Change (Negligible / Slight / Moderate/ Substantial) *	
				Construction	Operation
LCA-3.1	Settled Valley Landscape	• Temporary work sites for the construction works of NM Highway San Tin Section, including at-grade and viaduct carriageway and associated road works for Project area. • Permanent structure of at-grade and viaduct section highway and Interchange I/C-04 connecting to San Tin Technopole.	• Approx. 1.8 ha (14% of LCA) would be affected. • Conservation area (1.1 ha) is identified in this LR but would not be affected	Moderate	Moderate
LCA-3.2	Upland and Hillside Landscape	• Temporary work sites for the construction works of NM Highway San Tin Section, including slope cutting, site formation of tunnel section, at-grade and viaduct carriageway and associated road works for Project area. • Permanent structure of viaduct and at-grade section highway (DP Item A.1), tunnel connecting I/C04 (DP Item A.7), and Interchange I/C-04 connecting to San Tin Technopole, I/C-05 connecting to Fanling Highway near Pak Shek Au and I/C-06 connecting to Kwu Tung North New Development Area.	• Approx. 6.5 ha (6% of LCA) would be affected. • Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are affected within this LCA • Conservation area (11.6 ha) is identified in this LCA and approx. 0.1 ha (0.001% of LCA) would be affected.	Slight	Slight
LCA-3.3	Rural Inland Plain Landscape	• Temporary work sites for the construction works of NM Highway San Tin Section, including at-grade and viaduct carriageway and associated road works for Project area. • Permanent structure of at-grade and viaduct section highway and Interchange I/C-04 connecting to San Tin Technopole. • Permanent structure of at-grade and viaduct section highway and Interchange I/C-03 connecting to Development at Ngau Tam Mei Area. • Permanent structure of ancillary works, namely Administration building.	• Approx. 0.6 ha (15% of LCA) would be affected.	Moderate	Moderate
LCA-3.4	Urban Peripheral Village Landscape	• Temporary work sites for the construction works of NM Highway San Tin Section, including viaduct carriageway and associated road works for Project area.	• A small portion of the LCA close to the works site would be temporarily affected. • Approx. 2.1 ha (15% of LCA) would be affected.	Moderate	Moderate

ID No.	Landscape Character Areas	Description of Works	Description of Impacts	Magnitude of Change (Negligible / Slight / Moderate/ Substantial) *	
				Construction	Operation
		• Permanent structure of viaduct and at-grade section highway (DP Item A.1) and Interchange I/C-06 connecting to Kwu Tung North New Development Area	• Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are affected within this LCA		
LCA-3.5	Miscellaneous Rural Fringe Landscape	• Temporary work sites for the construction works of NM Highway San Tin Section, including at-grade and viaduct carriageway and associated road works for Project area. • Permanent structure of at-grade and viaduct section highway (DP Item A.1) and Interchange I/C-06 connecting to Kwu Tung North New Development Area.	• Approx. 0.4 ha (4% of LCA) would be affected. • Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are affected within this LCA • Conservation area (0.7 ha) is identified in this LCA but would not be affected	Slight	Slight
LCA-3.6	Miscellaneous Urban Fringe Landscape	• No temporary work or permanent work proposed.	• Nil	Negligible	Negligible
LCA-3.7	Comprehensive Residential Development Landscape	• Temporary work sites for the construction works of NM Highway San Tin Section, including at-grade carriageway and associated road works for Project area. • Permanent structure of at-grade section highway (DP Item A.1).	• Approx. 0.1 ha (2% of LCA) would be affected.	Slight	Slight
LCA-3.8	Transportation Corridor Landscape	• Temporary work sites for the construction works of NM Highway San Tin Section, including at-grade and viaduct carriageway and associated road works for Project area. • Permanent structure of at-grade and viaduct section highway (DP Item A.1) and Interchange I/C-05 connecting to Fanling Highway near Pak Shek Au.	• Approx. 0.9 ha (9% of LCA) would be affected.	Slight	Slight

Remarks (*) : The estimation would be based on the approximate area and proportion of affected area of each LR / LCA. The affected tree quantity of each LR / LCA would not be presented in the LVIA submission.

Significance of Unmitigated Landscape Impact

10.6.3.1 The significance of landscape impact, before implementation of mitigation measures, in the construction and operational phases is assessed and presented in this LVIA submission.

10.6.3.2 The initial significance of unmitigated impacts on the affected LRs and LCAs would vary from negligible to moderate.

10.7 Visual Impact Assessment

10.7.1 Sources of Visual Impact

10.7.1.1 The sources of visual impact during operational phases of the Project would create varying levels of visual impact. Potential impacts would be resulted from the permanent aboveground structure elements during operational phase.

10.7.1.2 The sources of visual impact in the operational phase would include:

- Operation of the NM Highway San Tin Section, including the at-grade road/viaduct, tunnel portal, associated administration building, ancillary building and portal plant building/ plant room; and
- Removal of existing trees and other vegetation due to the Project.

10.7.1.3 The locations and development details of permanent aboveground structures that would cause potential visual impact are summarised below, please refer to **Figure 10.4.0** for location.

Location	Approximate footprint and Height of the Structure (m)	Remark
Portal plant building/ plant room	50m x 20m, 30m height	At portal A1
Portal plant building/ plant room	40m x 20m, 30m height	At portal A2
Portal plant building/ plant room	40m x 20m, 30m height	At portal B1
Portal plant building/ plant room	40m x 20m, 30m height	At portal C2
Portal plant building/ plant room	40m x 20m, 30m height	At portal E2
Administration Building	100m x 40m, 30m height	Near I/C-03

10.7.2 Magnitude of Visual Impact on existing VPs

10.7.2.1 The criteria for the selection of representative viewpoints for photomontages include:

- the viewpoints which cover the aboveground structure(s) viewed from major public viewpoint would be potentially affected by the proposed permanent structures; and
- the viewpoints should be able to represent the worst-case scenarios and demonstrate the compatibility of the aboveground structures to the adjacent visual context and illustrate the visual effect with and without mitigation measures at operation stage.

10.7.3 Significance Thresholds of Visual Impact

10.7.4 The significance thresholds of visual impact, in the operational phase will be assessed and presented in **Table 10.7**.

Table 10.7 Magnitude of Visual Change during Operation Phase

VP ID	Location of VPs	Sources of Visual Impact	Visual Composition	Visual Obstruction	Visual Change	Magnitude of Change (Negligible / Slight/ Moderate/ Substantial)
VP-N.1	View from Kwu Tung Fresh Water Service Reservoir (Hiker)	The proposed road works (at grade and viaduct section) of I/C05 & I/C06, and ancillary works, including 5m noise barrier	• The view is dominated by settled valley landscape and the planned San Tin Technopole and Kwu Tung North Development Area at front ground with settlements at Pak Shek Au, and ridgeline at She Leng (+143mPD) and open sky view at the background. • The backdrop consists of Pak Shek Au Interchange occupying the middle ground with adjacent planned San Tin Technopole and Kwu Tung North development. • The visual compatibility of the proposed road works with surrounding context is considered as M**edium**.	• Due to the elevated nature of this VP, the proposed road works (at-grade and viaduct section) of I/C06 create medium visual obstruction to the existing distant view of the Pak Shek Au settled valley landscape. • The obstruction to visuals is **Partial**.	• Before the proposed road works (at-grade and viaduct section) of I/C06, the value of this view is primarily attached to the planned San Tin Technopole and Kwu Tung North development at foreground, and open sky and mountain ridgeline view at the background. • The proposed development would preserve the foreground vegetation on Ki Lun Shan (+223mPD) and ridgeline of She Leng (+143mPD) as visual amenity. It will mainly obstruct the mountain ridgeline of She Leng (+143mPD) view partially, and Pak Shek Au settled valley landscape. • Degree of visibility: M**edium** • Viewing distance: **Long** • The visual change with partial blockage of the mountain ridgeline view is consider as M**edium.**	**Moderate**
VP-N.2	View from Kwu Tung Reservoir (Hiker)	The proposed road works (at-grade section) between Portal C1 and B2 of interchange I/C05.	• The view is dominated by an open sky view and vast, continuous ridgeline Ki Lun Shan	• The proposed road works (at-grade section) of I/C05 will create slight visual obstruction to the	• Before the proposed road works (at-grade section) of I/C05, the value of this view is primarily attached to the open sky, Kwu	**Slight**

VP ID	Location of VPs	Sources of Visual Impact	Visual Composition	Visual Obstruction	Visual Change	Magnitude of Change (Negligible / Slight/ Moderate/ Substantial)
			(+223mPD) at the background. • The backdrop consists of ridgeline Ki Lun Shan (+223mPD) , while Kwu Tung Reservoir and the hiking trail at Kwu Tung Reservoir occupy the middle ground with adjacent greenery and shrubs. • The visual compatibility of the proposed road works with surrounding context is considered as L**ow**.	existing distant view of the mountain ridgeline of Ki Lun Shan (+223mPD). Most of the proposed road works (at-grade section) are not visible from this view due to the long viewing distance. Remaining portion of the proposed road works will be tunnel section and will not be visible from this view. • The obstruction to visuals is **Partial**.	Tung Reservoir and mountain ridgeline view. • The proposed development would preserve the vegetation abutting Kwu Tung Reservoir and the Reservoir as visual amenity. It will obstruct the mountain ridgeline of Ki Lun Shan (+223mPD) view slightly. • Degree of visibility: **Slight** • Viewing distance: **Long** • The visual change with partial blockage of the mountain ridgeline view is consider as **Low**.	
VP-N.3	View from Pak Shek Au Interchange	The proposed road works (viaduct section) of I/C05 & I/C06.	• The view is dominated by Pak Shek Au Interchange, the planned Northern Link and San Tin Technopole at front ground with foothill of Ki Lun Shan at the background. • The backdrop consists of the planned Kwu Tung North New Development Area. • The visual compatibility of the proposed road works with surrounding context is considered as **High**.	• The proposed road works (viaduct section) of I/C05 & I/C06 will create slight to medium visual obstruction to the existing distant view of the Kwu Tung North development. • Most of the proposed road works (at-grade and viaduct section) are not visible from this view due to the long viewing distance. Only a small portion of the viaduct section would be visible and form part of the middle ground of this view. • The obstruction to visuals is **Partial**.	• Before the proposed road works (viaduct section) of I/C06, the value of this view is primarily attached to the foothill of Ki Lun Shan and Kwu Tung North development. • No visual amenity element for the construction site of Pak Shek Au Interchange and Kwu Tung North development. • It will mainly obstruct the Kwu Tung North development. • Degree of visibility: **Medium** • Viewing distance: **Long** • The visual change with partial blockage of the	**Moderate**

VP ID	Location of VPs	Sources of Visual Impact	Visual Composition	Visual Obstruction	Visual Change	Magnitude of Change (Negligible / Slight/ Moderate/ Substantial)
					building view is consider as **Medium**	
VP-N.4	View from Ki Lun Tsuen Playground	The proposed road works (at grade and viaduct section) connecting Portal A2 and E2 of I/C04.	• The view is dominated by driveway at front ground with foothill view of Ki Lun Shan Au (+55mPD) and open sky view with the planned residential development under the planning application No. Y/NE-KTS/18 at the background. • The backdrop mostly consists of hillside vegetation. • The visual compatibility of the proposed road works with surrounding context is considered as **low**.	• The proposed road works (viaduct section) of I/C04 will create medium to substantial visual obstruction to the existing view of the hillside vegetation at Ki Lun Shan Au (+55mPD). • Some of the proposed road works (viaduct section) are not visible from this view due to the density of vegetation in the foreground. • The obstruction to visuals is **Partial**.	• Before the proposed road works (viaduct section) of I/C04, the value of this view is primarily attached to the hillside vegetation and open sky. • The proposed road works would preserve the foreground hillside vegetation and roadside vegetation as visual amenity. It will partially obstruct the foothill view of Ki Lun Shan Au (+55mPD). • Degree of visibility: **Medium** • Viewing distance: **Short** • The visual change with partial blockage of the building view is consider as **Medium**	**Moderate**
VP-N.5	View from Cheung Lek Minibus Station	The proposed road works (at grade and viaduct section) connecting Portal A2 and E2 of I/C04, and ancillary works, including portal plant building/ plant room.	• The view is dominated by grassland/ shrubland in the front and an open sky view with the planned San Tin Technopole and vast continuous ridgeline of Ngau Tam Shan (+337mPD) at the background. • The backdrop consists of grassland/ shrubland occupying the middle ground with Ngau Tam Shan (+337mPD) at the back.	• The proposed road works (at-grade and viaduct section) of I/C04 will create partial visual obstruction to the existing distant view of the mountain ridgeline of Ngau Tam Shan (+337mPD). • Most of the proposed road works (at-grade section) are not visible from this view due to the long viewing distance. • The obstruction to visuals is **Partial**.	• Before the proposed road works (at-grade and viaduct section) of I/C04, the value of this view is primarily attached to the open sky, grassland/ shrubland and mountain ridgeline view. • The proposed development would preserve the majority of the backdrop as visual amenity. It will obstruct the mountain ridgeline of Ngau Tam Shan (+337mPD) view slightly.	**Slight**

VP ID	Location of VPs	Sources of Visual Impact	Visual Composition	Visual Obstruction	Visual Change	Magnitude of Change (Negligible / Slight/ Moderate/ Substantial)
			• The visual compatibility of the proposed road works with surrounding context is considered as L**ow**.		• Degree of visibility: **Slight** • Viewing distance: **Long** • The visual change with partial blockage of the mountain ridgeline view is consider as **Low**.	
VP-N.6	View from Planned Public Transport Interchange of the Technopole	The proposed road works (at-grade and tunnel section) connecting Portal E1 of I/C04.	• The view is dominated by roadside vegetation and the planned San Tin Technopole at the foreground from the planned Public Transport Interchange of the Technopole, with partial sky view with foothill of Ngau Tam Shan (+337mPD) at the background. • The backdrop consists of roadside vegetation and driveway occupying the middle ground with roadside vegetation and Ngau Tam Shan (+337mPD) at the back. • The visual compatibility of the proposed road works with surrounding context is considered as **High**.	• The proposed road works (at-grade section) of I/C04 will create partial visual obstruction to the existing distant foothill view of Ngau Tam Shan (+337mPD). • Partial of the proposed road works (tunnel and at-grade section) are not visible from this view due to blockage of the planned San Tin Technopole development. • The obstruction to visuals is **Slight**.	• Before the proposed road works (at-grade and tunnel section) of I/C04, the value of this view is primarily attached to the open sky, grassland/ shrubland and view to the planned San Tin Technopole from the planned Public Transport Interchange of the Technopole • The proposed development would preserve the majority of the backdrop as visual amenity. The at-grade section will obstruct the mountain ridgeline of Ngau Tam Shan (+337mPD) view slightly. • As partial of proposed road works (at-grade section) is located behind the planned San Tin Technopole, it would not change the visual composition of this view. • Degree of visibility: **Slight** • Viewing distance: **Medium** • The visual change with blockage of the planned development is consider as **Negligible**.	**Slight**

VP ID	Location of VPs	Sources of Visual Impact	Visual Composition	Visual Obstruction	Visual Change	Magnitude of Change (Negligible / Slight/ Moderate/ Substantial)
VP-N.7	View along the revitalised Ngau Tam Mei Drainage Channel at the University Town	The proposed road works (viaduct section) connecting Portal A1 and ancillary works, including portal plant building/ plant room and 5m vertical abortive noise barrier.	• The view is dominated by the view along the revitalised Ngau Tam Mei Drainage Channel at the University Town and a partial sky view with ridgeline of Ngau Tam Shan (+337mPD) at the background. • The backdrop consists of woodland at foothill of Ngau Tam Shan (+337mPD) and ridgeline of Ngau Tam Shan (+337mPD) at the back. • The visual compatibility of the proposed road works with surrounding context is considered as **Medium**.	• The proposed road works (viaduct section) connecting to I/C03 will create partial visual obstruction to the existing distant view of the mountain ridgeline of Ngau Tam Shan (+337mPD). • Most of the proposed road works (viaduct section) are not visible from this view due to the blockage of the planned University Town • The obstruction to visuals is **Slight**.	• Before the proposed road works (at-grade and viaduct section) connecting to I/C03, the value of this view is primarily attached to the the planned University Town of Ngau Tam Mei New Development Area, partial sky and mountain ridgeline view.. • As the planned University Town of Ngau Tam Mei New Development Area occupies most of the view and the proposed road works (viaduct section) is mostly located behind the development, the proposed road works will have limited change to the visual composition of this view. • Degree of visibility: **Negligible** • Viewing distance: **Long** • The visual change with blockage of the planned development and mountain ridgeline view is consider as **Slight**.	**Slight**
VP-N.8	View from Kai Kung Shan (Hiker)	The proposed road works (at grade and viaduct section) connecting to Portal A1 and interchange I/C03 and ancillary works, including administration building.	• The view is dominated by settled valley landscape of Ngau Tam Mei with the planned Ngau Tam Mei New Development Area and Yau Tam Mei area at front ground and the planned San Tin Technopole,	• Due to the elevated nature of this VP, the proposed road works (at-grade and viaduct section) create slight visual obstruction to the existing distant view of the Ngau Tam Mei with the planned development and Yau	• Before the proposed road works (at-grade and viaduct section), the value of this view is primarily attached to the planned Ngau Tam Mei development, the open sky and settled valley landscape view. • The proposed development would	**Slight**

VP ID	Location of VPs	Sources of Visual Impact	Visual Composition	Visual Obstruction	Visual Change	Magnitude of Change (Negligible / Slight/ Moderate/ Substantial)
			Shenzhen skyline and open sky view at the background. • The backdrop consists of Long Ha Tsuen, Wai Tsuen, Wai Tsai and Yau Tam Mei Tsuen and the planned San Tin Technopole occupying the middle ground with hillside vegetation of Kai Kung Shan (+364mPD) and the planned Ngau Tam Mei development in foreground. • The visual compatibility of the proposed road works with surrounding context is considered as **High**.	Tam Mei area settled valley landscape. • The obstruction to visuals is **Slight**.	mainly obstruct the settlement partially. • Degree of visibility: **Slight** • Viewing distance: **Long** • The visual change with partial blockage of the mountain ridgeline view is consider as **Slight.**	
VP-N.9	View from Planned Roadside Amenity Area of the Ngau Tam Mei NDA	The proposed road works (at grade and viaduct section) connecting Portal A1 and associated structure including portal plant building/ plant room.	• The view is dominated by the planned Ngau Tam Mei New Development Area with the planned roadside amenity with layby area at front ground, the planned riverside open space of NTM NDA in the middle ground and the partial sky view at the background. • The visual compatibility of the proposed road works with surrounding context is considered as **High**.	• The proposed road works (viaduct section) connecting Portal A1 and Portal Plant Building/ Plant Room at Tunnel Portal will create slight visual obstruction to the existing distant view of the mountain ridgeline of Lung Tam Shan (+550mPD) and Ngau Tam Shan (+337mPD). • The proposed road works (at-grade and viaduct section) are not visible from this view due to the blockage of the planned Ngau Tam Mei development.	• Before the proposed road works (viaduct section connecting Portal A1 and Portal Plant Building/ Plant Room at Tunnel Portal, the value of this view is primarily attached to the planned Ngau Tam Mei New Development Area and partial sky view. • The proposed development will mainly obstruct the mountain ridgeline of Lung Tam Shan (+550mPD) and Ngau Tam Shan (+337mPD) view partially. • As the planned Ngau Tam Mei New Development Area occupies most of the view and the proposed	**Negligible**

VP ID	Location of VPs	Sources of Visual Impact	Visual Composition	Visual Obstruction	Visual Change	Magnitude of Change (Negligible / Slight/ Moderate/ Substantial)
				• The obstruction to visuals is **Negligible**.	road works (at-grade and viaduct section) is located behind the development, it would not change the visual composition of this view. • Degree of visibility: **Negligible** • Viewing distance: **Long** • The visual change with partial blockage of the planned Ngau Tam Mei development is consider as **Negligible**.	
VP-S.1	View from Nam Sang Wai Road	The Proposed viaduct across the Kam Tin River in the vicinity of the Interchange I/C-02, located in the Tsing Long Highway interchange.	The view is dominated by an open sky view. The existing visual composition at this VP will be existing Nam Sang Wai Road and Kam Tin River in the foreground. The lush green of Kai Kung Shan (+570mPD), Yuen Shan as well as planned residential development (under approved applications No. A/YL-NSW/293) and planned public housing at Sha Po (+185mPD) as the middle-ground, while the mountain backdrop of Tai Mo Shan (+950mPD) as well as open sky view as the background. The proposed viaduct will be located along the Tsing Long Highway and the San Tin Highway, and	The proposed viaduct along the San Tin Highway would be blocking the view of lush greenery located in the foothill of the Kai Kung Leung in the middle ground. The view of the existing Nam Sang Wai Road and Kam Tin River in the foreground and sky view in the background will remain the same. The obstruction to visuals is **Negligible**.	Visual amenity such as the riverscape of Kam Tin River and the greenery along the Nam Sang Wai Road in the foreground would be maintained. Since the proposed viaduct is relatively far away, and would be barely perceptible from this viewing point due to the distance of view (~1000m-1200m). • Degree of visibility: **Negligible** • Viewing distance: **Long** The effect on the visual change is considered as **slight**.	Slight

VP ID	Location of VPs	Sources of Visual Impact	Visual Composition	Visual Obstruction	Visual Change	Magnitude of Change (Negligible / Slight/ Moderate/ Substantial)
			is barely visible from this viewing point. The visual compatibility of the proposed road works with surrounding context is considered as **High**.			
VP-S.2	Western side of Kam Tin River adjoining Ko Po Tsuen	The Proposed viaduct across the Kam Tin River in the vicinity of the Interchange I/C-02, located in the Tsing Long Highway interchange.	The existing visual composition is largely composed by the amenity planting and the basketball in Ko Po Playground located adjacent to Ko Po Road, as the foreground. The Kam Tin River, MTR Tuen Ma Line, planned residential development (under approved applications No. A/YL-NSW/293) and the planned public housing at Sha Po (+185mPD) will be as the middle-ground, while the sky view as background. The visual compatibility of the proposed road works with surrounding context is considered as **High**.	The proposed viaduct across the Kam Tin River will not impact the path and the amenity planting in the foreground, as well as the sky view as the background. The proposed viaduct across the Tsing Long Highway will be barely perceptible from this viewing point due to the distance of view (approximately 1400m - 1600m), and the proposed viaduct will be screened off by existing Tuen Ma Line and planned residential Development (under approved applications No. A/YL-NSW/293). The obstruction to visuals is **Negligible**.	The proposed viaduct across the Kam Tin River in the vicinity of the Interchange I/C-02 will not impact existing amenity planting and riverscape view as the foreground, and would be mostly screened off by existing Tuen Ma Line and the planned residential Development (under approved applications No. A/YL-NSW/293). The effect on the visual experience is negligible. There will be nil impact to the sky view that would be experienced by viewers. • Degree of visibility: **Negligible** • Viewing distance: **Long** The effect on the visual change is considered as **Negligible**	Negligible
VP-S.3	View from Footbridge crossing San Tam Road	Proposed viaduct run parallel to the San Tin Highway.	The existing visual composition is largely composed by the footpath along San Tam Road as the foreground, and the roadside greenery and the footbridge crossing the Castle Peak Road –	The proposed viaduct will not impact upon the footpath, which located along San Tam Road, in the foreground. But some vegetation view in the middle-ground will	Public viewers at this viewing points are pedestrian traveller in the footbridge. The proposed viaduct and the pier will bring about visual changes to the public viewers.	Moderate

VP ID	Location of VPs	Sources of Visual Impact	Visual Composition	Visual Obstruction	Visual Change	Magnitude of Change (Negligible / Slight/ Moderate/ Substantial)
			Tam Mi, San Tin Highway and San Tam Road , and the planned public housing at Sha Po (+185mPD) as the middle-ground. The mountain view of the ridgeline of Kai Kung Leng (+570mPD) as well as the sky view as the background. The visual compatibility of the proposed road works with surrounding context is considered as **Medium** .	be impacted by the proposed viaduct pier. There will be a moderate visual obstruction of the sky view and mountain back drop that would be experienced by public viewers located in the footbridge. It is anticipated that it will inevitably lead to a loss of visual openness by obstructing the sky view. The obstruction to visuals is **Substantial.**	Due to the close viewing distance (less than ~50m), the effect on the visual experience of this VP due to the proposed viaduct, is considered moderately adverse. • Degree of visibility: **Moderate** • Viewing distance: **short** The effect on the visual change is considered as **Moderate**	
VP-S.4	View from Ho Hok Shan (Hiker)	Proposed viaduct running from Yuen Long to San Tin in the vicinity of the Interchange I/C-02	The existing visual composition is largely composed by the greenery in the Nam Sang Wai, Kam Tin River in the vicinity of the Interchange I/C-02 and some existing residential development, namely, Crescent Green, Riva, and Park Yoho, and Planned residential Development (under approved applications No. A/YL-NSW/293, A/YL-KTN/604) as the foreground. The plantation in Nam Sang Wai, Kam Tin and planned public housing at Sha Po as well as Kai Kung Leng (+570mPD) as the middle ground,	The proposed viaduct, along the Tsing Long Highway and San Tin Highway in the vicinity of the Interchange I/C-02, will have a visual obstruction of the greenery in the foreground and in the middle-ground. The existing sky view in the background will not be affected, and no visual obstruction will be resulted. The obstruction to visuals is **Negligible**.	Visitor to this viewing point will be mainly recreational users in the Ho Hok Shan (+140mPD), and engaging in passive recreational activities. The value of this view is the open sky view in the background. The existing view and overall visual character currently enjoyed by visitors' of Ho Hok Shan (+140mPD) would not be disturbed by the proposed viaducts. The proposed viaduct of the Interchange I/C-02 linking to the San Tin Highway would slightly alter the vegetation around the San Tin Highway, in the middle-ground.	Slight

VP ID	Location of VPs	Sources of Visual Impact	Visual Composition	Visual Obstruction	Visual Change	Magnitude of Change (Negligible / Slight/ Moderate/ Substantial)
			while, the sky view as the background. The visual compatibility of the proposed road works with surrounding context is considered as **Medium.**		• Degree of visibility: **Negligible** • Viewing distance: **Medium** The effect on the visual change is considered as **Negligible**	

10.8 Landscape and Visual Mitigation Measures

10.8.1 Mitigation measures are proposed to minimise impacts on the landscape and visual amenity of the area within the visual envelope. These measures include strategies for reducing, offsetting and compensating impacts during construction and operational phases.

10.8.2 Landscape and Aesthetic External Design Measures in the Proposed Scheme

10.8.3 The proposed landscape and visual mitigation measures, together with an indication of funding, implementation and maintenance agencies, during the construction and operational phases are listed in **Table 10.8** and **Table 10.9**. The mitigation measures proposed would be further reviewed and consents from relevant governmental department would be sought subject to the design development of the Project.

Table 10.8 Proposed Landscape Mitigation Measures for Construction Phase

ID No.	Landscape Mitigation Measures	Funding Agency	Implementation Agency*
CM1	**Tree Preservation and Transplantation** Trees without impact from the proposed works should be retained and any existing trees unavoidably affected by the works should be transplanted as far as possible in accordance with DEVB TC(W) No. 4/2020.	HyD	HyD (via Contractor)
CM2	**Erection of Decorative Screen Hoarding** Erection of decorative screen hoarding with decorative effect or planting compatible with the surrounding setting to minimise potential landscape impacts.	HyD	HyD (via Contractor)
CM3	**Management of Construction Activities and Facilities** Construction facilities and activities on work sites and areas should be carefully managed and controlled, including height and disposition /arrangement, to minimise any potential adverse landscape impacts.	HyD	HyD (via Contractor)
CM4	**Reinstatement of the Affected Landscaped Area** Reinstatement of the temporarily affected landscaped area within assessment area in like-for-like basis would be implemented to restore the existing natural environment as far as possible.	HyD	HyD (via Contractor)

ID No.	Landscape Mitigation Measures	Funding Agency	Implementation Agency*
CM5	**Minimize the Direct Conflict with Lam Tsuen Country Park & Conservation Area** The optimum alignment of proposed road works is carefully designed to minimize direct conflict with the Lam Tsuen Country Park and Conservation area. The works area of road works and associated slope works shall be minimized and confined to avoid any unnecessary vegetation loss in the adjacent Country Park and Conservation area.	HyD	HyD (via Contractor)
CM6	**Minimize Disturbance on Watercourses/Wetlands** The design shall minimize disturbance on watercourses/wetlands, particularly for natural watercourse/wetlands. Good site practices as described in ETWB TCW No. 5/2005 "Protection of natural streams/rivers from adverse impacts arising from construction works" shall also be adopted to avoid any pollution entering the watercourses nearby where applicable. Should temporarily or indirect disturbance on watercourse is unavoidable, it shall be reinstated to the satisfaction of relevant Government Departments.	HyD	HyD (via Contractor)

Note: "CM" stands for mitigation measure for construction phase.

Table 10.9 Proposed Landscape and Visual Mitigation Measures for Operational Phase

ID No.	Landscape and Visual Mitigation Measures	Funding Agency	Implementation Agency	Maintenance/ Management Agency*
OM1	**Aesthetically Pleasing Design of Aboveground Structures** The aboveground structures such as tunnel portals, portal plant building/ plant rooms and associated buildings etc. in the regard of layouts, forms, materials and finishes shall be sensitively designed so as to blend in the structures to the adjacent landscape and visual context. ACABAS submission upon completion of conceptual design should be in accordance with ETWB TCW No. 36/2004 – The Advisory Committee on the	HyD	HyD (via Contractor)	HyD

ID No.	Landscape and Visual Mitigation Measures	Funding Agency	Implementation Agency	Maintenance/ Management Agency*
	Appearance of Bridges and Associated Structures (ACABAS). Aesthetic treatment and Design of the noise mitigation measures, building and tunnel ventilation shaft should be vetted and advised upon by ArchSD in accordance with ETWB TCW No. 8/2005 – Aesthetic Design of Ancillary Buildings in Engineering Projects.			
OM2	**Aesthetically pleasing design of Highways Structures or Slope Associated Structures** Highways Structures such as viaducts proposed shall be sensitively designed in the regard of form, tonal colour and texture so as to minimise any potential adverse landscape and visual impact. The slope associated structures such as proposed retaining structures shall be sensitively designed to minizine the extend of structure and to break down the monotonous façade with use of natural material, unobtrusive colour or texture to blend in the retaining structures to the adjacent landscape and visual context.	HyD	HyD (via Contractor)	HyD
OM3	**Compensatory Tree Planting** As far as practicable, compensatory tree planting requirement of 1:1 in terms of number in accordance with DEVB TC(W) No. 4/2020 for compensation of felled trees subject to agreement made with relevant departmental parties.	HyD	HyD (via Contractor)	HyD / LCSD

ID No.	Landscape and Visual Mitigation Measures	Funding Agency	Implementation Agency	Maintenance/ Management Agency*
OM4	**Buffer Screen Planting / Roadside Planting** Buffer Planting shall be provided at the perimeter of the Portal Areas to screen and soften the proposed Aboveground Structures. Combination of shrub and groundcover, with tree planting as far as practicable, will be planted to enhance the buffer and screening effect.	HyD	HyD (via Contractor)	HyD / LCSD
OM5	**Landscape Treatments on Slope or Retaining Structure** Landscape treatments on slope or retaining structure in accordance with GEO Publication No. 1/2011 – Technical Guidelines on Landscape Treatment for Slopes shall be adopted subject to agreement made with relevant departmental parties. All aesthetic treatment shall seek the committee's view in accordance with the ETWB TCW No. 36/2004 – The Advisory Committee on the Appearance of Bridges and Associated Structures (ACABAS). Woodland Mix Planting with tree whips shall be proposed as far as practicable. On slope with gradient not suitable for whip tree planting, combination of shrub/groundcover mix shall be applied to new soil cut and fill slopes in accordance with technical guidelines set out in GEO Publication No. 1/2011 at the tunnel portals and the affected slopes along the road improvement works. Use of native species shall be maximized as far as possible in accordance with the Guiding Principles on Use of Native Plant Species	HyD	HyD (via Contractor)	HyD

ID No.	Landscape and Visual Mitigation Measures	Funding Agency	Implementation Agency	Maintenance/ Management Agency*
	in Public Works Projects issued by DEVB to improve the habitat complexity and quality.			
OM6	**Post-Planting Monitoring** Post-planting monitoring of the compensatory trees shall be undertaken (namely, duration of the post-planting monitoring and monitoring methodology). The monitoring will be aimed to assess the success and performance of the compensatory planting trees, monitor the growth performance of the planted seedlings and whips, and identify any need of vegetation and site maintenance work. All monthly record photos shall be prepared by a tree specialist or a qualified arborist and endorsed by a registered Landscape Architect (RLA).	HyD	HyD (via Contractor)	HyD
OM7	**Reinstatement of disturbed Open Space** In case any existing open space or sitting out area will be impacted upon during construction stage, all affected area will be reinstated and / or upgraded to integrate with the existing site context. Further, the landscape areas disturbed temporarily during construction due to temporary excavations, temporary works sites shall be reinstated to equal or better quality, to the satisfaction of the relevant Government Departments.	HyD	HyD (via Contractor)	LCSD
OM8	**Incorporation of Green Roof** Roof Greening should be proposed to the roof area of the proposed building works	HyD	HyD (via Contractor)	Tunnel Operator as management party and ArchSD as

ID No.	Landscape and Visual Mitigation Measures	Funding Agency	Implementation Agency	Maintenance/ Management Agency*
	as far as practical to enhance the landscape quality of the structures and mitigate any potential visual impact on adjacent VSRs. All new building works are required to achieve the minimum standards and requirements on Site Coverage of Greenery in Table 1 of DEVB TC(W) No. 3/2012 – Site Coverage of Greenery for Government Building Projects.			maintenance agency
OM9	**Sensitive design of noise barriers** The proposed noise barriers & enclosures shall be design in an elegant manner that includes suitable combination of transparent and sound absorbent materials, appropriate colour selection of panels and supporting structures, or provision of at-grade planting of trees, shrubs and/or climbers. Aesthetic treatment and Design of the noise mitigation measures should be vetted and advised upon by ACABAS in accordance with ETWB TCW No. 36/2004 – The Advisory Committee on the Appearance of Bridges and Associated Structures (ACABAS).	HyD	HyD (via Contractor)	HyD / LCSD

* Remarks: "OM" stands for mitigation measure for operational phase. The arrangement of management / maintenance agencies is subject to agreement with corresponding departments/parties in accordance with DEVB TCW No. 6/2015.

10.8.3.1 The construction phase mitigation measures listed above should be adopted from the commencement of construction and should be in place throughout the entire construction period. The operational phase mitigation measures listed above should be adopted during the detailed design and should be built as part of the construction works so that they are in place at the date of commissioning of the Project. However, it should be noted that the full effect of the soft landscape mitigation measures would not be appreciated for several years.

10.8.3.2 Viewpoint locations of the photomontages are shown in **Figure 10.4.0**. The photomontages intend to demonstrate only the scale and massing of the Project and the effect of the proposed mitigation measures. The architectural design finishes or any other related detailed design components are subject to refinement and changes during the detailed design stage. Photomontages of the Project without and with mitigation measures illustrating the appearance of the Project are shown in **Figures 10.4.1** to **10.4.13**.

10.9 Landscape and Visual Impacts

10.9.1.1 Subject to the design development, the landscape impacts and visual impacts were assessed and presented in the table format with brief description in this LVIA submission in line with the latest design development of the Project.

10.9.2 Landscape Resources

LR-1.01 Woodland

10.9.2.1 Permanent and irreversible impact is expected to LR-1.01 (Woodland) due to the construction works of NM Highway San Tin Section, including slope cutting, at-grade and viaduct carriageway and associated road works in the northern side of the hillside of Kai Kung Shan. Approximate 2.1 ha (17% of this LR) is expected to be lost. Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are affected within this LR. Proposed new planting (OM3 and OM5) is proposed to compensate for the area. A small portion (approx. 2 ha) of Conservation Area is affected within this LR. The alignment of proposed at-grade road and viaduct are carefully designed to minimize the works extent and avoid encroachment on Lam Tsuen Country Park (CM3 and CM5). Since it would take more than 10 years to establish the woodland. It is considered that residual impact on this LR would be **Moderate** during the construction phase and reduced to **Slight** in operation with the implementation of mitigation measures after establishment of the compensatory planting.

LR-1.02 Hillside Vegetation

10.9.2.2 Permanent and irreversible impact is expected to LR-1.02 (Hillside Vegetation) due to the construction works of NM Highway San Tin Section, including slope cutting, at-grade and viaduct carriageway and associated road works in the northern side of the hillside of Kai Kung Shan. Approximate 0.1 ha (2% of this LR) is expected to be lost. A small part (approx. 0.1 ha) of Conservation area is affected. Proposed new planting (OM3 and OM5) is proposed to compensate for the area. Since it would take more than 10 years to establish the woodland. It is considered that residual impact on this LR would be **Moderate** during the construction phase and reduced to **Slight** in operation with the implementation of mitigation measures after establishment of the compensatory planting.

LR-1.03 Shrub / Grassland

10.9.2.3 Permanent and irreversible impact is expected to LR-1.03 (Shrub / Grassland) due to construction works of NM Highway San Tin Section, including slope cutting, at-grade and viaduct carriageway and associated road works in the northern side of the hillside of Kai Kung Shan. Approximate 0.05 ha (1% of this LR) is expected to be lost. A small part (approx. 0.04 ha) of Conservation Area is affected. The alignment of proposed at-grade road and viaduct are carefully designed to minimize

the works extent and avoid encroachment on Lam Tsuen Country Park (CM3 and CM5). Proposed new planting (OM3 and OM5) is proposed to compensate for the area. It is considered that residual impact on this LR would be **Slight** during the construction phase and in operation with the implementation of mitigation measures (OM4, OM5).

LR-1.04 Vegetation in Village / Rural Area

10.9.2.4 Permanent and irreversible impact is expected to LR-1.04 (Vegetation in Village / Rural Area) due to the work sites for the construction works of NM Highway San Tin Section, including slope cutting, at-grade and viaduct carriageway and associated road works along San Tin Highway and in the vicinity of Fung Kat Heung and along San Tam Road. Approximate 2 ha (7% of this LR) is expected to be lost. Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are affected within this LR. A small part (0.02 ha) of Conservation Area in the vicinity of Pak Wai is affected. Proposed new planting (OM3 and OM5) is proposed to compensate for the area. It is considered that residual impact on this LR would be **Slight** during the construction phase and in operation with the implementation of mitigation measures.

LR-1.05 Roadside vegetation

10.9.2.5 Permanent and irreversible impact is expected to LR-1.05 (Roadside vegetation) due to the construction works of NM Highway San Tin Section, including slope cutting, at-grade and viaduct carriageway and associated road works along San Tin Highway. Approximate 5 ha (12% of this LR) is expected to be lost. Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are affected within this LR. Proposed new planting is proposed to compensate for the area (OM3 and OM4). This planting will be established after 10 years. It is considered that residual impact on this LR would be **Slight** during the construction phase and in operation with the implementation of mitigation measures.

LR-1.06 Vegetation in Wasteland / Open Storage

10.9.2.6 Permanent and irreversible impact is expected to LR-1.06 (Vegetation in Wasteland / Open Storage) due to the construction of the viaduct pier along San Tin Highway. Approximate 0.1 ha (1% of this LR) is expected to be lost. Proposed new planting (OM4) is proposed to compensate for the greenery. It is considered that residual impact on this LR would be **Negligible** during the construction phase and in operation with the implementation of mitigation measures.

LR-1.10 Vegetation Along Watercourse

10.9.2.7 Permanent and irreversible impact is expected to LR-1.10 (Vegetation Along Watercourse) due to construction work sites for the construction works of the pier of NM Highway San Tin Section across the Kam Tin River channel. Approximate 0.4 ha (4% of this LR) is expected to be lost. It is considered that residual impact on this LR would be **Slight** during the construction phase and in operation with the implementation of mitigation measures (OM3).

10.9.2.8 It is predicted that there would not be any impact on LR-1.07 (Landscape Area in Developed Area), LR-1.11 (Vegetation in Wetland Area), and LR-1.12 (Pond).

LR-2.01 Woodland

10.9.2.9 During the construction stage, the proposed temporary works, including slope cutting, site formation of tunnel section, at-grade and viaduct carriageway, would potentially affect LR-2.01 (Woodland). Existing vegetation would also be potentially affected temporarily. Approximately 0.4 ha (3% of this LR) is expected to be lost.

10.9.2.10 Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are affected within this LR. The alignment of proposed road works is carefully designed to minimize the works extent and avoid encroachment on Trees of particular interest (TPIs) (CM3).

10.9.2.11 Permanent and irreversible impact is expected due to permanent structure of at-grade section highway and Interchange I/C-03 connecting to Development at Ngau Tam Mei Area and permanent structure of ancillary works. Upon the completion of works, the affected vegetation would be reinstated. Considered that the sensitivity of this LR is identified as **High** while the magnitude of change on this LR due to the Project is considered as **Slight**, it is considered that residual impact on this LR would be **Moderate** during the construction phase and **Slight** in operational phase with the implementation of mitigation measures (CM1, CM2, CM3, CM4, CM5 and OM3, OM4, OM5 respectively)

LR-2.02 Hillside vegetation

10.9.2.12 During the construction stage, the proposed temporary works, including slope cutting, site formation of tunnel section, at-grade and viaduct carriageway, would potentially affect LR-2.02 (Hillside vegetation). Existing vegetation would also be potentially affected temporarily. Approximately 2.2 ha (7% of this LR) is expected to be lost.

10.9.2.13 Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are affected within this LR. Approx. 0.2 ha of the conservation area (0.01% of LR) would be affected within this LR. The alignment of proposed road works is carefully designed to minimize the works extent and avoid encroachment on Conservation area (CM3 and CM5).

10.9.2.14 Permanent and irreversible impact is expected due to permanent structure of at-grade section highway and Interchange I/C-03 connecting to Development at Ngau Tam Mei Area and permanent structure of ancillary works. Upon the completion of works, the affected vegetation would be reinstated. Considered that the sensitivity of this LR is identified as **High** while the magnitude of change on this LR due to the Project is considered as **Slight**, it is considered that residual impact on this LR would be **Moderate** during the construction phase and **Slight** in operational phase with the implementation of mitigation measures (CM2, CM3, CM4 and OM2, OM3, OM4, OM5 respectively).

LR-2.03 Shrubland/ Grassland

10.9.2.15 During the construction stage, the proposed temporary works, including slope cutting, site formation of at-grade and viaduct carriageway, would potentially affect LR-2.03 (Shrubland/ Grassland). Existing vegetation would also be potentially affected temporarily. Approximately 1.6 ha (10% of LR) is expected to be lost.

10.9.2.16 Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are affected within this LR. Nil conservation area would be affected within this LR. The alignment of proposed road works is carefully designed to minimize the works extent and avoid encroachment on Conservation area (CM3 and CM5).

10.9.2.17 Permanent and irreversible impact is expected due to permanent structure of at-grade and tunnel section highway at Ngau Tam Shan. Upon the completion of works, the affected vegetation would be reinstated. Considered that the sensitivity of this LR is identified as **Medium** while the magnitude of change on this LR due to the Project is considered as **Slight**, it is considered that residual impact on this LR would be **Slight** during the construction phase and **Negligible** in operational phase with the implementation of mitigation measures (CM2, CM3, CM4 and OM3, OM5, OM6) respectively).

LR-2.04 Vegetation in village/ rural area

10.9.2.18 During the construction stage, the proposed temporary works, including slope cutting, site formation of at-grade and viaduct carriageway and associated road works, would potentially affect LR-2.04 (Vegetation in village/ rural area). Existing vegetation would also be potentially affected temporarily. Approximately 3.7 ha (7% of LR) is expected to be lost.

10.9.2.19 Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are affected within this LR. The alignment of proposed road works is carefully designed to minimize the works extent and avoid encroachment to Trees of particular interest (TPIs) (CM3).

10.9.2.20 Permanent and irreversible impact is expected due to permanent structure of at-grade and viaduct section highway and Interchange I/C-03 connecting to Development at Ngau Tam Mei Area and permanent structure of ancillary works, namely Administration building. Upon the completion of works, the affected vegetation would be reinstated. Considered that the sensitivity of this LR is identified as Medium while the magnitude of change on this LR due to the Project is considered as **Slight**, it is considered that residual impact on this LR would be **Slight** during the construction phase and **Negligible** in operational phase with the implementation of mitigation measures (CM1, CM2, CM3, CM4 and OM3, OM5, OM6, OM9 respectively).

LR-2.05 Roadside Vegetation

10.9.2.21 During the construction stage, the proposed temporary works, including slope cutting, site formation of at-grade and viaduct carriageway and associated road works, would potentially affect LR-2.05 (Roadside Vegetation). Existing vegetation would also be potentially affected temporarily. Approximately 0.5 ha (14% of LR) is expected to be lost.

10.9.2.22 Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are affected within this LR. Nil conservation area would be affected within this LR. The alignment of proposed road works is designed to minimize the works extent and avoid encroachment on Conservation area (CM3 and CM5).

10.9.2.23 Permanent and irreversible impact is expected due to permanent structure of at-grade and viaduct section highway. Upon the completion of works, the affected vegetation would be reinstated. Considered that the sensitivity of this LR is identified as **Low** while the magnitude of change on this LR due to the Project is considered as **Moderate**, it is considered that residual impact on this LR would be **Slight** during the construction phase and **Negligible** in operational phase with the implementation of mitigation measures (CM1, CM2, CM3, CM4 and OM3, OM4 respectively).

LR-2.06 Vegetation in wasteland/ open storage

10.9.2.24 The landscape resource of LR-2.06 Vegetation in wasteland/ open storage is identified primarily on both the western and eastern valleys of Ki Lun Shan Au. The sensitivity of this LR is identified as **Low**. Since no works would be proposed during both construction and operational phases, hence the magnitude of change on this LR due to the Project is considered as **Negligible**. The resultant unmitigated impact during construction and operational phases is **Negligible**

LR-2.07 Landscape area in Developed Area

10.9.2.25 The landscape resource of LR-2.07 Landscape area in Developed Area is identified primarily north of Kai Kung Shan. The sensitivity of this LR is identified as **Low**. Since no temporary work or permanent work would be proposed during both construction and operational phases, hence the magnitude of change on this LR due to the Project is considered as **Negligible**. The resultant unmitigated impact during construction and operational phases is **Negligible**

LR-2.09 Landscape area in Ngau Tam Mei Water Treatment Works

10.9.2.26 The landscape resource of LR-2.09 Landscape area in Ngau Tam Mei Water Treatment Works is identified on the engineered slope surrounding Ngau Tam Mei Water Treatment Works between hillside vegetation of west Ngau Tam Shan and vegetation in Yau Tam Mei area. The sensitivity of this LR is identified as **Low**. Since no temporary work or permanent work would be proposed during both construction and operational phases, hence the magnitude of change on this LR due to the Project is considered as **Negligible**. The resultant unmitigated impact during construction and operational phases is **Negligible**

LR-2.10 Watercourse

10.9.2.27 During the construction stage, the proposed temporary works, including slope cutting, site formation of tunnel, at-grade and viaduct carriageway and associated road works, would potentially affect LR-2.10 (Watercourse). Existing vegetation would also be potentially affected temporarily. Approximately 0.1 ha (6% of LR) is expected to be lost.

10.9.2.28 Permanent and irreversible impact is expected due to permanent structure of at-grade and tunnel section highway at Ngau Tam Shan. Upon the completion of works, the affected vegetation would be reinstated. Considered that the sensitivity of this LR is identified as **Medium** while the magnitude of change on this LR due to the Project is considered as **Slight**, it is considered that residual impact on this LR would be **Slight** during the construction phase and **Negligible** in operational phase

with the implementation of mitigation measures (CM2, CM3, CM4, CM6 and OM1, OM4 respectively).

LR-2.11 Wetland/ Marsh/ Reed

10.9.2.29 During the construction stage, the proposed temporary works, including slope cutting, site formation of at-grade and viaduct carriageway and associated road works, would potentially affect LR-2.11 (Wetland/ Marsh/ Reed). Existing vegetation would also be potentially affected temporarily. Approximately 0.1 ha (8% of LR) is expected to be lost.

10.9.2.30 Permanent and irreversible impact is expected due to permanent structure of at-grade and viaduct section highway. Upon the completion of works, the affected vegetation would be reinstated. Considered that the sensitivity of this LR is identified as **High** while the magnitude of change on this LR due to the Project is considered as **Moderate**, it is considered that residual impact on this LR would be **Moderate** during the construction phase and **Slight** in operational phase with the implementation of mitigation measures (CM2, CM3, CM4, CM6 and OM1, OM4 respectively).

LR-2.12 Pond

10.9.2.31 During the construction stage, the proposed temporary works, including slope cutting, site formation of at-grade and viaduct carriageway and associated road works, would potentially affect LR-2.12 (Pond). Existing vegetation would also be potentially affected temporarily. Approximately 0.4 ha (8% of LR) is expected to be lost.

10.9.2.32 Permanent and irreversible impact is expected due to permanent structure of at-grade and viaduct section highway. Upon the completion of works, the affected vegetation would be reinstated. Considered that the sensitivity of this LR is identified as **Medium** while the magnitude of change on this LR due to the Project is considered as **Moderate**, it is considered that residual impact on this LR would be **Moderate** during the construction phase and **Slight** in operational phase with the implementation of mitigation measures (OM1, OM4).

LR-3.01 Woodland

10.9.2.33 During the construction stage, the proposed temporary works, including slope cutting, site formation of at-grade carriageway, would potentially affect LR-3.01 (Woodland). Existing vegetation would also be potentially affected temporarily. Approximately 1.9 ha (0.2% of this LR) is expected to be lost.

10.9.2.34 Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are affected within this LR. The alignment of proposed road works is carefully designed to minimize the works extent and avoid encroachment on Trees of particular interest (TPIs) (CM3).

10.9.2.35 Permanent and irreversible impact is expected due to permanent structure of at-grade section highway. Upon the completion of works, the affected vegetation would be reinstated. Considered that the sensitivity of this LR is identified as **High** while the magnitude of change on this LR due to the Project is considered as **Slight**, it is considered that residual impact on this LR would be **Moderate** during the construction phase and **Slight** in operational phase with the implementation of

mitigation measures (CM1, CM2, CM3, CM4, CM5 and OM3, OM4, OM5 respectively)

LR-3.02 Hillside vegetation

10.9.2.36 During the construction stage, the proposed temporary works, including slope cutting, site formation of at-grade and viaduct carriageway, would potentially affect LR-3.02 (Hillside vegetation). Existing vegetation would also be potentially affected temporarily. Approximately 1.1 ha (8% of LR) is expected to be lost.

10.9.2.37 Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are affected within this LR. Nil conservation area would be affected within this LR. The alignment of proposed road works is carefully designed to minimize the works extent and avoid encroachment on Conservation area (CM3 and CM5).

10.9.2.38 Permanent and irreversible impact is expected due to permanent structure of at-grade and viaduct section highway and Interchange I/C-05 connecting to Fanling Highway near Pak Shek Au and I/C-06 connecting to Kwu Tung North New Development Area. Upon the completion of works, the affected vegetation would be reinstated. Considered that the sensitivity of this LR is identified as **High** while the magnitude of change on this LR due to the Project is considered as **Moderate**, it is considered that residual impact on this LR would be **Moderate** during the construction phase and **Slight** in operational phase with the implementation of mitigation measures (CM1, CM2, CM3, CM4 and OM3, OM4, OM5 respectively).

LR-3.03 Shrubland/ Grassland

10.9.2.39 During the construction stage, the proposed temporary works, including slope cutting, site formation of tunnel section, at-grade and viaduct carriageway and associated road works, would potentially affect LR-3.03 (Hillside vegetation). Existing vegetation would also be potentially affected temporarily. Approximately 4 ha (5% of LR) is expected to be lost.

10.9.2.40 Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are affected within this LR. Approx. 0.8 ha of the conservation area (0.01% of LR) would be affected within this LR. The alignment of proposed road works is carefully designed to minimize the works extent and avoid encroachment on Conservation area (CM3 and CM5).

10.9.2.41 Permanent and irreversible impact is expected due to permanent structure of tunnel, at-grade and viaduct section highway and Interchange I/C-04 connecting to San Tin Technopole, I/C-05 connecting to Fanling Highway near Pak Shek Au and I/C-06 connecting to Kwu Tung North New Development Area. Upon the completion of works, the affected vegetation would be reinstated. Considered that the sensitivity of this LR is identified as **Medium** while the magnitude of change on this LR due to the Project is considered as **Slight**, it is considered that residual impact on this LR would be **Slight** during the construction phase and **Negligible** in operational phase with the implementation of mitigation measures (CM2, CM3, CM4 and OM2, OM3, OM4, OM5 respectively).

LR-3.04 Vegetation in village/ rural area

10.9.2.42 During the construction stage, the proposed temporary works, including slope cutting, site formation of tunnel section, at-grade and viaduct carriageway and

associated road works, would potentially affect LR-3.04 (Vegetation in village/ rural area). Existing vegetation would also be potentially affected temporarily. Approximately 3.3 ha (12% of LR) is expected to be lost.

10.9.2.43 Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are affected within this LR. Nil conservation area would be affected within this LR. The alignment of proposed road works is carefully designed to minimize the works extent and avoid encroachment on Conservation area (CM3 and CM5).

10.9.2.44 Permanent and irreversible impact is expected due to permanent structure of at-grade and viaduct section highway and Interchange I/C-04 connecting to San Tin Technopole. Upon the completion of works, the affected vegetation would be reinstated. Considered that the sensitivity of this LR is identified as **Medium** while the magnitude of change on this LR due to the Project is considered as **Moderate**, it is considered that residual impact on this LR would be **Moderate** during the construction phase and **Slight** in operational phase with the implementation of mitigation measures (CM1, CM2, CM3, CM4 and OM3, OM5, OM6, OM9 respectively).

LR-3.05 Roadside Vegetation

10.9.2.45 During the construction stage, the proposed temporary works, including slope cutting, site formation of viaduct carriageway and associated road works, would potentially affect LR-3.05 (Roadside Vegetation). Existing vegetation would also be potentially affected temporarily. Approximately 0.5 ha (12% of this LR) is expected to be lost.

10.9.2.46 Permanent and irreversible impact is expected due to permanent structure of viaduct section highway and Interchange I/C-05 connecting to Fanling Highway near Pak Shek Au. Upon the completion of works, the affected vegetation would be reinstated. Considered that the sensitivity of this LR is identified as **Low** while the magnitude of change on this LR due to the Project is considered as **Moderate**, it is considered that residual impact on this LR would be **Moderate** during the construction phase and **Slight** in operational phase with the implementation of mitigation measures (CM1, CM2, CM3, CM4 and OM3, OM4 respectively).

LR-3.06 Vegetation in wasteland/ open storage

10.9.2.47 During the construction stage, the proposed temporary works, including at-grade carriageway and associated road works, would potentially affect LR-3.06 (Vegetation in wasteland/ open storage). Existing vegetation would also be potentially affected temporarily. Approximately 0.4 ha (6% of LR) is expected to be lost.

10.9.2.48 Permanent and irreversible impact is expected due to permanent structure of at-grade section highway and Interchange I/C-04 connecting to San Tin Technopole and I/C-06 connecting to Kwu Tung North New Development Area. Upon the completion of works, the affected vegetation would be reinstated. Considered that the sensitivity of this LR is identified as **Low** while the magnitude of change on this LR due to the Project is considered as **Slight**, it is considered that residual impact on this LR would be **Slight** during the construction phase and **Negligible** in operational phase with the implementation of mitigation measures (CM2, CM3, CM4 and OM2, OM3, OM4, OM5 respectively).

LR-3.07 Landscape area in Developed Area

10.9.2.49 During the construction stage, the proposed temporary works, including at-grade carriageway and associated road works, would potentially affect LR-3.07 (Landscape area in Developed Area). Existing vegetation would also be potentially affected temporarily. Approximately 0.1 ha (1% of LR) is expected to be lost.

10.9.2.50 Nil conservation area would be affected within this LR. The alignment of proposed road works is carefully designed to minimize the works extent and avoid encroachment on Conservation area (CM3 and CM5).

10.9.2.51 Permanent and irreversible impact is expected due to permanent structure of at-grade and viaduct section highway of Interchange I/C-05 and I/C-06 connecting to Kwu Tung North New Development Area. Upon the completion of works, the affected vegetation would be reinstated. Considered that the sensitivity of this LR is identified as **Low** while the magnitude of change on this LR due to the Project is considered as **Slight**, it is considered that residual impact on this LR would be **Slight** during the construction phase and **Negligible** in operational phase with the implementation of mitigation measures (CM2, CM3, CM4 and OM3, OM5, OM6, OM9 respectively).

LR-3.08 Landscape area in LCSD Sitting-out area/ park

10.9.2.52 The landscape resource of LR-3.08 Landscape area in LCSD Sitting-out area/ park is identified at foothill of Kai Kung Shan, such as, Ki Lun Tsuen Playground and Basketball court, located at Ki Lun Tsuen. The sensitivity of this LR is identified as **Low**. Since no temporary work or permanent work would be proposed during both construction and operational phases, hence the magnitude of change on this LR due to the Project is considered as **Negligible**. The resultant unmitigated impact during construction and operational phases is **Negligible**.

LR-3.09 Landscape Area in Kwu Tung Reservoir

10.9.2.53 The landscape resource of LR-3.09 Landscape Area in Kwu Tung Reservoir is identified as the waterbody of Kwu Tung Reservoir and vegetation planted surrounding the Reservoir. The sensitivity of this LR is identified as **Low**. Since no temporary work or permanent work would be proposed during both construction and operational phases, hence the magnitude of change on this LR due to the Project is considered as **Negligible**. The resultant unmitigated impact during construction and operational phases is **Negligible**.

LR-3.10 Watercourse

10.9.2.54 The landscape resource of LR-3.10 Watercourse is identified in areas of hillside at Ki Lun Shan Au. The sensitivity of this LR is identified as **Low**. Since no temporary work or permanent work would be proposed during both construction and operational phases, hence the magnitude of change on this LR due to the Project is considered as **Negligible**. The resultant unmitigated impact during construction and operational phases is **Negligible**.

LR-3.12 Pond

10.9.2.55 During the construction stage, the proposed temporary works, including viaduct carriageway and associated road works, would potentially affect LR-3.07

(Landscape area in Developed Area). Existing vegetation would also be potentially affected temporarily. Approximately 0.2 ha (34% of LR) is expected to be lost.

10.9.2.56 Permanent and irreversible impact is expected due to permanent structure of at-grade and viaduct section highway of Interchange I/C-05 and I/C-06 connecting to Kwu Tung North New Development Area. Upon the completion of works, the affected vegetation would be reinstated. Considered that the sensitivity of this LR is identified as **Medium** while the magnitude of change on this LR due to the Project is considered as **Moderate**, it is considered that residual impact on this LR would be **Moderate** during the construction phase and **Slight** in operational phase with the implementation of mitigation measures (CM2, CM3, CM4, CM6 and OM1, OM4 respectively).

10.9.3 Landscape Character Areas

LCA-1.2 - Upland and Hillside Landscape

10.9.3.1 Permanent and irreversible impact is expected to LCA-1.2 (Upland and Hillside Landscape) due to the construction works of NM Highway San Tin Section, including slope cutting, at-grade and viaduct carriageway and associated road works in the northern side of the hillside of Kai Kung Shan. Approximate 2.4 ha (11% of this LCA) is expected to be lost. The alignment of proposed at-grade road and viaduct are carefully designed to minimize the works extent and avoid encroachment on Lam Tsuen Country Park (CM3 and CM5). Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are affected within this LCA. Part of the Conservation Area located in the northern side of Kai Kung Shan, which is approx. 2.1 ha, would be affected. Proposed new planting (OM3 and OM5) is proposed to compensate for the area. It is considered that residual impact on this LCA would be **Moderate** during the construction phase and reduced to **Slight** in operation with the implementation of mitigation measures after establishment of the compensatory planting (OM3,OM5 and OM6).

LCA-1.3- Rural Inland Plain Landscape

10.9.3.2 Permanent and irreversible impact is expected to LCA-1.3 (Rural Inland Plain Landscape) due to construction works of NM Highway San Tin Section, including slope cutting, at-grade and viaduct carriageway and associated road works in the northern side of the hillside of Kai Kung Shan. Approximately 0.3 ha (2% of this LCA) is expected to be lost. Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are affected within this LCA. Small patches (0.05ha) of Conservation Area located in the foothill of Kai Kung Leng would be affected. It is considered that residual impact on this LCA would be **Slight** during the construction phase and reduced to **Negligible** in operation with the implementation of mitigation measures after establishment of the compensatory planting (OM3,OM5 and OM6).

LCA-1.5 Miscellaneous Rural Fringe Landscape

10.9.3.3 Permanent and irreversible impact is expected to LCA-1.5 (Miscellaneous Rural Fringe Landscape) due to construction works of NM Highway San Tin Section, including slope cutting, at-grade and viaduct carriageway and associated road works along San Tin Highway and in the vicinity of Fung Kat Heung and along San Tam Road. Approximate 3.3 ha (5% of this LCA) is expected to be lost. Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are affected within this LCA. Conservation Area is

identified in this LCA, in which a very small part (approx. 0.02ha) in the vicinity of Pak Wai would be affected. It is considered that residual impact on this LCA would be **Slight** during the construction phase and reduced to **Negligible** in operation with the implementation of mitigation measures after establishment of the compensatory planting (OM3,OM5 and OM6).

LCA-1.8 Transportation Corridor Landscape

10.9.3.4 Permanent and irreversible impact is expected to LCA-1.8 (Transportation Corridor Landscape) due to construction works of NM Highway San Tin Section, including slope cutting, at-grade and viaduct carriageway and associated road works along San Tin Highway. Approximate 4.3 ha (14% of this LCA) is expected to be lost. Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are affected within this LCA. It is considered that residual impact on this LCA would be **Slight** during the construction phase and reduced to **Negligible** in operation with the implementation of mitigation measures after establishment of the compensatory planting (OM3,OM5 and OM6).

10.9.3.5 It is predicted that there would not be any impact on LCA-1.7 Comprehensive Residential Development Landscape.

LCA-2.2 Upland and Hillside Landscape

10.9.3.6 During the construction stage, the proposed temporary works, including slope cutting, site formation of tunnel section, at-grade and viaduct carriageway and associated road works, would potentially affect LCA-2.2 (Upland and Hillside Landscape). Existing vegetation would also be potentially affected temporarily. Approximately 5.0 ha (7% of LCA) is expected to be lost.

10.9.3.7 Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are affected within this LCA. Approx. 0.2 ha of the conservation area (0.002% of LR) would be affected within this LCA. The alignment of proposed road works is carefully designed to minimize the works extent and avoid encroachment on Lam Tsuen Country Park and Conservation area (CM3 and CM5).

10.9.3.8 Permanent and irreversible impact is expected due to permanent structure of tunnel, at-grade and viaduct section highway and permanent structure of ancillary works, namely Portal plant building/ plant room. Upon the completion of works, the affected vegetation would be reinstated. Considered that the sensitivity of this LCA is identified as **High** while the magnitude of change on this LCA due to the Project is considered as **Slight**, it is considered that residual impact on this LCA would be **Slight** during the construction phase and **Negligible** in operational phase with the implementation of mitigation measures (CM1, CM2, CM3, CM4, CM5 and OM1, OM2. OM3, OM4, OM5 respectively).

LCA-2.3 Rural Inland Plain Landscape

10.9.3.9 During the construction stage, the proposed temporary works, including at-grade and viaduct carriageway and associated road works, would potentially affect LCA-2.3 (Rural Inland Plain Landscape). Existing vegetation would also be potentially affected temporarily. Approximately 1.0 ha (10% of LCA) is expected to be lost.

10.9.3.10 Permanent and irreversible impact is expected due to permanent structure of tunnel, at-grade and viaduct section highway. Upon the completion of works, the affected vegetation would be reinstated. Considered that the sensitivity of this LCA is identified as **Medium** while the magnitude of change on this LCA due to the Project is considered as **Moderate**, it is considered that residual impact on this LCA would be **Moderate** during the construction phase and **Slight** in operational phase with the implementation of mitigation measures (CM1, CM2, CM3, CM4 and OM1, OM2. OM3, OM4, OM5, OM8 respectively).

LCA-2.4 Urban Peripheral Village Landscape

10.9.3.11 During the construction stage, the proposed temporary works, including at-grade and viaduct carriageway and associated road works of Interchange I/C-03 connecting to Development at Ngau Tam Mei Area and permanent structure of ancillary works, namely Administration building, would potentially affect LCA-2.4 (Urban Peripheral Village Landscape). Existing vegetation would also be potentially affected temporarily. Approximately 2.4 ha (11% of LCA) is expected to be lost.

10.9.3.12 Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are affected within this LCA. Nil conservation area would be affected within this LCA. The alignment of proposed road works is carefully designed to minimize the works extent and avoid encroachment on Conservation area (CM3 and CM5).

10.9.3.13 Permanent and irreversible impact is expected due to permanent structure of tunnel, at-grade and viaduct section highway. Upon the completion of works, the affected vegetation would be reinstated. Considered that the sensitivity of this LCA is identified as **Medium** while the magnitude of change on this LCA due to the Project is considered as **Slight**, it is considered that residual impact on this LCA would be **Slight** during the construction phase and **Negligible** in operational phase with the implementation of mitigation measures (CM1, CM2, CM3, CM4 and OM1, OM2. OM3, OM4, OM5, OM8 respectively).

LCA-2.5 Miscellaneous Rural Fringe Landscape

10.9.3.14 During the construction stage, the proposed temporary works, including viaduct carriageway and associated road works, would potentially affect LCA-2.5 (Miscellaneous Rural Fringe Landscape). Existing vegetation would also be potentially affected temporarily. Approximately 0.9 ha (5% of LCA) is expected to be lost.

10.9.3.15 Permanent and irreversible impact is expected due to permanent structure of viaduct section highway. Upon the completion of works, the affected vegetation would be reinstated. Considered that the sensitivity of this LCA is identified as **Low** while the magnitude of change on this LCA due to the Project is considered as **Slight**, it is considered that residual impact on this LCA would be **Slight** during the construction phase and **Negligible** in operational phase with the implementation of mitigation measures (CM1, CM2, CM3, CM4, CM6 and OM1, OM2. OM3, OM4, OM5, OM8 respectively).

LCA-2.6 Miscellaneous Urban Fringe Landscape

10.9.3.16 During the construction stage, the proposed temporary works, including at-grade and viaduct carriageway and associated road works, would potentially affect LCA-

2.6 (Miscellaneous Urban Fringe Landscape). Existing vegetation would also be potentially affected temporarily. Approximately 0.4 ha (4% of LCA) is expected to be lost.

10.9.3.17 Permanent and irreversible impact is expected due to permanent structure of at-grade and viaduct section highway. Upon the completion of works, the affected vegetation would be reinstated. Considered that the sensitivity of this LCA is identified as **Low** while the magnitude of change on this LCA due to the Project is considered as **Slight**, it is considered that residual impact on this LCA would be **Slight** during the construction phase and **Negligible** in operational phase with the implementation of mitigation measures (CM1, CM2, CM3, CM4 and OM1, OM2. OM3, OM4, OM5, OM8 respectively).

LCA-3.1 Settled Valley Landscape

10.9.3.18 During the construction stage, the proposed temporary works, including slope cutting, site formation of at-grade and viaduct carriageway and associated road work s, would potentially affect LCA-3.1 (Settled Valley Landscape). Existing vegetation would also be potentially affected temporarily. Approximately 1.8 ha (14% of LCA) is expected to be lost.

10.9.3.19 Nil conservation area would be affected within this LCA. The alignment of proposed road works is carefully designed to minimize the works extent and avoid encroachment on Conservation area (CM3 and CM5).

10.9.3.20 Permanent and irreversible impact is expected due to permanent structure of at-grade and viaduct section highway and Interchange I/C-04 connecting to San Tin Technopole. Upon the completion of works, the affected vegetation would be reinstated. Considered that the sensitivity of this LCA is identified as **Medium** while the magnitude of change on this LCA due to the Project is considered as **Moderate**, it is considered that residual impact on this LCA would be **Moderate** during the construction phase and **Slight** in operational phase with the implementation of mitigation measures (CM1, CM2, CM3, CM4, CM6 and OM1, OM2. OM3, OM4, OM5, OM8 respectively).

LCA-3.2 Upland and Hillside Landscape

10.9.3.21 During the construction stage, the proposed temporary works, including slope cutting, site formation of tunnel section, at-grade and viaduct carriageway and associated road works, would potentially affect LCA-3.2 (Upland and Hillside Landscape). Existing vegetation would also be potentially affected temporarily. Approximately 6.5 ha (6% of LCA) is expected to be lost.

10.9.3.22 Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are affected within this LCA. Approx. 0.1 ha of the conservation area (0.001% of LCA) would be affected within this LCA. The alignment of proposed road works is carefully designed to minimize the works extent and avoid encroachment on Conservation area (CM3 and CM5).

10.9.3.23 Permanent and irreversible impact is expected due to permanent structure of at-grade section highway and Interchange I/C-04 connecting to San Tin Technopole, I/C-05 connecting to Fanling Highway near Pak Shek Au and I/C-06 connecting to Kwu Tung North New Development Area. Upon the completion of works, the affected vegetation would be reinstated. Considered that the sensitivity of this LCA

is identified as **High** while the magnitude of change on this LCA due to the Project is considered as **Slight**, it is considered that residual impact on this LCA would be **Slight** during the construction phase and **Negligible** in operational phase with the implementation of mitigation measures (CM1, CM2, CM3, CM4, CM5 and OM1, OM2. OM3, OM4, OM5 respectively).

LCA-3.3 Rural Inland Plain Landscape

10.9.3.24 During the construction stage, the proposed temporary works, including at-grade and viaduct carriageway and associated road works, would potentially affect LCA-3.3 (Rural Inland Plain Landscape). Existing vegetation would also be potentially affected temporarily. Approximately 0.6 ha (15% of LCA) is expected to be lost.

10.9.3.25 Permanent and irreversible impact is expected due to permanent structure of at-grade and viaduct section highway and Interchange I/C-04 connecting to San Tin Technopole. Upon the completion of works, the affected vegetation would be reinstated. Considered that the sensitivity of this LCA is identified as **Medium** while the magnitude of change on this LCA due to the Project is considered as **Moderate**, it is considered that residual impact on this LCA would be **Moderate** during the construction phase and **Slight** in operational phase with the implementation of mitigation measures (CM1, CM2, CM3, CM4 and OM1, OM2. OM3, OM4, OM5, OM8 respectively).

LCA-3.4 Urban Peripheral Village Landscape

10.9.3.26 During the construction stage, the proposed temporary works, including viaduct carriageway and associated road works, would potentially affect LCA-3.4 (Urban Peripheral Village Landscape). Existing vegetation would also be potentially affected temporarily. Approximately 2.1 ha (15% of LCA) is expected to be lost.

10.9.3.27 Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are affected within this LCA. The alignment of proposed road works is carefully designed to minimize the works extent and avoid encroachment on Trees of particular interest (TPIs) (CM3).

10.9.3.28 Permanent and irreversible impact is expected due to permanent structure of viaduct section highway and Interchange I/C-06 connecting to Kwu Tung North New Development Area. Upon the completion of works, the affected vegetation would be reinstated. Considered that the sensitivity of this LCA is identified as **Medium** while the magnitude of change on this LCA due to the Project is considered as **Moderate**, it is considered that residual impact on this LCA would be **Moderate** during the construction phase and **Slight** in operational phase with the implementation of mitigation measures (CM1, CM2, CM3, CM4 and OM1, OM2. OM3, OM4, OM5, OM8 respectively).

LCA-3.5 Miscellaneous Rural Fringe Landscape

10.9.3.29 During the construction stage, the proposed temporary works, including at-grade and viaduct carriageway and associated road works, would potentially affect LCA-3.5 (Miscellaneous Rural Fringe Landscape). Existing vegetation would also be potentially affected temporarily. Approximately 0.4 ha (4% of LCA) is expected to be lost.

10.9.3.30 Trees of particular interest (TPIs) are affected within this LR. Nil conservation area would be affected within this LR. The alignment of proposed road works is carefully designed to minimize the works extent and avoid encroachment on Conservation area (CM3 and CM5).

10.9.3.31 Permanent and irreversible impact is expected due to permanent structure of viaduct section highway. Upon the completion of works, the affected vegetation would be reinstated. Considered that the sensitivity of this LCA is identified as **Low** while the magnitude of change on this LCA due to the Project is considered as **Slight**, it is considered that residual impact on this LCA would be **Slight** during the construction phase and **Negligible** in operational phase with the implementation of mitigation measures (CM1, CM2, CM3, CM4, CM6 and OM1, OM2. OM3, OM4, OM5, OM8 respectively).

LCA-3.6 Miscellaneous Urban Fringe Landscape

10.9.3.32 The landscape resource of LCA-3.6 Miscellaneous Urban Fringe Landscape is identified along both side of Castle Peak Road – Chau Tau and Fanling Highway. The sensitivity of this LCA is identified as **Low**. Since no temporary work or permanent work would be proposed during both construction and operational phases, hence the magnitude of change on this LCA due to the Project is considered as **Negligible**. The resultant unmitigated impact during construction and operational phases is **Negligible**

LCA-3.7 Comprehensive Residential Development Landscape

10.9.3.33 During the construction stage, the proposed temporary works, including at-grade carriageway and associated road works, would potentially affect LCA-3.7 (Comprehensive Residential Development Landscape). Existing vegetation would also be potentially affected temporarily. Approximately 0.1 ha (2% of LCA) is expected to be lost.

10.9.3.34 Permanent and irreversible impact is expected due to permanent structure of at-grade section highway. Upon the completion of works, the affected vegetation would be reinstated. Considered that the sensitivity of this LCA is identified as **Low** while the magnitude of change on this LCA due to the Project is considered as **Slight**, it is considered that residual impact on this LCA would be **Slight** during the construction phase and **Negligible** in operational phase with the implementation of mitigation measures (CM1, CM2, CM3, CM4 and OM3, OM5, OM6, OM9 respectively).

LCA-3.8 Transportation Corridor Landscape

10.9.3.35 During the construction stage, the proposed temporary works, including at-grade and viaduct carriageway and associated road works, would potentially affect LCA-3.8 (Transportation Corridor Landscape). Existing vegetation would also be potentially affected temporarily. Approximately 0.9 ha (9% of LCA) is expected to be lost.

10.9.3.36 Permanent and irreversible impact is expected due to permanent structure of at-grade and viaduct section highway and Interchange I/C-05 connecting to Fanling Highway near Pak Shek Au. Upon the completion of works, the affected vegetation would be reinstated. Considered that the sensitivity of this LCA is identified as **Low**

while the magnitude of change on this LCA due to the Project is considered as **Slight**, it is considered that residual impact on this LCA would be **Slight** during the construction phase and **Negligible** in operational phase with the implementation of mitigation measures (CM1, CM2, CM3, CM4 and OM3, OM4 respectively).

Table 10.10 Significance Thresholds of Landscape Impact during Construction and Operation Phases

ID no.	Landscape Resources / Landscape Character Area	Sensitivity (Low, Medium, High)	Magnitude of Change (Negligible, Slight, Moderate, Substantial)		Impact Significance Before Mitigation (Negligible, Slight, Moderate, Substantial)		Recommended Mitigation Measures	Residual Impact Significance after Mitigation (Negligible, Slight, Moderate, Substantial)	
			Construction	Operation	Construction	Operation		Construction	Operation
LR-1.01	Woodland	High	Moderate	Moderate	Moderate	Moderate	CM1,CM2, CM3, CM4, CM5, OM1, OM2, OM3, OM4, OM5, OM6	Moderate	Slight
LR-1.02	Hillside Vegetation	High	Moderate	Moderate	Moderate	Moderate	CM1,CM2, CM3, CM4, CM5, OM1, OM2, OM3, OM4, OM5, OM6	Moderate	Slight
LR-1.03	Shrub / Grassland	Medium	Slight	Slight	Moderate	Moderate	CM1,CM2, CM3, CM4, CM5, OM1, OM2, OM3, OM4, OM5, OM6	Slight	Slight
LR-1.04	Vegetation in Village / Rural Area	medium	Moderate	Moderate	Moderate	Moderate	CM1,CM2, CM3, CM4, OM1, OM2, OM3, OM4, OM5, OM6	Slight	Slight
LR-1.05	Roadside vegetation	medium	Moderate	Moderate	Moderate	Moderate	CM1,CM2, CM3, CM4, OM1, OM2, OM3, OM4, OM5, OM6	Slight	Slight
LR-1.06	Vegetation in Wasteland / Open Storage	Low	Negligible	Negligible	Negligible	Negligible	OM4	Negligible	Negligible

ID no.	Landscape Resources / Landscape Character Area	Sensitivity (Low, Medium, High)	Magnitude of Change (Negligible, Slight, Moderate, Substantial)		Impact Significance Before Mitigation (Negligible, Slight, Moderate, Substantial)		Recommended Mitigation Measures	Residual Impact Significance after Mitigation (Negligible, Slight, Moderate, Substantial)	
			Construction	Operation	Construction	Operation		Construction	Operation
LR-1.07	Landscape Area in Developed Area	Low	Negligible	Negligible	Negligible	Negligible	N/A	Negligible	Negligible
LR-1.10	Vegetation Along Watercourse	Medium	Slight	Slight	Moderate	Moderate	CM1,CM2, CM3, CM4, CM6, OM1, OM2, OM3, OM4, OM5, OM6	Slight	Slight
LR-1.11	Vegetation in Wetland Area	Medium	Negligible	Negligible	Negligible	Negligible	N/A	Negligible	Negligible
LR-1.12	Pond	Medium	Negligible	Negligible	Negligible	Negligible	N/A	Negligible	Negligible
LR-2.01	Woodland	High	Slight	Slight	Moderate	Moderate	CM1, CM2, CM3, CM4, CM5, OM3, OM4, OM5	Moderate	Slight
LR-2.02	Hillside vegetation	High	Slight	Slight	Moderate	Moderate	CM1, CM2, CM3, CM4, CM5, OM2, OM3, OM4, OM5	Moderate	Slight
LR-2.03	Shrubland/ Grassland	Medium	Slight	Slight	Slight	Slight	CM2, CM3, CM4, OM3, OM5, OM6	Slight	Negligible
LR-2.04	Vegetation in village/ rural area	Medium	Slight	Slight	Slight	Slight	CM1, CM2, CM3, CM4, OM3, OM5, OM6, OM9	Slight	Negligible

ID no.	Landscape Resources / Landscape Character Area	Sensitivity (Low, Medium, High)	Magnitude of Change (Negligible, Slight, Moderate, Substantial)		Impact Significance Before Mitigation (Negligible, Slight, Moderate, Substantial)		Recommended Mitigation Measures	Residual Impact Significance after Mitigation (Negligible, Slight, Moderate, Substantial)	
			Construction	Operation	Construction	Operation		Construction	Operation
LR-2.05	Roadside Vegetation	Low	Moderate	Moderate	Slight	Slight	CM1, CM2, CM3, CM4, OM3, OM4	Slight	Negligible
LR-2.06	Vegetation in wasteland/ open storage	Low	Negligible	Negligible	Negligible	Negligible	N/A	Negligible	Negligible
LR-2.07	Landscape area in Developed Area	Low	Negligible	Negligible	Negligible	Negligible	N/A	Negligible	Negligible
LR-2.09	Landscape area in Ngau Tam Mei Water Treatment Works	Low	Negligible	Negligible	Negligible	Negligible	N/A	Negligible	Negligible
LR-2.10	Watercourse	Medium	Slight	Slight	Slight	Slight	CM2, CM3, CM4, CM6, OM1, OM4	Slight	Negligible
LR-2.11	Wetland/ Marsh/ Reed	High	Moderate	Moderate	Moderate	Moderate	CM2, CM3, CM4, CM6, OM1, OM4	Moderate	Slight
LR-2.12	Pond	Medium	Moderate	Moderate	Moderate	Moderate	CM2, CM3, CM4, CM6, OM1, OM4	Moderate	Slight
LR-3.01	Woodland	High	Slight	Slight	Moderate	Moderate	CM1, CM2, CM3, CM4, CM5, OM3, OM4, OM5	Moderate	Slight

ID no.	Landscape Resources / Landscape Character Area	Sensitivity (Low, Medium, High)	Magnitude of Change (Negligible, Slight, Moderate, Substantial)		Impact Significance Before Mitigation (Negligible, Slight, Moderate, Substantial)		Recommended Mitigation Measures	Residual Impact Significance after Mitigation (Negligible, Slight, Moderate, Substantial)	
			Construction	Operation	Construction	Operation		Construction	Operation
LR-3.02	Hillside vegetation	High	Moderate	Moderate	Moderate	Moderate	CM1, CM2, CM3, CM4, OM3, OM4, OM5	Moderate	Slight
LR-3.03	Shrubland/ Grassland	Medium	Slight	Slight	Slight	Slight	CM2, CM3, CM4, OM2, OM3, OM4, OM5	Slight	Negligible
LR-3.04	Vegetation in village/ rural area	Medium	Moderate	Moderate	Moderate	Moderate	CM1, CM2, CM3, CM4, OM3, OM5, OM6, OM9	Moderate	Slight
LR-3.05	Roadside Vegetation	Low	Moderate	Moderate	Moderate	Moderate	CM1, CM2, CM3, CM4, OM3, OM4	Moderate	Slight
LR-3.06	Vegetation in wasteland/ open storage	Low	Slight	Slight	Slight	Slight	CM2, CM3, CM4, OM2, OM3, OM4, OM5	Slight	Negligible
LR-3.07	Landscape area in Developed Area	Low	Slight	Slight	Slight	Slight	CM2, CM3, CM4, OM3, OM5, OM6, OM9	Slight	Negligible
LR-3.08	Landscape area in LCSD Sitting-out area/ park	Low	Negligible	Negligible	Negligible	Negligible	N/A	Negligible	Negligible
LR-3.09	Landscape Area in Kwu Tung Reservoir	Low	Negligible	Negligible	Negligible	Negligible	N/A	Negligible	Negligible
LR-3.10	Watercourse	Low	Negligible	Negligible	Negligible	Negligible	N/A	Negligible	Negligible

ID no.	Landscape Resources / Landscape Character Area	Sensitivity (Low, Medium, High)	Magnitude of Change (Negligible, Slight, Moderate, Substantial)		Impact Significance Before Mitigation (Negligible, Slight, Moderate, Substantial)		Recommended Mitigation Measures	Residual Impact Significance after Mitigation (Negligible, Slight, Moderate, Substantial)	
			Construction	Operation	Construction	Operation		Construction	Operation
LR-3.12	Pond	Medium	Moderate	Moderate	Moderate	Moderate	CM2, CM3, CM4, CM6, OM1, OM4	Moderate	Slight
LCA-1.2	Upland and Hillside Landscape	High	Moderate	Moderate	Moderate	Moderate	CM1,CM2, CM3, CM4, CM5, OM1, OM2, OM3, OM4, OM5, OM6	Moderate	Slight
LCA-1.3	Rural Inland Plain Landscape	Medium	Slight	slight	Moderate	Moderate	CM1,CM2, CM3, CM4, CM5, OM1, OM2, OM3, OM4, OM5, OM6	Slight	Negligible
LCA-1.5	Miscellaneous Rural Fringe Landscape	Low	Moderate	Moderate	Slight	Slight	CM1,CM2, CM3, CM4, CM5, CM6, OM1, OM2, OM3, OM4, OM5, OM6	Slight	Negligible
LCA-1.7	Comprehensive Residential Development Landscape	Low	Negligible	Negligible	Negligible	Negligible	N/A	Negligible	Negligible
LCA-1.8	Transportation Corridor Landscape	Medium	Moderate	Moderate	Moderate	Moderate	CM1,CM2, CM3, CM4, OM1, OM2, OM3, OM4, OM5, OM6	Slight	Negligible

ID no.	Landscape Resources / Landscape Character Area	Sensitivity (Low, Medium, High)	Magnitude of Change (Negligible, Slight, Moderate, Substantial)		Impact Significance Before Mitigation (Negligible, Slight, Moderate, Substantial)		Recommended Mitigation Measures	Residual Impact Significance after Mitigation (Negligible, Slight, Moderate, Substantial)	
			Construction	Operation	Construction	Operation		Construction	Operation
LCA-2.2	Upland and Hillside Landscape	High	Slight	Slight	Slight	Slight	CM1, CM2, CM3, CM4, CM5, OM1, OM2. OM3, OM4, OM5	Slight	Negligible
LCA-2.3	Rural Inland Plain Landscape	Medium	Moderate	Moderate	Moderate	Moderate	CM1, CM2, CM3, CM4, OM1, OM2. OM3, OM4, OM5, OM8	Moderate	Slight
LCA-2.4	Urban Peripheral Village Landscape	Medium	Slight	Slight	Slight	Slight	CM1, CM2, CM3, CM4, OM1, OM2. OM3, OM4, OM5, OM8	Slight	Negligible
LCA-2.5	Miscellaneous Rural Fringe Landscape	Low	Slight	Slight	Slight	Slight	CM1, CM2, CM3, CM4, CM6, OM1, OM2. OM3, OM4, OM5, OM8	Slight	Negligible
LCA-2.6	Miscellaneous Urban Fringe Landscape	Low	Slight	Slight	Slight	Slight	CM1, CM2, CM3, CM4, OM1, OM2. OM3, OM4, OM5, OM8	Slight	Negligible
LCA-3.1	Settled Valley Landscape	Medium	Moderate	Moderate	Moderate	Moderate	CM1, CM2, CM3, CM4, CM6, OM1, OM2. OM3, OM4, OM5, OM8	Moderate	Slight

ID no.	Landscape Resources / Landscape Character Area	Sensitivity (Low, Medium, High)	Magnitude of Change (Negligible, Slight, Moderate, Substantial)		Impact Significance Before Mitigation (Negligible, Slight, Moderate, Substantial)		Recommended Mitigation Measures	Residual Impact Significance after Mitigation (Negligible, Slight, Moderate, Substantial)	
			Construction	Operation	Construction	Operation		Construction	Operation
LCA-3.2	Upland and Hillside Landscape	High	Slight	Slight	Slight	Slight	CM1, CM2, CM3, CM4, CM5, OM1, OM2. OM3, OM4, OM5	Slight	Negligible
LCA-3.3	Rural Inland Plain Landscape	Medium	Moderate	Moderate	Moderate	Moderate	CM1, CM2, CM3, CM4, OM1, OM2. OM3, OM4, OM5, OM8	Moderate	Slight
LCA-3.4	Urban Peripheral Village Landscape	Medium	Moderate	Moderate	Moderate	Moderate	CM1, CM2, CM3, CM4, OM1, OM2. OM3, OM4, OM5, OM8	Moderate	Slight
LCA-3.5	Miscellaneous Rural Fringe Landscape	Low	Slight	Slight	Slight	Slight	CM1, CM2, CM3, CM4, CM6, OM1, OM2. OM3, OM4, OM5, OM8	Slight	Negligible
LCA-3.6	Miscellaneous Urban Fringe Landscape	Low	Negligible	Negligible	Negligible	Negligible	N/A	Negligible	Negligible
LCA-3.7	Comprehensive Residential Development Landscape	Low	Slight	Slight	Slight	Slight	CM1, CM2, CM3, CM4, OM3, OM5, OM6, OM9	Slight	Negligible

ID no.	Landscape Resources / Landscape Character Area	Sensitivity (Low, Medium, High)	Magnitude of Change (Negligible, Slight, Moderate, Substantial)		Impact Significance Before Mitigation (Negligible, Slight, Moderate, Substantial)		Recommended Mitigation Measures	Residual Impact Significance after Mitigation (Negligible, Slight, Moderate, Substantial)	
			Construction	Operation	Construction	Operation		Construction	Operation
LCA-3.8	Transportation Corridor Landscape	Low	Slight	Slight	Slight	Slight	CM1, CM2, CM3, CM4 OM3, OM4	Slight	Negligible

10.9.4 Visual Impact to existing VPs

10.9.4.1 With the implementation of the recommended mitigation measures shown in the Landscape and Visual Mitigation Plans in **Figures 10.5.0 to 10.5.10**, and sections in **Figures 10.5.13 to 10.5.14,** significance thresholds of visual impact during operational phase are described below. Photomontages illustrating the potential visual impact during operation with and without mitigation measures from the VPs are shown in **Figures 10.4.1 to 10.4.13**.

10.9.5 North of Lung Tam Shan

VP-N.1 – View from Kwu Tung Fresh Water Service Reservoir (Hiker)

10.9.5.1 The proposed works would occupy the middle ground of this VP-N.1 in long viewing distance. The proposed road works (at-grade and viaduct section) of I/C06 create **partial** visual obstruction to the existing distant view of the Pak Shek Au settled valley landscape, the planned San Tin Technopole and Kwu Tung North development, while visual amenity of the foreground vegetation on Ki Lun Shan (+223mPD) and ridgeline of She Leng (+143mPD) remain unchanged.

10.9.5.2 To alleviate the visual impact, mitigation measures such as Aesthetically pleasing design of Highways Structures (OM2), Slope Associated Structures and Landscape Treatments on Slope or Retaining Structure (OM5) and Sensitive design of noise barriers (OM9) are proposed to be implemented. With the magnitude of change is **Moderate** and the viewers' sensitivity of VP-N.1 is **Medium**, it is anticipated that the visual impact for the viewers of this VP would be **Moderate** during operational phase.

VP-N.2 – View from Kwu Tung Reservoir (Hiker)

10.9.5.3 The proposed works would occupy the middle ground of this VP-N.2 in long viewing distance. The proposed road works (Portal B2) of I/C05 create **partial** visual obstruction to the existing distant hillside vegetation view of Ki Lun Shan (+223mPD). Most of the proposed road works (at-grade section) are not visible from this view due to the medium to long viewing distance. Remaining portion of the proposed road works will be tunnel section and will not be visible from this view.

10.9.5.4 To alleviate the visual impact, mitigation measures such as Aesthetically pleasing design of Highways Structures (OM2) and Slope Associated Structures and Landscape Treatments on Slope or Retaining Structure (OM5) are proposed to be implemented. With the magnitude of change is **Slight** and the viewers' sensitivity of VP-N.2 is **High**, it is anticipated that the residual impact for the viewers of this VP would be **Slight** during operational phase.

VP-N.3 – View from Pak Shek Au Interchange

10.9.5.5 The proposed works would occupy the middle ground of this VP-N.3 in long viewing distance. The proposed road works (viaduct section) of I/C05 & I/C06 create **partial** visual obstruction to the existing distant view of Kwu Tung North Development, while most of the proposed road works (at-grade and viaduct section) are not visible from this view due to the long viewing distance.

10.9.5.6 To alleviate the visual impact, mitigation measures such as Aesthetically pleasing design of Highways Structures (OM2) is proposed to be implemented. With the magnitude of change is **Moderate** and the viewers' sensitivity of VP-N.3 is **Low**, it is anticipated that the visual impact for the viewers of this VP would be **Moderate** during operational phase.

VP-N.4 – View from Ki Lun Tsuen Playground

10.9.5.7 Given the relatively short viewing distance, the proposed works would occupy the middle ground of this VP-N.4. The proposed road works (viaduct section) of I/C05 & I/C06 create **medium to substantial** visual obstruction to hillside vegetation at Ki Lun Shan Au (+55mPD). Partial of the proposed road works (viaduct section) are not visible from this view due to the density of vegetation in the foreground.

10.9.5.8 To alleviate the visual impact, mitigation measures such as Aesthetically pleasing design of Highways Structures (OM2) is proposed to be implemented. With the magnitude of change is **Moderate** and the viewers' sensitivity of VP-N.4 is **Low**, it is anticipated that the visual impact for the viewers of this VP would be **Moderate** during operational phase.

10.9.6 VP-N.5 – View from Cheung Lek Minibus Station

10.9.6.1 The proposed works would occupy the middle ground of this VP-N.5 in medium to long viewing distance. The proposed road works (at-grade and viaduct section) of I/C04 create **partial** visual obstruction to hillside vegetation at Ngau Tam Shan (+337mPD). Partial of the proposed road works (viaduct section) are not visible from this view due to the density of vegetation in the foreground.

10.9.6.2 To alleviate the visual impact, mitigation measures such as Aesthetically pleasing design of Highways Structures (OM2) and Slope Associated Structures and Landscape Treatments on Slope or Retaining Structure (OM5) are proposed to be implemented. With the magnitude of change is **Slight** and the viewers' sensitivity of VP-N.5 is **Low**, it is anticipated that the visual impact for the viewers of this VP would be **Slight** during operational phase.

VP-N.6 – View from Planned Public Transport Interchange of the Technopole

10.9.6.3 The proposed works would occupy the middle ground of this VP-N.6 in medium viewing distance. Given the planned San Tin Technopole development occupies most of the view at the foreground, partial of the proposed road works (tunnel and at-grade section) are not visible from this view due to blockage of the planned San Tin Technopole development.

10.9.6.4 To alleviate the visual impact, mitigation measures such as Aesthetically pleasing design of Highways Structures (OM2) and Slope Associated Structures and Landscape Treatments on Slope or Retaining Structure (OM5) are proposed to be implemented. With the viewers' sensitivity of VP-N.6 is **Medium** and the magnitude of change is **Slight**, it is anticipated that the visual impact for the viewers of this VP would be **Slight** during operational phase.

VP-N.7 – View along the revitalised Ngau Tam Mei Drainage Channel at the University Town

10.9.6.5 The proposed works would occupy the middle ground of this VP-N.7 in medium to long viewing distance. Given the planned riverside of Ngau Tam Mei New Development Area and the planned University Town of Ngau Tam Mei New Development Area occupies most of the view at the foreground, the proposed road works (viaduct section) connecting to I/C03 would be mostly invisible due to the blockage of the planned development. The visual obstruction of the proposed road works (viaduct section) would be negligible.

10.9.6.6 To alleviate the visual impact, mitigation measures such as Aesthetically pleasing design of Highways Structures (OM2) and Slope Associated Structures and Landscape Treatments on Slope or Retaining Structure (OM5) are proposed to be implemented. With the viewers' sensitivity of VP-N.7 is **Low** and the magnitude of change is **Slight**, it is anticipated that the visual impact for the viewers of this VP would be **Slight** during operational phase.

VP-N.8 – View from Kai Kung Shan (Hiker)

10.9.6.7 The proposed works would occupy the middle ground of this VP-N.8 in long viewing distance. The proposed road works (at-grade and viaduct section, and interchange I/C03) and associated structure including administration building create **slight** visual obstruction to the existing distant view of Ngau Tam Mei with the planned Ngau Tam Mei New Development Area and Yau Tam Mei area settled valley landscape, while visual amenity of the foreground vegetation of Kai Kung Shan (+364mPD) remain unchanged.

10.9.6.8 To alleviate the visual impact, mitigation measures such as Aesthetically pleasing design of Highways Structures (OM2), Slope Associated Structures and Landscape Treatments on Slope or Retaining Structure (OM5) and Sensitive design of noise barriers (OM9) are proposed to be implemented. With the magnitude of change is **Slight** and the viewers' sensitivity of VP-N.8 is **High**, it is anticipated that the visual impact for the viewers of this VP would be **Moderate** during operational phase.

VP-N.9 – View from Planned Roadside Amenity Area of the Ngau Tam Mei NDA

10.9.6.9 The proposed works would occupy the middle ground of this VP-N.9 in long viewing distance. Given the planned Ngau Tam Mei New Development Area occupies most of the view at the foreground, the proposed road works (viaduct section) connecting Portal A1 and associated structure including portal plant building/ plant room would be located behind the planned development and would not be visible from this view due to the blockage of the planned development. The visual obstruction of the proposed road works (viaduct section) would be negligible.

10.9.6.10 To alleviate the visual impact, mitigation measures such as Aesthetically pleasing design of Highways Structures (OM2) and Slope Associated Structures and Landscape Treatments on Slope or Retaining Structure (OM5) are proposed to be implemented. With the viewers' sensitivity of VP-N.9 is **Low** and the magnitude of change is **Negligible**, it is anticipated that the visual impact for the viewers of this VP would be **Negligible** during operational phase.

10.9.7 South of Lung Tam Shan

VP-S.1 – View from Nam Sang Wai Road

10.9.8 The proposed viaduct along the San Tin Highway would be blocking the view of lush greenery located in the foothill of the Kai Kung Leung in the middle ground. The magnitude of change to this VP would be considered as **Slight**. After the implementation of mitigation measures such as aesthetic pleasing treatment of viaduct (OM1 & OM2), and buffer screening planting (OM4), It is anticipated that the visual impact for the viewers of this VP, with **High** sensitivity, would be **Moderate** in operational phase.

VP-S.2 – Western side of Kam Tin River adjoining Ko Po Tsuen

10.9.8.1 Most of the proposed viaduct across the Kam Tin River, located in the Tsing Long Highway interchange, is not visible in this viewing point. The proposed viaduct across the Kam Tin River will not impact existing amenity planting and riverscape view as the foreground, and would be mostly screened off by existing Tuen Ma Line. The effect on the visual experience is negligible. The magnitude of change to this VP would be considered as **Negligible**. Hence, it is expected that visual impact after implementation of mitigation measure would be **Negligible** in operational phase.

VP-S.3 – View from Footbridge crossing San Tam Road

10.9.8.2 Given to the close viewing distance, the proposed viaduct and the pier will bring about visual changes to the public viewers. There will be a moderate visual obstruction of the sky view that would be experienced by public viewers located in the footbridge. The effect on the visual experience of this VP due to the proposed viaduct, is considered moderately adverse. It is anticipated that the visual impact for the viewers of this VP with **Low** sensitivity would be **Moderate** in operational phase.

VP-S.4 – View from Ho Hok Shan (Hiker)

10.9.8.3 Visitor to this viewing point will be mainly recreational users in the Ho Hok Shan (+140mPD), and engaging in passive recreational activities. The value of this view is the open sky view in the background. The existing view and overall visual character currently enjoyed by visitors of Ho Hok Shan (+140mPD) would not be disturbed. The anticipated visual change would not be noticeable by viewers. The proposed works will be blend in with the existing infrastructure road network in the interchange of Tsing Long Highway and Yuen Long Highway. The magnitude of change to this VP would be considered as **Slight**. After the implementation of the mitigation measures (OM1 & OM2), it is anticipated that the visual impact for the viewers of this VP would be **Moderate** in operational phase given the **High** sensitivity of this VP.

Table 10.11 Significance Thresholds of Visual Impact during Operation Phase

VP ID.	Location of VPs / Key Public Viewers	Sensitivity (High, Medium, Low)	Magnitude of Change (Negligible, Slight, Moderate, Substantial)	Recommended Mitigation Measures	Significance Thresholds of Visual Impact after Mitigation Measure Established (Beneficial, Negligible, Slight, Moderate, Substantial)
VP-N.1	View from Kwu Tung Fresh Water Service Reservoir (Hiker)	High	Moderate	OM2, OM5, OM9	Moderate
VP-N.2	View from Kwu Tung Reservoir (Hiker)	High	Slight	OM2, OM5	Moderate
VP-N.3	View from Pak Shek Au Interchange	Low	Moderate	OM2	Moderate
VP-N.4	View from Ki Lun Tsuen Playground	Low	Moderate	OM2	Moderate
VP-N.5	View from Cheung Lek Minibus Station	Low	Slight	OM2, OM5	Slight
VP-N.6	View from Planned Public Transport Interchange of the Technopole	Medium	Slight	OM2, OM5	Slight
VP-N.7	View along the revitalised Ngau Tam Mei Drainage Channel at the University Town	Low	Slight	OM2, OM5	Slight
VP-N.8	View from Kai Kung Shan (Hiker)	High	Slight	OM2, OM5, OM9	Moderate
VP-N.9	View from Planned Roadside Amenity Area of the Ngau Tam Mei NDA	Low	Negligible	OM2, OM5	Negligible
VP-S.1	View from Nam Sang Wai Road	High	Slight	OM1. OM2, OM3, OM4, OM9	Moderate
VP-S.2	Western side of Kam Tin River adjoining Ko Po Tsuen	Medium	Negligible	OM1. OM2,	Negligible
VP-S.3	View from Footbridge crossing San Tam Road	Low	Moderate	OM1. OM2, OM9	Moderate
VP-S.4	View from Ho Hok Shan (Hiker)	High	Slight	OM1. OM2,	Moderate

Evaluation of the Residual Landscape Impacts and Visual Impacts

10.9.8.4 Considering the scale and nature of the Project, it would inevitably result in certain levels of residual landscape and visual impacts in relation to the loss of woodland (i.e. LR-1.01, LR-2.01, LR-3.01), loss of hillside vegetation (i.e. LR-1.02, LR-1.03, LR-2.02, LR-3.02, LCA-1.2 and LCA-3.3), loss of wetland/ marsh/ reed/ pond (i.e. LR-1.10, LR-2.11, LR-2.12, LR-3.12, LCA-2.3 and LCA-3.1), loss of vegetation in village/ rural area (i.e. LR-1.04, LR-1.05, LR-3.04, LR-3.05 and LCA-3.4), and the views from hilltop and from ground level (i.e. VP-N.1, VP-N.2, VP-N.3, VP-N.4, VP-N.5, VP-N.6, VP-N.7, VP-N.8, VP-S.1, VP-S.3 and VP-S.4). The residual landscape and visual impacts are evaluated below in accordance with Section 4.4.3 of EIAO-TM:

i) Effects on public health and health of biota or risk to life:

- The residual landscape and visual impacts would not cause adverse effects on public health and the health of biota or pose risk to life.

ii) The magnitude of the adverse environmental impacts:

- The magnitude of residual landscape and visual impacts of LR-1.01, LR-1.02, LR-1.03. LR-1.04, LR-1.05, LR-1.10, LR-2.01, LR-2.11, LR-2.12, LR-3.01, LR-3.02, LR-3.04, LR-3.05, LR-3.12, LCA-1.2, LCA-2.3, LCA-3.1, LCA-3.3, LCA-3.4, VP-N.1, VP-N.2, VP-N.5, VP-N.6, VP-N.7, VP-S.1and VP-S.4 are slight and minor in scale. The residual visual impacts on VP-N.3, VP-N.4 and VP-S.3 are moderate due to the short viewing distance. The residual visual impacts on VP-N.1, VP-N.8, VP-S.1 and VP-S.4 are moderate due to high sensitivity with slight to moderate magnitude of change. Nevertheless, the proposed development incorporating landscape mitigation measures such as tree compensation where space is available, reinstatement of affected landscaping area in like-for-like basis and provision of buffer screen planting/ roadside planting would be implemented. Aesthetically pleasing design of above ground structures/ highways structures/ slope associated structure had also been developed for the proposed works, to cohere with the existing environment and planned developments, such as Ngau Tam Mei Development Area, San Tin Technopole and Kwu Tung North New Development Area, with similar development nature and scale, to ameliorate the overall landscape and visual qualities.

iii) The geographic extent of the adverse environmental impacts:

- *The residual landscape impacts and visual impacts would not cause* adverse environmental impact on the geographical extent. For LR-1.02, LR-2.02, LR-3.02, LCA-1.2 and LCA-3.3, loss of hillside vegetation is localized and minimized, and no country park would be affected. For VP-N.1, VP-N.2, VP-N.3, VP-N.4, VP-N.5, VP-N.6, VP-N.7, VP-N.8, VP-S.1, VP-S.3 and VP-S.4, all the residual visual impacts are confined within the visual envelope.

iv) The duration and frequency of the adverse environmental impacts:

- The residual landscape and visual impacts are long term and permanent due to the nature of highway construction and associated works, transforming hillside vegetation to man-made slope. The durations of view on VP-N.1, VP-N.2, VP-N.8 and VP-S.4 are short and transient, as most of the public viewers will only take short rest and then continue their hiking journey. The durations of view on VP-N.3, VP-N.5, VP-N.6, VP-S.1 and VP-S.3 are short to medium, as most of the public viewers are recreational/ pedestrian/ vehicular travelers and may stop for short period of time to enjoy the views of vast landscape and scenic view. The durations of view are medium to long for VP-N.4 and VP-N.7 as recreational users/ visitors likely to stay in the playground for recreational activities.

v) The likely size of the community or the environment that may be affected by the adverse impacts:

- The residual landscape impacts are localised and confined to the loss of hillside vegetation, wetland/ marsh/ reed / pond and vegetation in village/ rural area. No existing community in Ngau Tam Mei and San Tin would be involved, and no country park would be affected. The residual visual impacts on VP-N.1, VP-N.2, VP-N.3, VP-N.4, VP-N.5, VP-N.6, VP-N.7, VP-N.8, VP-S.1, VP-S.3 and VP-S.4 involved relatively few to medium public viewers, mainly hikers in lookout of Kwu Tung, Kai Lung Shan and Ho Hok Shan, recreational users in playgrounds and planned riverside, and pedestrian/ vehicular travelers along Pak Shek Au Interchange, Nam San Wai Road and in Cheung Lek and in San Tin Technopole.

vi) The degree to which the adverse environmental impacts are reversible:

- The residual landscape impacts are irreversible due to the nature of highway construction and associated works, transforming hillside vegetation to man-made slope. The residual visual impacts are also long term and irreversible with the introduction of new development in the area. Nevertheless, the proposed development incorporating landscape mitigation measures such as tree compensation where space is available, reinstatement of affected landscaping area in like-for-like basis and provision of buffer screen planting would be implemented. Aesthetically pleasing design of above ground structures/ highways structures/ slope associated structure had also been developed for the proposed works, to cohere with the existing environment and planned developments, such as Ngau Tam Mei Development Area, San Tin Technopole and Kwu Tung North New Development Area, with similar development nature and scale, to ameliorate the overall landscape and visual qualities.

vii) The ecological context:

- The residual landscape and visual impacts would not occur in ecologically fragile areas such as country parks.

viii) The degree of disruption to sites of cultural heritage:

- The residual landscape and visual impacts would not disrupt any cultural heritage context.

ix) International and regional importance:

- The residual landscape and visual impacts would not involve any distinctive landscape resource, landscape character and vantage viewing point with international or regional importance.

x) Both the likelihood and degree of uncertainly of adverse environmental impacts:

- The residual landscape and visual impacts would be foreseeable without uncertainty at the time of EIA preparation.

10.9.8.5 As discussed above, the residual landscape and visual impacts ranged from negligible to moderate magnitude, long term and irreversible due to the nature of highway construction and associated works, transforming hillside vegetation to man-made slope are inevitable. Nevertheless, the residual landscape impacts are localised and limited to the highway construction and associated works extent only without affecting existing community, while the residual visual impacts are confined within the visual envelope either involving few numbers of public viewers along hiking trail and in playgrounds, or relatively moderate numbers of public viewers at roadside but only partially visible to viewers in short viewing distance due to the blockage of existing visual elements. Although not all landscape and visual impacts can be fully reduced or eliminated through the implementation of mitigation measures, the design, construction and operation of the NM Highway San Tin Section would also fully comply with relevant ordinances, regulations, standards and guidelines as stipulated in Section 10.1.3. Hence, with full implementation of the recommended mitigation measures, unacceptable adverse residual landscape and visual impacts are not expected, as evaluated based on the relevant factors in Section 4.4.3 of the EIAO-TM.

10.10 Cumulative Impacts

10.10.1.1 Cumulative landscape impacts during construction and operational phases from other key concurrent projects in the vicinity were assessed. The planned construction period and a brief description of the projects identified has been summarised in **Section 2.9** of the EIA report.

10.10.1.2 According to the latest implementation programme in **Section 2.8** of the EIA report, the construction of the Project is anticipated to commence tentatively in 2027 with a target to commission in or before 2036. A number of key committed and planned developments that would likely interface with the implementation of the Project with potential cumulative landscape impacts were identified as below:

- Kwu Tung North New Development Area;
- Ngau Tam Mei New Development Area;
- Northern Metropolis Highway (NMH) – Kwu Tung Section;
- Northern Metropolis Highway (NMH) – Tin Shui Wai Section;
- Northern Link (NOL);

- Planned Residential Development under Planning Application no. Y/YL-NSW/9; and

- San Tin Technopole.

10.10.1.3 The construction works of "Kwu Tung North New Development Area" is commenced in 2017 for expected completion in 2031. It is anticipated that localised cumulative landscape impacts (e.g. LR-3.02, LR-3.03 and LR-3.04) will be occurred during the early stage of construction of the Project. To mitigate the cumulative landscape impacts during construction phase, appropriate landscape mitigation measures such as tree preservation and transplanting, management of construction activities and facilities and reinstatement of affected landscaped area will be implemented.

10.10.1.4 The construction works of "Ngau Tam Mei New Development Area" is anticipated to commence in 2027 and to complete in 2036. It is anticipated that localised cumulative landscape impacts (e.g. LR-2.02 and LR-2.04) will be occurred throughout the construction of the Project. To mitigate the cumulative landscape impacts during construction phase, appropriate landscape mitigation measures such as tree preservation and transplanting, management of construction activities and facilities and reinstatement of affected landscaped area will be implemented. As the operational phase of the involved projects will be commenced in similar time period, with the implementation of appropriate landscape mitigation measures during operational phase such as compensatory tree planting, landscape treatments on slope or retaining structure, buffer screen planting / roadside planting and sensitive design of noise barriers, no significant cumulative landscape impacts are expected.

10.10.1.5 The commencement date of the planned construction of "Northern Metropolis Highway (NMH) – Kwu Tung Section" and "Northern Metropolis Highway (NMH) – Tin Shui Wai Section" are under review, and the target completion will be in 3-4 years after NMH-San Tin Section commissioning. Based on current available information, it is anticipated that localised cumulative landscape impacts (e.g. LR-3.02 and LR-3.04 at the north portion and LR-1.05 at the south portion) will be occurred during the late stage of construction of the Project. To mitigate the cumulative landscape impacts during construction phase, appropriate landscape mitigation measures such as tree preservation and transplanting, management of construction activities and facilities and reinstatement of affected landscaped area will be implemented. Since the involved projects are in similar nature of road projects, no significant cumulative landscape impacts during operational phase are expected.

10.10.1.6 The construction works of "NOL" is commenced in 2025 for expected completion in phases in 2034. Based on available information, most of the interfacing areas are underground works area of NOL, while localized cumulative landscape impacts are anticipated in at-grade works sites of NOL in Au Tau Station (e.g. LR-1.06) and the access road to Pok Wai Ancillary building (e.g. LR-1.04). To mitigate the cumulative landscape impacts during construction phase, appropriate landscape mitigation measures such as tree preservation and transplanting, management of construction activities and facilities and reinstatement of affected landscaped area will be implemented. Since the involved projects are in similar nature of road projects, no significant cumulative landscape impacts during operational phase are expected.

10.10.1.7 The construction works of "Planned Residential Development under Planning Application no. Y/YL-NSW/9" is anticipated to be completed in 2031, while no information on the anticipated construction commencement date. Localized cumulative landscape impacts (e.g. LR-1.06) are anticipated along the southern boundary of the planned development. To mitigate the cumulative landscape impacts during construction phase and operational phase, appropriate landscape mitigation measures such as tree preservation and transplanting, management of construction activities and facilities, reinstatement of affected landscaped area, landscape treatments on slope or retaining structure, buffer screen planting / roadside planting and sensitive design of noise barriers will be implemented.

10.10.1.8 The construction works of "San Tin Technopole" is anticipated to commence in 2024 and to complete in 2039. It is anticipated that localised cumulative landscape impacts (e.g. LR-3.03, LR-3.04 and LR-3.06) will be occurred throughout the construction of the Project. To mitigate the cumulative landscape impacts during construction phase, appropriate landscape mitigation measures such as tree preservation and transplanting, management of construction activities and facilities and reinstatement of affected landscaped area will be implemented. As the operational phase of the involved projects will be commenced in similar time period, with the implementation of appropriate landscape mitigation measures during operational phase such as compensatory tree planting, landscape treatments on slope or retaining structure, buffer screen planting / roadside planting and sensitive design of noise barriers, no significant cumulative landscape impacts are expected.

10.10.1.9 Besides, the following committed and planned developments identified within 100m landscape impact assessment area of the Project without direct interface with the project boundary. These include:

- Planned Residential Development under Planning Application no. Y/YL-NSW/7;
- Planned Residential Development under Planning Application no. Y/YL-NSW/8;
- Site Formation and Infrastructure Works for Public Housing Development at Sha Po, Shap Pat Heung and Tai Kei Leng Yuen Long;
- Proposed Nam Sang Wai Wetland Conservation Park;
- Planned Residential Development Under the Planning Application no. A/YL-NSW/293; and
- Planned Residential Development Under the Planning Application no. A/YL-KTN/604 and A/YL-KTN/663.

10.10.1.10 Since the landscape impacts for both construction and operational phases will be confined within the project boundary of the respective developments, it is anticipated that there will not be any significant cumulative landscape impacts after implementation of appropriate landscape mitigation measures during construction and operational phases.

10.11 Environmental Monitoring and Audit

10.11.1.1 The detailed landscape and engineering design of the Project shall be undertaken so as to ensure compliance with the landscape and visual mitigation measures described in Section 10.1.12 and Table 10.8 and Table 10.9 for Proposed Landscape Mitigation Measures for Construction Phase and Proposed Landscape and Visual Mitigation Measures for Operational Phase respectively.

10.11.1.2 Implementation of the recommended mitigation measures would be regularly audited during construction phase and the 12-month establishment period during operational phase. Details of environmental monitoring and audit requirement are stated in Section 13.9 of the EIA Report. The Project will inevitably result in some landscape and visual impacts during construction and operational phases. These impacts were minimised through the consideration on minimization of works areas, incorporation of aesthetic external designs and landscape treatments in the proposed infrastructures.

10.12 Conclusion

10.12.1.1 The Project will inevitably result in some landscape and visual impacts during construction and operation phases. These impacts were minimised through the consideration on minimization of works areas, incorporation of aesthetic external designs and landscape treatments in the proposed infrastructures.

10.12.2 Tree compensation within the site in a form of woodland mix tree planting on slopes or heavy standard tree planting in amenity area would be explored. Tree compensation requirement of 1:1 in terms of number should be carried out as far as practicable. Exact number of trees to be retained, transplanted and removed to be determined under the Tree Preservation and Removal Proposals (TPRPs) in accordance with DEVB TC(W) – No. 4/2020 – Tree Preservation. Among the approx. 67,500 nos. of existing trees within the 100m assessment area, it is estimated that there are approx. 9,050 nos. of trees (excluding *Leucaena leucocephala* of which TPRP is not required for removal of undesirable species) would be unavoidably affected. The exact quantity, tree condition, proposed recommendations as well as future receptor locations of these trees shall be further reviewed in the formal TPRP submission, which to be prepared and submitted in the Detailed Design stage.

10.12.2.1 Under this Project, the existing landscape resources, including vegetation, marsh or wetland and fishpond would be affected in multiple scale subject to the proposed works. Vegetation found within the LRs and LCAs would either be temporarily or permanently loss. After the completion of works, landscape mitigation measures such as tree compensation where space is available, reinstatement of affected landscaping area or fishpond in like for like basis and provision of buffer screen planting would be implemented. With the implementation of these mitigation measures, it is considered that residual impacts of the LRs and LCAs would be reduced to **Negligible** to **Slight** in the operational phase.

10.12.2.2 In terms of the landscape impact, a number of LRs would be preserved in total (i.e. LR-1.07, LR-1.11, LR-1.12, LR-2.06, LR-2.07, LR-2.09, LR-3.08, LR-3.09, LR-3.10). Among the remaining LRs, Woodland (LR-1.01, LR-2.01, LR-3.01), Hillside vegetation (LR1.02, LR-2.02, LR-3.02), Wetland/ Marsh/ Reed (LR-2.11), Pond (LR-2.12), Vegetation in village/ rural area (LR-3.04), and Roadside Vegetation (LR-3.05) would have moderate impact significance before mitigation. Nevertheless, after the completion of works, landscape mitigation measures such as tree compensation where space is available, reinstatement of affected landscaping area in like-for-like basis and provision of buffer screen planting would be implemented as appropriate. With the implementation of these mitigation measures, it is considered that residual impacts on these LRs would be reduced to **Slight** in operational phase.

10.12.2.3 Meanwhile, Shrubland/ Grassland (LR-1.03, LR-2.03, LR-3.03), Vegetation in village/ rural area (LR-1.04,LR-2.04), Roadside Vegetation (LR-1.05, LR-2.05), Vegetation in wasteland/ open storage (LR-3.06), Landscape area in Developed Area (LR-3.07), Landscape area in Ngau Tam Mei Water Treatment Works (LR-2.09), Watercourse (LR-1.10, LR-2.10) would have **slight** impact significance before mitigation due to the proposed development. It is anticipated that residual impacts on these LRs would be reduced to **Negligible or Slight** in operational phase after the implementation of mitigation measures

10.12.2.4 For LCAs, the most permanent works such as construction at-grade carriageway, associated structure and ancillary work, e.g. slope works, would be located within Upland and Hillside Landscape (LCA-1.2), Rural Inland Plain Landscape (LCA-2.3, LCA-3.3), Settled Valley Landscape (LCA-3.1), Urban Peripheral Village Landscape (LCA-3.4). Hence, it is anticipated that the impact significance before mitigation would be **moderate** due to their **medium** to **high** sensitivity. With the implementation of mitigation measures, the residual impact of these LCAs would be reduced to **Slight** in operational phase.

10.12.2.5 The proposed works within Upland and Hillside Landscape (LCA-1.3, LCA-2.2, LCA-3.3), Urban Peripheral Village Landscape (LCA-2.4), Miscellaneous Rural Fringe Landscape (LCA1.5, LCA-2.5, LCA-3.5), Miscellaneous Urban Fringe Landscape (LCA-2.6), Comprehensive Residential Development Landscape (LCA-3.7) and Transportation Corridor Landscape (LCA-1.8, LCA-3.8) would slightly alter the existing landscape character. It is assumed that there would be **slight** impact significance before mitigation to these LCAs. With the implementation of mitigation measures, the residual impact would be reduced to **Negligible** in operational phase.

10.12.2.6 In terms of the visual impact, considered the connecting alignment to the existing infrastructures and structural mass of proposed road works, the visual impact to the identified key public viewers would be ranging from **Negligible** to **Moderate**.

10.12.2.7 For VPs (i.e.VP-N.9), the proposed works are relatively minimal and with no significant visual blockages to existing visual elements. In addition, the VPs have a foreground of planned development, hillside or woodland vegetation as buffer landscape. The anticipated visual impact of operational phase would be **Negligible**.

10.12.2.8 For VP (i.e. VP-N.6, VP-N.7, VP-N.2, VP-N.5), the proposed works are relatively minimal and with partial visual blockages to existing visual elements, the visual change would not be noticeable by viewers. The anticipated visual impact of operational phase would be **Slight**.

10.12.2.9 For VPs (i.e. VP-N.1, VP-N.3, VP-N.4, VP-N.8), the proposed works are relatively minimal and with slight to medium visual blockages to existing key visual elements such as open sky and ridgeline of Ki Lun Shan or She Leng. With the mitigation measures such as provision of greenery on slope and roadside area and aesthetically pleasing design of road and associated structures, the anticipated visual impact of operational phase for the VPs would be **Moderate**.

10.12.2.10 For VP-S.1 and VP-S.4, the proposed works are relatively minimal when seen from VPs. Both viewers' sensitivity is High. The proposed viaduct along the San Tin Highway would not affected exiting sky view in the background and no visual obstruction will be resulted. With the mitigation measures such as aesthetically pleasing design of aboveground structure (OM1) and roadside buffer planting (OM4), the anticipated visual impact of operational phase for the VPs would be **Moderate**.

10.12.2.11 For VP-S.2, the proposed works are relatively minimal and with no significant visual blockages to existing visual elements. With the mitigation measures such as aesthetically pleasing design of aboveground structure (OM1 & OM2) and sensitive design of noise barriers (OM9), it is anticipated visual impact of operational phase would be **Negligible**.

10.12.2.12 For VP-S.3, the view from the footbridge crossing San Tam Road will be a closed view. There will be a moderate visual obstruction of the sky view that would be experienced by public viewers located in the footbridge. The visual change would not be noticeable by viewers, and the magnitude of change would be **Moderate**. With the mitigation measures such as aesthetically pleasing design of aboveground structure (OM1 & OM2) and sensitive design of noise barriers (OM9), it is anticipated that the visual impact of operational phase would be **Moderate**.

10.12.2.13 Considering the scale and nature of the Project, it would inevitably result in certain levels of residual landscape impacts and visual impacts in relation to the loss of hillside vegetation from hilltop and from ground level. Nevertheless, the residual landscape impacts are localized and limited to the project extent only without affecting existing community, while the visual impacts are confined within the visual envelope either involving few to medium numbers of public viewers along hiking trail and paths. With the implementation of the proposed landscape and visual mitigation measures, the overall landscape residual impacts would be from **Negligible** to **Moderate** in construction phase and **Negligible** to **Slight** in operational phase, and the overall visual impacts would be from **Negligible** to **Moderate** in operational phase. With full implementation of the recommended mitigation measures, unacceptable adverse residual landscape impacts and visual impacts are not expected.